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Inventor(s)	Andriani; Matthew

Non-disruptive diagnostic and attack testing methods and systems

Abstract

Testing methods and systems provide a Diagnostic Testing Service as well as an attack simulation service, for a perimeter security system, in a non-disruptive manner, so that the production targets can be tested while normally functioning, and do not have to be brought down for testing. The testing methods can be implemented, such that they are vendor and device type neutral, considering the overall strategy utilized to prevent perimeter security system attacks.

Inventors:	Andriani; Matthew (Givataiym, IL)
Applicant:	MAZEBOLT TECHNOLOGIES LTD. (Ramat Gan, IL)
Family ID:	1000008781299
Assignee:	MAZEBOLT TECHNOLOGIES LTD (Ramat Gan, IL)
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Primary Examiner: Jacobs-Burton; Lashonda

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Vorys, Sater, Seymour and Pease LLP

Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCES TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of commonly owned PCT/IB2022/059556, title: NON-DISRUPTIVE DIAGNOSTIC AND ATTACK TESTING METHODS AND SYSTEMS, filed on Oct. 6, 2022, which is related to and claims priority from commonly owned U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 63/253,160, title: NON-DISRUPTIVE DIAGNOSTIC AND ATTACK TESTING METHODS AND SYSTEMS, filed on Oct. 7, 2021, the disclosure of each of the aforementioned patent applications is incorporated by reference in its entirety herein.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present invention generally relates to network communications and data transfer, and in particular, it concerns cyber security validation and enhancement of network perimeter services and appliances protection level, for the downstream targets and services being protected.

BACKGROUND

(2) Web Application attacks, Distributed denial of service (DDoS) attacks, application service attacks, phishing attacks, web scraping attacks, malware attacks, and other cyber-attacks originating from the internet, are a major threat to financial institutions (e.g., banks, Forex trading, stock exchanges), large e-commerce sites (auctions, gaming, gambling), hospitals, cloud infrastructure, governmental sites. ISP infrastructure, national infrastructure, and other organizations. Such attacks can exfiltrate data, embed malware, deface, take down, or otherwise hack into stock exchanges, banks, governments, voting sites, insurance companies, NGO's, as well as other critical online infrastructure. Many organizations are increasing their investments into mitigating the spectrum of cyber attacks originating on the internet.

(3) Conventional testing systems and methodologies, especially those for realistic web application testing or DDoS, are disruptive to the IT infrastructure or services of the organization targeted for the test simulation. As a result, vendors try to roll back various aspects of testing, and because of this fact they mainly rely on responses for vulnerability identification from the end application or service itself, false positives from current testing methods become a major issue, leaving additional, in many times avoidable professional services work to validate each vulnerability identified. This makes the remediation process significantly more time consuming and resource intense. Another aspect, in many cyber security checks there is a requirement to have system downtime (or expectation thereof) to perform certain cyber checks (Pentesting, DDoS testing, aggressive vulnerability scanning, Brute force attacks, Web application attacks etc.). This maintenance time always leads to a lack of security coverage, since approving such downtime is very difficult in enterprises, so testing scope has to be severely limited. Accordingly, vendors have weakened and or

reduced the types or intensity of their checks to get more coverage, which normally results in inconclusive assessments, assessments not being done at all, or in some cases, assessments being done incorrectly.

(4) Most organizations are heavily reliant on their cyber security posture being maintained through intermediary security mitigation services upstream to the target application or service. These security services may include cloud security services or other security appliances, designed to mitigate cyber threats originating from the internet, prior to reaching the intended production target, on the internal network or targeted service. Security simulations are being done against the services or applications in a production environment where possible, or in a staging environment in cases where service availability on a production environment may be an issue, or where service availability may be put at risk. Another issue facing organizations, having multiple entry points, and multiple upstream security providers they rely on. Organizations have little to no way at all to validate when perimeter security services are required to act together, and function for their protected environment when an attack is split between multiple upstream security providers, e.g., a multi-homed or multi-path environment. Sometimes it is difficult to assess the end target service automatically, for a particular cyber-attack correctly without starting to risk downtime, this is a contributing factor in being unable to ensure all mitigation systems deployed are working automatically and reliably, which inevitably, may lead to a major cyber attack being successful against the organization relying on those mitigation systems.

SUMMARY

(5) Embodiments of the disclosed subject matter provide a Diagnostic Testing Service as well as an attack simulation service, for a perimeter security system, in a non-disruptive manner, so that the production targets can be tested while normally functioning, and do not have to be brought down for testing. The disclosed testing methods can be implemented, such that they are vendor and device type neutral, considering the overall strategy utilized to prevent perimeter security system attacks.

(6) The disclosed embodiments examine attack leakage at various locations along a network, such as at confirmed data points (those data points not statistically generated through inference of responses). By reliably determining leakage, the depth of penetration of an attack on a network is determined, as well as vulnerabilities of mitigation or other components along the network. Embodiments of the disclosed subject matter are designed to continuously launch attack simulations aimed at validating intermediary security services and appliances and less so the end service or application for vulnerability, and not necessarily waiting for the end service or daemon to become vulnerable. For the disruptive testing methods used today, the end application may not be vulnerable to a specific attack at a given moment, however, using the disclosed non-disruptive testing methods, the organization will be able to know if a particular threat could affect the existing target service in the future, should that service enable additional settings or software that may make it or other intermediary equipment vulnerable, allowing security personnel to patch identified vulnerabilities preemptively in each relevant perimeter security service or appliance.

(7) Using the disclosed testing methods, as well as some of the remediation capabilities described, the organization benefits from the no required downtime or maintenance windows, false positive free reporting, as well as full coverage of all targets and services being protected by the organization, the ability to understand exactly which security ring has been breached and how deep into the environment the attack penetrated, which security service or appliance to patch the vulnerability, understand if the vulnerability was made possible because of multiple entry points simultaneously sending in attacks or data split between multihomed or multipath systems, gain immediate insight into vulnerabilities which can penetrate an organizations security, immediately validate any patches or fixes due to the fact no downtime is required, and provide the possibility to automate vulnerability remediation through API without any affect or service availability impact to production systems. Using the disclosed methods and systems enhance the ability to avoid

damaging cyber-attacks originating on the internet or other external network(s), where the system owner suffers losses from the breach, including financial, data leakage, data-encryption and/or system or service downtime, as well as loss of reputation and goodwill.

(8) The diagnostic testing service and the perimeter security attack testing service typically assess the protected networks at regular intervals (hourly or daily or weekly or custom). This non-disruptive perimeter testing is performed without affecting service availability of the production IT infrastructure and service, while at the same time assessing the production system's risk to a successful perimeter security attack.

(9) In contrast to conventional testing, embodiments of the diagnostic and perimeter security testing services will not affect the organization's IT infrastructures service availability while performing the aforementioned testing towards an organization's internal network. Testing for system health can be toward a coordination device in the internal network and simultaneously toward actual production servers, or only to production services. Ongoing testing can be altered or terminated if the testing service detects deterioration of the health of the production system. This termination is a "fail safe" or "cut-off" mechanism built into the testing systems to avoid disruption and downtime of the production network. This means that a maintenance window is not required on the part of the organization for any type of testing in this method, including DDoS testing. Verifying the mitigation structure of an organization in an ongoing fashion without any downtime to production is a desirable feature for modern production applications, communication networks and testing in general. Additionally, the results of non-disruptive perimeter testing can be used in subsequent conventional disruptive testing if so desired, so that the disruptive testing simulations will be more focused and efficient with a more predictable outcome for human and procedural response handling. Additionally, it is desired that no false positives are included in results since this significantly reduces an organizations efficiency in vulnerability elimination, and significantly if the actual remediation can be completed without or with minimal human intervention, once a vulnerability is discovered. Also understanding which part of the network(s) or security services, malicious attacks were able to traverse would provide an organization with greatly enhanced proactive cyber-attack prevention capabilities, especially with cyber security systems being more distributed and in heterogeneous, multi-path & multi-homed environments and across multiple continents in some cases. Making each layer or otherwise referred to as each ring of security more automated in both identifying and remediating modern cyber threats is the challenge of the day, a ring of security can be thought of as a layer of cyber protections, upstream or downstream to another layer of protection, protecting a production network or its services.

(10) The method of the ongoing non-disruptive simulation services, allows testing of a production environment's susceptibility and likelihood to succumbing to various attack vectors originating from the internet or other unknown networks, especially focusing on where perimeter security services failed. The verification and testing do not require and avoid causing downtime or disruption to the organization being tested. Realistic assessments can be generated as a result of testing, since the tests are run against the production environment and not a staging environment. The non-disruptive perimeter testing methods allow covering (testing) a much larger quantity of attacks and targets performed against a production environment, as compared to conventional disruptive testing, since no maintenance windows are required for the non-disruptive DDoS testing service, WAF testing service, IPS testing service or other security testing, i.e., the testing can be ongoing and allows the attack surface coverage to be very extensive.

(11) Additionally, the way this testing is performed, security personnel will enjoy visibility previously unavailable in granularity, and this method is based on actual threat success being confirmed to have passed each mitigation perimeter security mechanism deployed, and not some inferred response, which may be detected as a vulnerability but also may be a false positive. This method laid out validates the security mechanisms and services with reliance on actual penetration having occurred on the perimeter security, between the potentially vulnerable target service being

protected and the internet.

(12) The testing services will assist personnel responsible for an organization's IT infrastructure security to know almost real-time if the organization is vulnerable to newly evolved perimeter security threats, closing a significant gap in intelligence on cyber weaknesses within the organization. Conventional perimeter security testing may take a few weeks or months until its vulnerability status is confirmed by other manual testing methods, which may require an additional maintenance period, significantly delaying cyber protections, leaving the organization vulnerable to perimeter security attacks. The testing systems have fail-safe mechanisms built-in to ensure the production environment is not disrupted during testing. This allows for many times more targets to be validated and also many more perimeter security attack types to be run against the production environment, as compared to conventional techniques. The testing systems also provides an accurate decision-making process for staff involved in planning disruptive perimeter security tests, which will likely be a rare event once deploying this method of testing.

(13) Embodiments of the disclosed subject matter are directed to a method for testing. The method comprises: (a) configuring a coordination device along a production network including at least one production service, the production network interfacing with an external network at a perimeter of the production network, and the production network protected by a perimeter security system (PSS) for mitigating multiple threats, the perimeter security system along the production network and the coordination device upstream from the at least one production service; (b) receiving, by the coordination device, pre-attack notification information, the pre-attack notification information including: one or more types of attacks to be launched; and, (c) collecting, by the coordination device, operation data regarding the operation of the coordination device, the collecting based on the pre-attack notification information, and the collecting during an attack based on the pre-attack notification information.

(14) Optionally, the method is such that the coordination device includes at least one emulated service for signaling between the coordination device and other system components, for example, the monitor controller or coordination agents; additionally, the emulated service can be used independently or in parallel with signaling, for a simulated attack associated with the preattack notification information may be run.

(15) Optionally, the method is such that the perimeter security system, includes simulation traffic traversing at least two of the group of: External Security Services (ESS) Module; DDoS mitigation module; Firewall; Web Application Firewall (WAF); Anti-virus, Anti-Spam, Anti-malware, Sandbox protections and, Intrusion Protection System (IPS).

(16) Embodiments of the disclosed subject matter are also directed to a method for testing a coordination device and its corresponding mirror ports(s) along a production network. The method comprises: receiving, by the coordination device, pre-diagnostic notification information, the pre-diagnostic notification information including: the diagnostic traffic being used for the test, including the number of the packets in the test diagnostic traffic, and the time when the test diagnostic traffic will be transmitted to the production network target; whereby a mirror port along the production network, is in communication with the coordination device, providing a copy of the test diagnostic traffic corresponding to the time that the test diagnostic traffic was transmitted to the production network target; and, analyzing the number of packets or certain data within the packets in the copied test diagnostic traffic with the number of packets, or other pre-determined metrics provided in the in the pre-diagnostic notification information, to determine the operational status of the mirror port.

(17) Optionally, the method is such that the test diagnostic traffic comprises legitimate traffic (independent traffic) which does not originate with a diagnostic monitor but rather legitimate traffic towards the a production target, that will be captured as instructed by the pre-diagnostic notification, this may be preferable to have random checks or non-specific checks or for any other reason where such functional tests may be preferred for practical implementations.

(18) Embodiments of the disclosed subject matter are directed to a method for determining the route of an attack into a production network including at least one production service, from at least two network segments, which interface with the production network, and at or at least proximate to, the perimeter of the production network. The method comprises: (a) configuring a coordination device along the at least two network segments, where at least one is at the perimeter of the production network, and the coordination device mirror port(s) upstream from at least one production service; (b) receiving, by the coordination device, pre-attack notification information, the pre-attack notification information including: one or more types of attacks which may be launched along any one of the at least two network segments; and, (c) collecting, by the coordination device, operation data regarding the operation of the coordination device for each of the at least two network segments, the collecting based on the pre-attack notification information from each of the at least two network segments, and the collecting during an attack based on the pre-attack notification information on each of the at least network segments. The originating traffic for these attack simulations is from an external network towards the production service or network, potentially traversing multiple network segments. Identifying the traversal of network segments allows personnel to know which provider or mitigation equipment has the identified vulnerabilities during remediation efforts.

(19) Embodiments of the disclosed subject matter are directed to a method for testing perimeter security of a network. The method comprises: (a) configuring a coordination device along a production network including at least one production server, the production network interfacing with an external network at a perimeter of the production network, and the production network protected by a perimeter security system comprising a plurality of components along the perimeter of the production network and the coordination device upstream from the at least one production server; (b) receiving, by the coordination device, pre-attack notification information, the pre-attack notification information including: one or more types of attacks to be launched; (c) collecting, by the coordination device, at multiple points along the perimeter security system, operation data, regarding the operation of each of the components, the collecting based on the pre-attack notification information, and the collecting during an attack based on the pre-attack notification information; and, (d) analyzing the operation data collected by the coordination device at two or more of the multiple points for packet leakage, to determine one or more of: the penetration into the production network of the attack, the effectiveness of each of the components of the perimeter security system.

(20) Optionally, the method for testing the perimeter security of a network is such that the analyzing the operation data collected at the coordination device, additionally comprises: identifying vulnerabilities in the components of the perimeter security system; and, sending commands to an Application Program Interface (API) controller for remediating the components of the perimeter security system having the identified vulnerabilities, providing partial or fully automated remediation.

(21) Optionally, the method for testing the perimeter security of a network is such that the perimeter security system comprises at least two of the group of: External Security Services (ESS) Module; DDoS mitigation module; Firewall; Web Application Firewall (WAF); Anti-virus, Anti Spam, Anti-malware, Sandbox protections and, Intrusion Protection System (IPS).

(22) Optionally, the method for testing the perimeter security of a network is such that the perimeter security system is within the production network and at least partially in an external network, outside of the production network.

(23) Optionally, the method for testing the perimeter security of a network is such that the identifying vulnerabilities and sensing commands to the API includes a monitor controller.

(24) Embodiments of the disclosed subject matter are directed to a method for determining the route of an attack into a target along a production network and along networks external to the production network, with the external networks interfacing with the production networks. The

method comprises: configuring at least one coordination device along at least two of the external networks; the at least two external networks at the perimeter of the production network(s), the production network(s) interfacing with each of the at least two external networks; configuring at least one coordination device at the perimeter of the production network, and the at least one coordination device upstream from the target; receiving, by the coordination devices, pre-attack notification information, the pre-attack notification information including: one or more types of attacks which may be launched along any one of the at least two external networks; and, collecting, by the coordination devices, operation data regarding the operation of each coordination device, the collecting based on the pre-attack notification information from each of the at least two external networks and the production network, and the collecting during an attack based on the pre-attack notification information on each of the at least two external networks and the production network.

(25) Optionally, the method for determining the route of an attack into a target along a production network and along networks external to the production network is such that the target includes at least one of a production service and/or a production server.

(26) Embodiments a of the disclosed subject matter include a method for testing depth of penetration for perimeter security of a network, configuring at least one coordination device for communication with at least two points of at least one network, the at least one network including at least one production service, and, a perimeter security system (PSS) for mitigating multiple threats upstream from the at least one production service; receiving, by the at least one coordination device, pre-attack notification information, the pre-attack notification information including: one or more types of attacks to be launched against the at least one production service; collecting, by the at least one coordination device, operation data which has at least partially traversed the perimeter security system (PSS) during an attack of the one or more attack types in the received pre-attack notification information, and the collecting from the at least two points, based on the attack of the one or more attack types from the pre-attack notification information; and analyzing the operation data collected by the at least one coordination device from the at least two points of the at least one network, for one or more of: packet leakage and/or the certain data within the packets, to determine one or more of: the downstream depth of penetration through the PSS towards the production service by the attack, or the effectiveness of one or more of the components of the perimeter security system (PSS).

(27) Optionally, wherein each of at least the at least two points of the at least one network includes a mirror port.

(28) Optionally, wherein the analyzing the operation data collected at the coordination device, additionally comprises: identifying vulnerabilities in the components of the perimeter security system (PSS); and sending commands from an Application Program Interface (API) controller towards the PSS for remediating at least one of the components of the perimeter security system having the identified vulnerabilities.

(29) Optionally, wherein the components of the perimeter security system (PSS) comprise at least two of the group of: External Security Services (ESS) Module; DDoS mitigation module; Firewall; Web Application Firewall (WAF); Anti-virus, Anti Spam, Anti-malware, Sandbox protections and, Intrusion Protection System (IPS).

(30) Optionally, wherein the at least one network comprises a plurality of networks, and including an external network and a production network, and the at least one production service is on the production network.

(31) Optionally, wherein the perimeter security system is within the production network and at least partially in the external network.

(32) Optionally, wherein the identified vulnerabilities includes instructing the API controller to send one or more commands, and is performed by a monitor controller or the coordination device.

(33) Optionally, wherein the preattack notification information includes, the time of the attack, and one or more of: the attack type, the number of packets in the attack, and/or certain data in the

packets of the attack.

(34) Optionally, wherein the attack is initiated by one or more simulators in communication with a simulator controller.

(35) Optionally, wherein the simulator controller is in communication with a monitor controller.

(36) Optionally, wherein the one or more simulators are in communication with a monitor controller.

(37) Optionally, wherein if the simulator controller loses communication with the monitor controller or the simulator controller, the simulator controller or the monitor controller initiates a notification to the one or more simulators to alter or terminate the attack.

(38) Optionally, wherein the at least one coordination device includes a plurality of coordination devices, and different coordination devices communicate with at least one point of the at least one network.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The embodiments herein described, by way of examples, is with reference to the accompanying drawings, wherein like reference numerals and/or letters indicate corresponding or like elements.

The drawings are as follows:

(2) FIG. 1 is a diagram of a high-level network topology for diagnostic testing, perimeter security attack testing and protection enhancement API;

(3) FIG. 2 is a flowchart of a method for the monitor controller to continuously monitor input IPs and FQDNs;

(4) FIG. 3 is a flowchart of a method for checking status and deciding to continue testing;

(5) FIG. 4 is a simplified diagram showing interaction of perimeter security testing service elements;

(6) FIG. 5 is a diagram of interaction between the simulator controller and the simulators;

(7) FIG. 6A is a diagram of interaction between the monitor controller and the monitor of FIG. 1;

(8) FIG. 6B is a diagram of interaction between the API controller and the perimeter security components of FIG. 1;

(9) FIG. 7 is a high-level partial block diagram of an exemplary system configured to implement the coordination device;

(10) FIG. 8 is a flow diagram of a process for diagnostic testing of one or more coordination devices in the network topology of FIG. 1;

(11) FIG. 9 is a diagram of another network topology used to show another disclosed embodiment;

(12) FIG. 10A is a flow diagram detailing a process in accordance with a disclosed embodiment;

(13) FIG. 10B is a flow diagram of a process for remediating vulnerabilities determined by the process of FIG. 10A;

(14) FIGS. 11-14 are diagrams of network topologies used to show other disclosed embodiments; and,

(15) FIG. 15 is a diagram showing an example of a coordination device set up in the cloud.

ABBREVIATIONS AND DEFINITIONS

(16) For convenience of reference, this section contains a brief list of abbreviations, acronyms, and short definitions used in this document. This section should not be considered limiting. Fuller descriptions can be found below, and in the applicable Standards. BID—Security focus Bugtraq ID Database, tracks issues of cyber security flaws and exploits also sometimes corresponding fixes. BGP—Border Gateway Protocol. CPE—customer premises equipment. CPS—Connections per second. CVE—Common Vulnerabilities exposure provides a reference method for publicly known information-security vulnerabilities and exposures. Device—One skilled in the art will realize that

the terms “device”, “node”, “server”, “compute node”, “instance”, “vm”, “virtual machine”, “docker”, “lambda instance” and similar terms are generally used interchangeably as appropriate for the specific context of the hardware or module being referenced. DoS—Denial of service or DDoS—Distributed denial of service. A type of attack attempting to make a machine or network resource (service, server or node etc.) unavailable to intended users. Sandbox—A technology typically used by antimalware, antispam, or phishing protection systems, to open potentially malicious files and execute those files in a controlled environment to inspect if the file indeed has malware or some type of malicious attachment embedded. Based on abnormal behavior or other threat analysis techniques a file may be deemed a threat.

(17) Companies utilizing Sandbox technology include, but not limited to:

[https://www.trendmicro.com/en_us/business/products/network/advanced-threat-](https://www.trendmicro.com/en_us/business/products/network/advanced-threat-protection/inspector.html)

[mcafee.com/enterprise/en-us/products/advanced-threat-defense.html](https://www.mcafee.com/enterprise/en-us/products/advanced-threat-defense.html)

<https://www.sonicwall.com/products/capture-advanced-threat-protection/> Zero Trust Architecture

(ZTA)—Is an idea and recommendation, whereby users are continuously scrutinized what they are doing with network resources and applications, e.g., “never trust, always verify”. This is done through multi-factor authentication, micro segmentation, continuous authentication, behavioral monitoring and other systems design to ensure the user is indeed authorized to access the system, preventing attackers lateral movement. See reference:

<https://csrc.nist.gov/publications/detail/sp/800-207/final>. Upstream/Downstream—The terms “upstream” and “downstream” are terms of direction, location, and orientation, for explaining the location of components and travel direction for traffic, including packet traffic, to and from various components of one or more networks. “Upstream” is normally referred to as towards the Internet or External Network **100**, as shown, for example, in FIGS. **1**, **9** and **11-15**. “Downstream” is normally referred to as into the internal network or production network **120** towards a target **124**, as shown for example, in FIG. **1** (as well as FIGS. **9** and **11-14**). For example, using FIG. **1**, as a reference for all of the drawing figures, a firewall is upstream to a target it protects. A target is downstream from the ESS, IPS and firewall. A WAF is upstream to a web application, and a web application is downstream to the WAF protecting it. Additionally, for example, as shown representatively in FIG. **1**, the external network(s) **100** and the internal network(s) **120** interface at a perimeter, shown by the vertical broken line **115** (as well as the drawing figures which include this vertical broken line or vertical broken lines). DDoS—Distributed Denial of service. A type of DoS attack where the attack source is more than one, and often a multitude (such as thousands) of unique IP addresses. DMZ—De-militarized zone. FQDN—Fully qualified domain name. Internal network—an organization's production network, also referred to as a “production environment”, or simply “environment”. Normally a private network under control of the organization, as opposed to the public Internet. IP—Internet protocol. Signaling—Used for control messages, data control, or communication between components of the described system. For example, the coordination device signals the monitor controller. The monitor controller may signal the monitors, diagnostic monitors or other components of the system. Signaling may or may not be part of an emulated service depending on the practicalities for the required implementation, such that the signaling between components of the disclosed systems is typically ongoing for system functionality, data flow control, control message control, and the like, IPS device—Intrusion Prevention System—monitors network traffic and attempts to block and log malicious activity on a network. IT—Information technology. Port mirroring—sending a copy of network packets seen on one switch port to another switch port. Also known as a network tap, mirror port or Switched Port Analyzer (SPAN) port and VPC (Virtual Private circuit) in the cloud. A mirror port may also be any device, appliance or service which generates one or more copies of traffic, for example, packet traffic moving upstream or downstream, that has traversed a location of the internal or external network. PPS—Packets per second. Pre-attack notification information. Information regarding what types of attacks will be launched against the production environment during an upcoming attack (testing).

Also referred to in the context of this document as “pre-attack information”. Pre-attack information should not be confused with conventional “attack” information that is generated by conventional computer defense systems during an attack. Pre-attack information should also not be confused with “attack” information that is generated and/or provided after an attack has occurred or after testing has completed. Production environment—Generally the internal network (cloud systems included) of an organization including the production servers. Also referred to in this document as the overall “system” being tested, or system for which health and status is being determined. Production environments are IT setups which serve a real business need and are not testing environments or staging environments. Production servers—one or more servers (devices or nodes) typically on an organization's internal network or cloud infrastructure. Each production server may be configured to run one or more services, and optionally run one or more coordination agents. Scrubbing—A service external to an organization's (internal) network that is relied upon to only pass clean traffic to the organization's (internal) network, such as destination production servers. A scrubbing center may be relied upon in place of or in conjunction with CPE for DDoS mitigation or WAF or any other cyber mitigation systems upstream to mitigate some of the malicious (attack) traffic. SIEM—Security Information and Event Management is a term for software products and services combining security information management (SIM) and security event management (SEM). SLEM technology provides real-time analysis of security alerts generated by network hardware and applications. SIM—security information management. Target—an element that is the subject of an attack. The object being attacked, towards which an attack is directed. For example, a target can be an organization in general, an organizations internal network (such as internal network), a server device (such as one or more of the production servers, such as web server), or a service (such as one or more of the services, such as mail service). Testing—In the context of this document, includes but is not limited to, “DDoS testing”, “Perimeter testing”, “Vulnerability scanning”, “WAF testing”, “perimeter security testing” is also referred to as “testing”, an “attack”, “attack simulation”, “simulation”, “test”, “security check”, “validation”. TCP—Transmission Control Protocol provides reliable communication with handshaking (often referred to as three-way handshake) over IP networks. TCP is a reliable transmission method and is sometimes referred to as TCP/IP. TCP is the transport protocol used with many services today such as HTTP or FTP. UDP—User Datagram Protocol is a major part of the IP suit of protocols. UDP is referred to as unreliable or connectionless since UDP does not have handshaking and other error/reliability checking features built-in. UDP is utilized in many services today, for example DNS. WAF (Web Application Firewall)—A device dedicated to mitigating web based attack vectors. WAFs, unlike firewalls, are designed mainly to inspect the application layer (layer 7) of incoming traffic. WAFs apply a set of rules to HTTP traffic dynamically or statically to stop an attack (for example XSS, SQL injections). Some examples of attacks, WAF are designed to mitigate: Cross Site scripting (XSS), SQL injections, Sensitive data exposure, known service vulnerabilities, brute force, web site scraping, botnet attacks, website defacement, DDoS attacks, out of state attacks, empty connection attacks, and others.

(18) Examples of DDoS attacks, include, but are not limited to: SYN flood, ACK Flood, RST Flood, LOIC (Low Orbit Iron Cannon), HOIC (High Orbit Iron Cannon), Out of state flood, Slowloris, R.U.D.Y, Slow HTTP test, ICMP flood, Teardrop attacks, Slow rate flood, HTTP POST flood, HTTP GET Flood, Dynamic HTTP flood, DNS request flood, SSL renegotiation, attack Bypass Layer 7 protections, DNS response Flood, NTP attack, SIP renegotiation attack, and, Advanced persistent DDoS (APT DDoS attacks). Examples of other attacks include, for example, —Application service attacks, phishing attacks, web scraping attacks, CVE based attack detection and strategies, IPS security, brute force attacks, fuzzing attacks, firewalls, malware attacks, malicious payloads, scraping, sandbox strategies, and other cyber attacks.

(19) Equipment that can be used as part of a DDoS mitigation strategy in the Perimeter Security System (PSS) **230** as defined herein, such as being integrated as sub-modules in the DDoS

mitigation **250** include, but are not limited to: Corberos DDoS Defense Device—

http://www.corero.com/products/Corero_DDS.html Radware's Defense Pro—

[http://www.radware.com/Products/DefensePro/F5 DDoS mitigation devices—](http://www.radware.com/Products/DefensePro/F5_DDoS_mitigation_devices)

[http://www.f5.com/it-management/solutions/ddos-protection/overview/.](http://www.f5.com/it-management/solutions/ddos-protection/overview/)

(20) Scrubbing centers, which may be part of external security services (ESS) modules, may include, but are not limited to equipment such as: Arbor—

<http://www.arbometworks.com/products/arbor-cloud/for-enterprises> Prolexic—

<http://www.prolexic.com/services-dos-and-ddos-mitigation.html> Incapsula—

<http://www.incapsula.com/ddos-protection-services.html>. Scrubbing centers may be part of the External Security Services modules. Additionally, provided that the deployment is upstream from the production network perimeter, any device such as Firewalls, WAFs, IPS, Anti-spam Anti-malware, Anti-virus, Sandbox protections, anti-phishing and the like are also taken to be part of the ESS.

(21) Firewalls can include, but are not limited to: Checkpoint—

<http://www.checkpoint.com/products/next-generation-firewall/index.html> Fortinet—

<http://www.fortinet.com/solutions/firewall.html>. Vulnerability Scanning—Vendors scan services or applications for vulnerabilities using either custom crafted methods or known CVE's. Vendors providing such services may use web attack simulations or NVTs (Network Vulnerability test) making use of NVD (National Vulnerability Database—<https://nvd.nist.gov/>) or similar sources.

Vendors providing such technologies include: Qualys—<https://www.qualys.com/apps/web-app-scanning/> Tenable—<https://www.tenable.com/products/nessus> Rapid7—<https://www.rapid7.com/>

(22) IPS/IDS systems include, but are not limited to: Snort—<https://www.snort.org/Cisco> IPS—

http://www.cisco.com/c/en/us/products/collateral/security/ips-4200-s-series-sensors/product_data_sheet0900aecd805baef2.html Fortinet IPS—

<http://www.fortinet.com/solutions/ips.html> IBM IPS—[http://www-](http://www-03.ibm.com/software/products/en/network-ips)

[03.ibm.com/software/products/en/network-ips](http://www-03.ibm.com/software/products/en/network-ips) Source fire—

[http://www.sourcefire.com/products/next-generation-network-security.](http://www.sourcefire.com/products/next-generation-network-security)

(23) Routers include, but are not limited to: Cisco—

<http://www.cisco.com/c/en/us/products/routers/index.html> Juniper,

[http://www.juniper.net/us/en/products-services/routing/.](http://www.juniper.net/us/en/products-services/routing/)

(24) WAF (Web application firewall) include, but are not limited to: Imperva—

<http://www.imperva.com/Products/WebApplicationFirewall> Radware—

[http://www.radware.com/Products/AppWall/.](http://www.radware.com/Products/AppWall/)

(25) CloudFlare—<https://www.cloudflare.com/>

(26) The above are just some of the more common devices seen in a network with regards to mitigating and defending against cyber security threats.

(27) Vulnerability scanners use various checks (NVTs and similar) to elicit responses from services or applications they are scanning locally or from a service on the internet. For example, sending an SQL injection towards a Web application, if the Web application responds with data which could indicate insufficient bounds checking, the vulnerability scanner may identify the web service as vulnerable, which may or may not be correct. A series of other checks may be performed, such as trying to input benign data and then checking if that data exists on the web application, further eliminating the possibility of a false positive. However, one hundred percent certainty of false positive is never assured since these technologies rely on responses from the service, there is no assurance that the service being tested is actually the one responding to the scanner or that the responses are legitimate.

(28) DDoS in many cases is unique in the fact that DDoS often requires more than one of these devices or infrastructures to be incorporated into the DDoS mitigation strategy to stop a DDoS attack from impacting service availability, since even if on premise equipment is working well, the bandwidth requirements may simply not be adequate. For example, if the DDoS CPE (Customer

Premise Equipment) perfectly blocks a SYN attack, however the attack exceeds the bandwidth of the production environment's target, the environment will still suffer downtime, since the bandwidth would be saturated up to the DDoS CPE. Without an upstream provider mitigating the SYN attack to preserve the bandwidth for legitimate users connecting, the CPE alone will not work to enable business continuity for the production environment, since no bandwidth will be available for legitimate users.

(29) Disruptive testing—implies that launching of attack simulations against an organization's IT infrastructure will cause disruption to service availability if that particular attack vector is not mitigated by the perimeter security mitigation systems deployed. For example: If a website is being tested for susceptibility to attacks, and a disruptive attack is performed towards the website, if the website is not as protected against such an attack vector, visitors will no longer be able to connect to the website. Service availability has been disrupted. To further this example, if the website was hosted on a network that also hosts a mail server, the mail server may also become unavailable, even if the original target was just the web server.

(30) Non-Disruptive perimeter (perimeter security) testing—implies that the testing taking place against the IT infrastructure does not affect adversely any of the service availability of the organization being tested. All services should remain in a healthy state for external users to utilize, even if the actual production service is being validated by launching a series of attacks directly to such a service. For example: If a website is being tested for susceptibility to perimeter security attacks and non-disruptive perimeter testing is used to verify if the website is indeed protected against multiple attack vectors, visitors should still be able to connect to the website. Service availability has not been disrupted. All services within that same subnet (network) such as SMTP, DNS, VPN or FTP would also not be disrupted (continue to operate).

(31) Network services—Also referred to as “services” such as the services or “production services”, include any service (also referred to as daemons) that are designed and deployed to serve users. Some examples of common services include, but are but not limited to: HTTP service—Serves websites and other web based applications (APACHE and IIS are a couple of common web services) SMTP—Is a mail protocol used to send email (POSFIX and Exchange may implement SMTP) SIP—Use for VOIP communications.

(32) IT infrastructure (network infrastructure)—refers to a device that has traffic passed through the device or to it on the IT network of an organization, including in the cloud. Examples include, but are not limited to: Firewalls Routers DDoS mitigation devices WAFs (Web application firewalls) IPS (intrusion prevention systems) Load balancers, servers and nodes.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(33) The principles and operation of the system according to a present embodiment may be better understood with reference to the drawings and the accompanying description. The present disclosed subject matter, in some embodiments, is directed to a system for testing and verifying the integrity of a perimeter security mitigation strategy of an organization while maintaining operation of the targeted organization's IT infrastructure. The method of the perimeter security testing service facilitates ongoing and recurring operation and integrity of the perimeter security mitigation strategy, at regular intervals and without causing service disruption to the IT infrastructure or production services, thus removing the need for disruptive maintenance windows in organizations. A feature of this perimeter security testing service is non-disruptive perimeter security testing simulation for production environments, including checking all vectors of an organization's perimeter security mitigation strategy in an ongoing way.

(34) This system is applicable for perimeter security, and is not limited but typically includes web application validation, web application security, web security strategies, phishing attack detection, DDoS testing services, DDoS mitigation strategies, phishing detection, CVE based attack detection and strategies, IPS security, brute force attacks, fuzzing attacks, firewalls, malware attacks, malicious payloads, scraping, sandbox strategies or any other validation and remediation of

security systems deployed on the perimeter of an internal network or protected services on systems serving the public or internal employs from cyber threats arising on the Internet.

(35) For simplicity, this description refers to perimeter security attacks, which may include, for example, web application attacks. This use should not be interpreted as limiting, and also applies to other types of attacks.

(36) The systems and methods of the disclosure provide for diagnostic and attack testing occurring during normal operation of the networks so as not to disrupt normal operation of the networks (both production and external networks). Accordingly, this testing is known as non-disruptive testing, as it occurs during normal production operations, such that the network or networks do not need to be taken offline or require a maintenance window out of hours for performing the aforementioned testing.

(37) In general, a method for testing, including performing diagnostics on one or more coordination devices, as well as performing simulated attacks, includes deploying a coordination device, for example, on a production network (for example, which may include multiple physical and logical entities including production services). The coordination device optionally emulates a network service for being attacked or for signaling to other components. The production network is protected by one or more perimeter security devices or components, the aforementioned perimeter security devices or components forming a perimeter security system (PSS). A response monitoring baseline is generated of each production service's normal operation on the production network; this can be done with either or both response monitors or coordination agents. Before perimeter security testing, the coordination device receives pre-diagnostic information, when a diagnostic procedure is to be performed, or pre-attack notification information, when a simulated attack is to be performed. The pre-attack notification information includes one or more types of attacks to be launched, when each type of attack will be launched, and parameters of each type of attack. During an attack, the coordination device collects operation data based on the pre-attack notification information. The production service is monitored for, example, by monitors on the external network, generating response monitors towards a production service on the internal network. This allows "normal" behavior of the service being monitored to be defined, i.e., understanding what a stable production service looks like. The monitor's operation data is reported back to the monitor controller during an attack, and if the monitor controller determines that the operation data is out of a pre-determined range, e.g., outside of the baseline, the attack is altered or terminated. Coordination agents may be part of a pre-attack or pre-diagnostic information and post attack and post diagnostic data collection. Coordination agents **222X** generally function as a monitor deployed on a production server **124** or coordination device **220** collecting agent operation data (which, for example, includes traffic, such as packet or packetized traffic), to be used as part of creating baselines for different operation data including such operation data metrics (agent metrics) such as, e.g. CPU, RAM, gathered traffic statistics, concurrent connections, packet information etc. Baselines are also created for coordination agents to understand what a healthy system looks like, same as response monitors. Later on, the coordination agents **222X**, feeding back to the monitor controller **200** can be used alone or in conjunction with monitors **202** to alter or terminate an attack, which may include a simulated attack. The process being similar to that of the monitors being used to alter or terminate an attack, which may include a simulated attack.

(38) In the description below, certain elements are referred to generally by a general number, with individual members of the general element referred to with a suffix. For example, general references to an element include a numeral without a suffix, such as production services (services) **124**, production servers **126**, monitors **202**, simulators **206**, coordination device(s) **220**, mirror ports (MP) **221**, coordination agents (agents) **222**, and diagnostic monitors **240**.

(39) The receiving of pre-attack notification information (used interchangeably herein with pre-attack information) is a feature of the perimeter security testing service. In addition, monitoring during testing facilitates altering test execution, or terminating test execution (prior to the

designated test ending time in the pre-attack information), thus facilitating non-disruptive perimeter testing of live, current production environments. Time can be time or approximate time, depending on specific usage or context with the practical implementation aspects, there may be a delay in network communications or operating system interpretation system signaling commands, whereas sometimes may be set ahead exactly on Universal Time Coordinated (UTC) time triggering all components simultaneously. Pre-attack information can include a variety of information as detailed elsewhere in this document. Pre-attack information normally includes at least a start time and an end time of the attack. This start time, also known as time of the attack may be one or more of an actual time, an exact time and/or an approximate time (e.g., up to a few seconds difference). Proper operation of the system is such that all devices should use the same time reference (for example, all devices use UTC). All pre-attack notification information that is relevant for a coordination device will be sent to the device. For example, the coordination device **220**, receives some or all of the pre-attack information, including the time and time length of the attack, from a monitor controller **200**. Once the pre-attack information is received, the coordination device **220** may parse the received pre-attack information, taking what information it requires for itself, to apply when checking for attack leakage. Additionally, based on the pre-attack information it received, the coordination device **220** may send a subset of the received pre-attack information to one or more of the coordination agents (CA) **222** for which it is relevant, which for example, are associated with the production servers **126A-126D** and/or services **124**. With this pre-attack information, coordination agents are able to parse and send back relevant data metrics (agent metrics), including data points or metrics (e.g., CPU usage, RAM usage, traffic statistics, concurrent connections, DPI data, hard disk storage information etc.), during attack simulations, as requested in this pre-attack information.

(40) The collection (gathering) of operation data includes, but is not limited to, measuring of operational (operation) parameters of a component, device, server, service, packet(s), memory and/or receiving operational (operation) information or metrics regarding a component, device, server, service, packet(s), such as load, processes running, memory use, CPU stats, and the like. Operation data can also be data received from attack simulations that have traversed any security mitigation component, such as any defined in a Perimeter Security System (PSS).

(41) A “pre-determined range” refers to any one or more, or a combination of many parameters (operational parameters) of a device that are measured as part of the collection of operation data being at, above, or below a pre-determined value, or inside or outside a pre-determined range.

(42) Referring now to FIG. **1**, a diagram of a network topology in accordance with various embodiments of the disclosed subject matter. An external network, such as Internet **100**, (the terms “external network” and “Internet” used interchangeably herein), is connected via a router **106** to an internal network **120**. For example, the external network **100** interfaces with the internal network **120** at a perimeter (shown as a vertical broken line **115**). The internal network **120** may also be referred to as a production network, as it includes production servers **126** (the terms “internal network” and “production network” used interchangeably herein). In some instances, the external network **100** includes network segments, also known as external network segments, to show different pathways into the internal network **120**. In some instances, the internal network **120** includes network segments, also known as internal network segments, to show different pathways within the internal network **120**. In some instances, network segments may be referred to, this means any of the internal network segments or the external network segments or combination thereof. Network segments are used as a descriptive way of illustrating how traffic traverses various points of an internal or external network, for example, when a network setup is large multihomed, multi route, multi path, and the like, understanding how traffic traverses can be thought of as various network segments.

(43) Throughout this document, traffic flows from the external network **100** towards the production network **120**, such that the external network **100** is located or positioned “upstream” from the

internal network **120** (production network), and the production network **120** is located or positioned downstream from the external network **100**. Both the external **100** or internal **120** networks may be made up of various segments, where necessary to illustrate a concept, segments are mentioned, and a where the term “network segment” is used this is to illustrate an isolated point of the network on either the internal **120** or external **100** network, for example purposes.

(44) The traffic, for example, including traffic known as attack traffic, simulated traffic, simulated attack traffic, simulator traffic, monitor traffic, test traffic, diagnostic traffic, and the like is typically packetized traffic formed of packets, packet groups or segments and the like. The packets typically contain certain data, which is typically obtained and/or analyzed by various processes, deep packet inspection or some other type of packet parsing analysis, where packet structs and data may be read, which may be performed, for example, at a coordination device **220**, a monitor **202A-202N**, or simulator **206A-206N**, or coordination agent **222A**.

(45) The coordination device(s) **220** and monitor controller **200**, as well as the mirror ports (MP), for example, mirror port (MP) **221** of FIG. **1** and mirror ports (MP) **221a-221f** of FIG. **9**, for example, as deployed on a network, i.e., the production network **120**, are also known as collection points, through which traffic, such as in the form of packets, is collected, so as to ultimately be available for analysis, as detailed below. Traffic, including the aforementioned packetized traffic, for example, is part of various data, such as operation data, simulation data, monitor operation data, agent operation data, diagnostic data, and the like. At the external network, for example, the Internet **100**, one or more users, represented by the user(s) **102**, communicate, for example, with services (production services **124A-124D**) provided, e.g., hosted by production servers **126**, for example, web services, provided by a one or more web servers **126a**, DNS services **124B**, represented by one or more DNS servers **126B**, also known as a DNS Node, a mail service **124C**, represented by one or more mail servers **126C**, and/or one or more databases (database service **124D**), represented by the server **126D**. The aforementioned servers and services are in accordance with that detailed in commonly owned U.S. Pat. No. 10,509,909, the disclosure of which is incorporated by reference in its entirety herein. Additionally, for example, the servers (production servers) **126** may also be a virtual node, a lambda instance attached to another instance, a docker, or the like.

(46) One or more attack nodes, represented by the attack node **104**, is one example network location from which real perimeter security attacks on the services **124** and/or production servers **126** and/or any other locations on the Internal Network **120** may originate and/or be facilitated.

(47) A perimeter security system (PSS) **230** sits upstream from the production services **124**, and, for example, extends along both the external network (Internet) **100** and the internal network (the production network) **120**. Alternately, the PSS **230** may be in the internal network **120** alone, or in the external network **100** alone.

(48) The PSS **230**, for example, includes perimeter security devices or components **109**, **250**, **252**, **254**, **256**. For example, component **109** (ESS) is typically deployed upstream of the router **106**, typically on/along the external network **100**, while components **250**, **252**, **254**, and **256**, are typically deployed after or downstream of the router **106** on/along the internal network **120**. However, for example, the PSS **230** components may be deployed on/along the external network **100** or the internal network **120**. The PSS **230** protects the services (production services) **124** (e.g., deployed on/along the internal or production network **120**), specific services indicated by element numbers **124A-124D**, and/or the production servers **126** (e.g., deployed on/along the internal or production network), with specific production servers represented by element numbers **126A-126D**. The PSS **230** components include, for example, one or more of each of (one of each shown for example purposes) of: an External Security Services (ESS) module **109** (hereinafter “ESS”), External Security Services (ESS) Module; DDoS mitigation module **250**, Firewall **252**, web application firewall (WAF) **254**, Intrusion Protection System (IPS) **256**, Antivirus, Anti-malware, Sandbox protections, Antispam, and the like.

(49) An External Security Services (ESS) module **109** (hereinafter “ESS”), for example, sits upstream from the router **106** on the Internet **100** or external network. The ESS **109**, for example, includes computers, computerized devices/modules, services, and the like. The ESS **109**, for example, may also be used as part of an organization's perimeter security mitigation strategy. The ESS **109** includes one or more security modules or components which are typically autonomous and/or distributed by location, and which are designed to mitigate malicious, benign or unwanted traffic, from the Internet and pass clean, sanitized or permitted only traffic to the Internal network **120**. Example devices or services within the ESS **109** include one or more of, a scrubbing center for DDoS traffic mitigation (such as that described in U.S. Pat. No. 10,509,909) and/or cloud security services or technologies (as disclosed in U.S. Pat. No. 10,509,909), such as, WAF (Web Application Firewall), IPS (Intrusion Prevention systems), antivirus, antispam, firewall, antimalware, geolocation blocking, sandbox detection and other technologies designed to detect and/or mitigate malicious, threatening, disallowed or abnormal traffic types, preventing such traffic from reaching the internal network **120**. The ESS module **109** may be distributed, over multiple locations along the internet **100** and/or the internal network **120**, to protect internal network **120**.

(50) The ESS **109**, router **106** and the other perimeter security devices **250**, **252**, **254**, **256** (detailed below) form the perimeter security system (PSS) **230** (also known as a perimeter security mitigation system). The aforementioned components ESS **109**, router **106**, components **250**, **252**, **254**, **256**, may also be in the form of one or more modules. As used herein, a “module”, for example, includes a component for storing instructions (e.g., machine readable instructions) for performing a process, and including or associated with processors or executing the instructions. Additionally, the router **106** functionality may be included in the PSS **230**. The internet side **100** of the network topology of FIG. **1** additionally includes one or more diagnostic monitors **240A-240N** controlled by a monitor controller **200**, and an API (Application Programming Interface) Controller **242**. The monitor controller **200**, as detailed below, typically is the component for orchestrating the system, i.e., controlling traffic flow, data generation, data collection, data analysis, initiating attacks, diagnostic tests, performing diagnostics, and the like. Alternately, another computer, processor or other device may be part of the system, replacing or augmenting the operation of the monitor controller **200**.

(51) The diagnostic monitor(s) **240A-240N** is/are configured, for example, to send legitimate traffic to a target or intended destination, such as one or more of the production servers **126** or services **124**, as part of a diagnostic procedure. One example diagnostic procedure is used to determine whether a mirror port (MP) **221**, along the internal network **120**, is operational, and the extent or effectiveness of its operation. Legitimate traffic includes, for example, packetized traffic and other traffic which is intended for a target, and which is known to be legitimate, so that it is not blocked by one or more of the ESS module **109** or the other perimeter security devices **250**, **252**, **254**, **256**, and will pass through to the target, e.g., the one or more production servers **126**, or services **124**, an intended destination for the legitimate traffic. For this reason, unless a specific need arises, malicious traffic is typically not used in diagnostic procedures, as there is a high likelihood, that it will be partially or completely blocked by the ESS module **109** (of the PSS **230**) or another perimeter security device (of the PSS **230**) **250**, **252**, **254**, **256**, prior to reaching the mirror port **221** which is being analyzed to determine whether it is operating or to what extent it is operating at.

(52) The monitor controller **200** communicates with one or more coordination devices **220** (detailed below), for example, along the internal network **120**, to provide notification information, such as pre-diagnostic notification information, that designated legitimate traffic will be sent to a target, from the diagnostic monitor **240**, for example, at a given time and given frequency. The sending of the designated legitimate traffic, by one or more diagnostic monitors **240A-240N**, is typically performed under the control and signaling of the monitor controller **200**. Alternatively, the monitor controller **200**, based on the reasoning for triggering a diagnostic event or other optimizations, may decide to use another existing monitor, for example, Monitor A **202A**, to

perform the diagnostic procedure. In some cases, during the diagnostic procedure, the diagnostic traffic may be transmitted independently of the diagnostic monitors **240**, for example, by a user **102** on the Internet **100** connecting to a production server **126**, when the start and/or stop time of the diagnostic traffic is unknown.

(53) In some examples, the monitor controller **200** serves as a collection point or collector for data from the various coordination devices **220**, agents **222**, simulator controller **204**, simulators **206**, PSS components, and performs analysis of the data to determine various aspects and vulnerabilities of the system as detailed herein. The monitor controller **200**, for example, may be exchanged with or supplemented by other components, such as simulator controller **204**, or coordination device **220** to render various decisions on traffic, system vulnerability, vulnerability mitigation, operation of the PSS **230**, system health, and the like.

(54) The monitor controller **200**, monitors **202A-202N**, diagnostic monitors **240A-240N**, simulator controller **204** (detailed below and in accordance with that detailed in U.S. Pat. No. 10,509,909), simulators **206A-206N** (detailed below and in accordance with that detailed in U.S. Pat. No. 10,509,909), users **102**, and the external security system (ESS) **109**, which may be a module, for example, deployed on the external network, e.g., Internet **100**.

(55) One or more monitor controllers, typically a single monitor controller **200** controls the one or more monitors **202**, such as exemplary monitor-A **202A** through monitor-N **202N**. Alternatively, a single device such as monitor controller **200** can be configured to perform the functions of a monitor controller and monitors. Monitor controller **200** is in communication with (one or more) simulator controllers **204**, (one or more) API controllers **242**. Typically, this communication is constant (such as using a “stay alive” or “heartbeat” signal, or “control message” signaling as is known in the art) to ensure the proper functioning of the perimeter security testing service, in particular to help implement fail-safe procedures for maintaining stable operation of internal network **120** (the targeted organization's IT infrastructure) during non-disruptive diagnostic and perimeter security testing. One or more simulator controllers, typically a single simulator controller **204** controls one or more simulators **206**, such as exemplary simulator-A **206A** through simulator-N **206N**. Alternatively, a single device such as simulator controller **204** can be configured to perform the functions of a simulator controller **204** and simulators **206**. Alternatively, a single device such as the monitor controller **200** can be configured to perform simultaneously the functions of the monitor controller **200**, monitors **202**, simulator controller **204**, and simulators **206**.

(56) In the context of this document, the term “target” is generally used to refer to an element that is the subject of an attack such as, services (e.g., production services **124** hosted by production servers **126**), daemon, IP address or FQDN name. The object being attacked, towards which an attack is directed. For example, a target can be an organization in general, an organizations internal network (such as the internal (e.g., production) network **120**), a server device (such as one or more of the production servers **126**, such as web server **126A**), or a service (such as one or more of the services **124**, such as mail service **124C**). The Internal network **120** (for example, which may be in the cloud), for example, includes components downstream of the router (R) **106** and which may include the router **106**, represents the targeted organization's IT infrastructure, and is also referred to in the context of this document as the “organization's network” or “network at the organization”. The internal network **120**, for example, includes a variety of physical or virtual implementations and architectures, including but not limited to one or more subnets and additional networks co-located or in physically or virtually diverse locations.

(57) The internal network **120** may also be such that traffic flows to the production servers as well as to actual internal users. As a result, a particular threat is meant to be blocked by either the Internet **100** ESS **109** or other perimeter security devices (components) **250**, **252**, **254**, **256**, even if in a separate part of the Internal Network **120**. Other security mitigation apparatus may be deployed at the perimeter or in the cloud (other than those shown in FIG. 1).

(58) The internal network **120**, for example, includes one or more perimeter security devices

(virtual machine, embedded virtual machines, docker/container, hardware based or other such platforms enabling of security protection software or services) for illustration purposes include perimeter security system (PSS) **230** devices **250**, **252**, **254**, **256**, but may include other perimeter security devices, protecting one or more production servers **126**. One or more coordination devices **220**, e.g., the one shown, communicates (e.g., links) with a corresponding mirror port (MP) **221**. (59) The coordination device **220**, is similar to, and in accordance with, the coordination device **220** of U.S. Pat. No. 10,509,909. The coordination device **220** communicates with the monitor controller **200**, to receive information as to diagnostic tests as well as simulated attacks. For example, in both the diagnostic tests and simulated attacks, the coordination device **220**, for example, functions as a receiver, or includes a receiver, and receives information, for example, as to parameters of each type of attack such as begin (start) time, end time, e.g., the start and end times being actual times typically in real time, amount, size, speed, repetition, location, traffic/packet types, data within packet(s), and the like, as well as other information of the diagnostic test/simulated attack. The coordination device **220** also receives information as to what analysis to perform on the received mirrored packets/representative data, and the data/information to send back to the monitor controller **200** about the diagnostic test/simulated attack. Typically, the coordination device **220** does not but may optionally include an emulated service **124E**, shown as part of the coordination device **220** (in U.S. Pat. No. 10,509,909).

(60) The emulated service **124E**, when in use, serves to provide signaling functions or other service emulation during pre-tests. The emulated service **124E**, for example, also receives a simulated attack, which is, for example, associated with preattack notification information, and for receiving pre-attack notification information and signaling. The signaling or signaling functions may be, for example be used to update the monitor controller **200**. The emulated service **124E**, for example, is optionally deployed on the coordination device **220**, and configured for receiving a simulated attack associated with pre-attack notification information, for receiving the pre-attack notification information and/or for receiving and sending signaling, for example, to the PSS **230** or one of the PSS components **109**, **250**, **252** or the like, associated with the pre-attack notification information. The router **106** may also be signaled to by the emulated service **124E** or the monitor controller **200**. Routers may be utilized as part of remediation efforts by the disclosed embodiment.

(61) The coordination device **220** is able to be deployed at/along multiple locations of the external **100** and/or internal **120** networks, depending on need and distribution of the organization, e.g., if two physical locations run production services **124**, then two coordination devices **220** may be deployed, one coordination device **220** at each of the two locations. All information is transmitted back to the monitor controller **200** for reporting, evaluation, and backup. However, other considerations may require multiple coordination devices in the same physical or virtual locations. Coordination devices can be communicated with or signaled to individually or collectively simultaneously as per the requirements of collecting operation (or operational) data. Also, when multiple coordination devices **220** are used, deployed along or otherwise in communication with the external network **100** and/or internal network **120**, and in communication with corresponding mirror port(s) **221**, the coordination devices **200** can operate contemporaneously, including simultaneously, and can communicate with various components, such as one or more of the monitor controller **200**, monitors **202**, simulator controller **204**, simulators **206**, diagnostic monitors **240**, and API controller **242**, contemporaneously, including simultaneously.

(62) Each coordination device **220** can have a separate set of configurations and daemons installed (which can be initially pulled from settings on the monitor controller **200**, an alternative setup may be that the coordination device **220** pulls a configuration for the coordination device **220** from the simulator controller **204** or another device acting as a configuration server). All the configurations are preferably stored on the monitor controller's **200** database and can be re-installed easily for new deployments.

(63) The configuration on the coordination device **220** can be backed up alternatively or only on

the coordination device **220**. Though this functionality may not be required for organizations (in this case relatively larger, more diverse, with a larger internal network **120**), local backup can be helpful in using the perimeter security testing system and manually configuring the coordination device **220**. In another scenario backups may be stored on the monitor controller **200**, simulator controller **204** or any other device acting as a backup server.

(64) The configurations on the coordination device **220** may, for example, optionally include services **124** such as example service **124E** such as a set of daemons and other information extracted from perimeter security mitigation devices (perimeter security system components) **109**, **250**, **252**, **254**, **256** and also manually input services **124**. A goal of the optional service **124E** on the coordination device **220** is to emulate as much as the real production network (internal network **120**) and the networks services **124** as possible (for example, HTTP, DNS), there services will provide more realistic pre-attack testing targets. These configurations on the coordination device **220**, which are a set of daemons and services, are sent traffic from the simulators **206**, monitors **202** or diagnostic monitors **240**. The sent traffic is recorded by the coordination device **220**. Traffic is also recorded by the coordination device **220** when simulators **206** send perimeter security tests towards the production services **124** or production servers **126** via the mirror port(s) **221**. The traffic statistics and other required information is stored (on the coordination device **220** or the production servers **126** (by the coordination agents **222**, as appropriate), and then sent back to the monitor controller **200** (the monitor controller **200** functioning as a collector or collection point for the aforementioned data, information, and the like) for evaluation via the coordination device **220** of that particular test. In some scenarios, the coordination device **220** may be setup to send data gathered from coordination agents **222** or other internal network **120** devices to the simulator controller **204** or similar server acting as a data storage facility. The coordination agents **222**, while shown, may be optional.

(65) The reason different configuration setups may be needed on the coordination device **220** is that there is a high likelihood that different networks for the same organization are responsible for different services **124**. Also any new physical subnet or network segment which has other production servers will require another coordination device **220** to have the analysis capabilities and traffic monitoring capabilities (on a mirror port **221**) for the services **124** for which production traffic passes through. Since during non-disruptive perimeter security testing the coordination device **220** needs to sniff traffic targeting the production services **124** in order to gather leakage statistics of how much, or, which type of traffic, or understand data manipulation which has occurred to the sent traffic, passed through the perimeter security mitigation module **230**. The traffic captured on the coordination device **220** can also potentially be coupled with other data gathered on a particular coordination agent (for example coordination agent **222B**) on the coordination device **220** and sent to the monitor controller **200** for further analysis and or conclusions.

(66) One or more perimeter security devices (components), **250**, **252**, **254**, **256**, for example, sit between the router **106** and the production servers, which as detailed above, are represented generally by element number **126**, and specifically, as Web Server **126A**, Domain Name Server (DNS) **126B**, Mail Server **126C** and Database server **126D**, as well as any other production servers, and/or services **124**. Coordination Agents (CA) referenced by element number **222** or variations thereof, such as **222A-222D**, and **222X**, similar to coordination agents **222A-222N** of U.S. Pat. No. 10,509,909, and are, for example, in accordance with the descriptions in U.S. Pat. No. 10,509,909. Additionally, the coordination device **220** may include one or more coordination agents (CA), represented by the coordination agent **222X**. The coordination agent **222X**, for example, serves to gather and collect server statistics which typically include but in no way limited to, CPU usage, RAM usage, concurrent connections, or other important performance metrics which can be baselined, to be used as part of operational decision making for either cut-off decisions, attack altering decisions, vulnerability understanding or other operational understandings which may be

derived from such information.

(67) The perimeter security devices or services **109, 250, 252, 254, 256**, of the PSS **230** (shown by the broken line box in FIG. **1**) alternatively, though not illustrated, may sit between the router **106** and other internal network users and/or services which may traverse at least one or more of security devices **109, 250, 252, 254, 256**. These perimeter security system (PSS) **230** devices include, for example, but not limited to, an ESS **109**, a DDoS CPE **250** (similar to the Internal DDoS mitigation module **122** of U.S. Pat. No. 10,509,909), a firewall **252**, a Web Application Firewall (WAF) **254**, and an Intrusion Prevention System (IPS) **256**, which mitigates and/or blocks malicious traffic.

(68) The perimeter security devices **250, 252, 254, 256** of the PSS **230** may, for example, be implemented as one or more of hardware, software, on standalone devices, as one or more components of existing devices, either alone or in combination. Components of the perimeter security mitigation system **230**, including those of the internal network **120**, may be activated or deactivated, additional components added, and components removed.

(69) One or more mirror ports, represented mirror port (MP) **221**, sit anywhere between any of the router **106** and the perimeter security devices (components) **250, 252, 254, 256**, and the production servers **126** and/or upstream to the router **106** but downstream from various ESS **109** components, all together the perimeter security components **250, 252, 254, 256** and ESS **109** make up the perimeter security system (PSS) **230**. These mirror ports **221** electronically communicate with one or more coordination devices **220**. The mirror ports **221** copy or “mirror” the traffic, e.g., packets forming the traffic, as it passes through the mirror port **221**. The mirror port **221** sends (or otherwise makes available to the coordination device **220**) the copied traffic to the respective coordination device **220** (which includes a collector or functions as a collector for the copied traffic) upon obtaining the traffic, or at intervals, and typically, for example, in real time.

Additionally, the mirror ports **221** and/or coordination service **124E** can obtain logs from a log management system, and based on the logs can change results of the diagnostic tests or simulations (e.g., simulated attacked, discussed below and also in detail in FIGS. **8** and **10A**), which was run previously or its currently running. With this log information, sent to the monitor controller **200** for processing, the API controller **242** can be triggered for updating the any parts of the perimeter security system (PSS), for example ESS **109**, the other perimeter security devices **250, 252, 254, 256**, and/or the target servers (e.g., production servers **126** and/or services), as detailed below. Alternatively, logs may be sent directly to the API controller **242**.

(70) A coordination device **220** is also deployed on the internal network **120** or at other locations (e.g., including network segments) where various ESS **109** components may be deployed on the external network **100**, or any other network segment in the internal or external network, as illustrated in FIG. **12** and FIG. **13**, this typically may include cloud deployments as defined in FIG. **15**. In addition, or alternatively to the coordination device **220**, coordination agents **222** can be deployed on the internal network **120** (to obtain data, e.g., operation data including packetized traffic, from network segments, e.g., running along a pathway from the respective ESS **109** to the router **106**, via the respective separate Internet service providers ISP1, ISP2 of FIG. **13**, the segments between the respective ESS **109a, 109b** and corresponding ISP1 and ISP2 being external network segments). Typically, coordination agents are deployed on devices providing services, for example coordination agent **222A** on web server **126A** with web service (HTTP) **124A**, coordination agent **222B** with DNS node **124B** and coordination agent **222X** with the coordination device **220**. One or more of the services **124** typically run on one or more production servers **126**. For clarity, most services **124** are drawn without the corresponding hardware on which the services **124** are running.

(71) Features of the perimeter security diagnostic and attack testing service include: 1. An automated method for ongoing “non-disruptive”, “Ongoing diagnostic and attack testing”, and simultaneous validation of single or multiple environments being protected by one or more perimeter security services or appliances, collectively referred to as “non-disruptive perimeter

testing” including: Verifying that the production environment(s) is currently stable prior to non-disruptive perimeter testing from monitor controller **200** statuses, as well as continually verifying health of the production network during non-disruptive perimeter testing; this is done by creating a baseline of normal response times and/or coordination agent **222** data for the actual services **124** or coordination device(s) **220** being verified, these servers and services **124** are queried directly for response times by the monitors **202** and the baseline stored on the monitor controller **200** for decision making and analysis. Additionally ensuring that the required mirror port(s) **221** are functioning as expected in the coordination device(s) to eliminate the possibility of false negatives or other misleading and/or damaging effects. Multiple coordination devices **220**, multiple mirror ports **221**, multiple monitor controllers **200**, multiple simulator controllers **204**, multiple coordination agents **222A**, multiple services **124E** or other components of the system can be configured to work in conjunction where practicalities of implementation require such. b. In the case of attack testing, such as attacks on the services **124** and/or production servers **126**, optionally first launching a series of attacks towards the production environment's coordination device **220** from an external network, not towards the production servers, at first only pre-testing the coordination device **220**. This optional pre-testing towards the coordination device **220**, may determine if further testing towards other production services **124** should continue based on the outcome of the testing of the coordination device **220**. In the cases where pre-testing is selected, after validating the attack against the coordination device **220**, the attack is then run against the real production, though typically launching traffic directly to the production server **124** is also an option, which options is selected is dependent on the type of environment and the type of cyber-attack being run and will be based on configurations of the system, which settings may or may not be dynamically configured, i.e., with or without human intervention. Attack testing traffic, which is, for example, launched from simulators **206** towards the production services **124** will be sniffed (gathered) by the coordination device **220**, since all traffic generated by the simulators **206** towards the services **124** is monitored on a mirror port **221** by the coordination device **220** (the coordination device **220** is configured on a mirror port **221** of the internal network **120**). c. Send data gathered from the coordination device **220** or devices to the monitor controller **200**. This is the data gathered from the attack simulation traffic sent by the simulators **206**, towards the coordination device **220** or production servers **126** being monitored by the coordination device **220**, or additionally diagnostic monitor traffic **240** sent towards production service(s) **124** or server(s) **126**. d. Stopping any traffic simulation coming from the simulators **206** or diagnostic monitors **240** (when diagnostic tests or simulation of non-disruptive perimeter testing), if any of the production environment (internal network **120**) is adversely affected, i.e., in an unhealthy status received from the monitor controller **200**. Actual production servers and the services **124** are monitored by the monitor controller **200**, and the simulator controller **204** is updated (by the monitor controller **200** in most cases, or directly) with the real-time health status of the production services **124** or the coordination device **220** (with coordination agents **222** results gathered from internal servers, e.g., the web server **126A**). e. Based on the data received from the monitor controller **200** (which is updated regularly with various data gathered on the coordination device **220** or devices, the monitors **202** and the simulator controller **204**), then the monitor controller **200** decides if a perimeter security vulnerability has been identified, or alternatively the tested target is protected (or some other status) for the production environment being validated. For example, if 100 SYN packets are sent towards the production service **124A** from one or more of the simulators **206**, with destination port **80** and the coordination device **220** receives on its mirror port **221** all 100 SYN packets it may be concluded that the server and its underlying infrastructure is susceptible to SYN flood attacks. f. Coordination agents **222** deployed on production servers (such as the web server **126A**) may also produce statistical baselines which are used to determine if a server is vulnerable to a particular perimeter security attack or becomes unstable during a test. The coordination agents **222** report to the coordination device **220** and the coordination device **220** reports back to the monitor controller

200 in as close to real-time as possible. This allows the monitor controller **200**, which may be due to previously stored baselines, to make decisions about the production environment's (internal network **120**) stability status. The monitor controller **200** may combine both the coordination agents **222** baselines and the monitor controller **200** baselines to decide if a health issue (vulnerable or not vulnerable) has been detected on the targeted production server (for example the web server **126A**) and then altering or terminating the attack may be initiated, similar to the logic of the process laid out in FIG. 3. For ease of understanding, one example may be that an HTTP flood is launched towards the web service **124A** at 100 CPS (connections per second) for 5 seconds from the simulators **206**. During the non-disruptive perimeter security attack testing the monitor controller's **200** monitors **202** baseline for HTTP traffic may not have deviated from a healthy state, however the coordination agent **222A** data gathered by the coordination device **220** and passed back to the monitor controller **200** may show that 500 current open TCP connections (in a TIME_WAIT state) are now open on the targeted server **126A** and this is enough of a deviation from the previous normal healthy baseline to consider the web service **124A** now unhealthy for the coordination agent **222A** baseline. This means the HTTP Flood attack did pass through the perimeter security mitigation system **230** (i.e., not mitigated) but did not adversely affect the web service **124A** for external users **102** wanting to utilize the web service **124A** (i.e. users **102** could still connect without any delay to the website). However, in the decision making process on the monitor controller **200** the web service **124A** may be concluded to be (depending on administrator or dynamically defined settings) vulnerable to the HTTP Flood attack vector when the administrator of the system views the results through the reporting. Or additionally, without regards to the vulnerability status the target service **124A** to the attack, the target service **124A** is deemed unhealthy (Though no user **102** has noticed any performance impact and can connect as usual) and therefore the attack terminated by the monitor controller **200**. g. The entire system working together gives an administrator an immediate and real-time overview of how a perimeter security attack passed through each ring of security (even if all other perimeter security defensive systems have failed). h. Additionally, once concluded that a target service **124A** or server **126** is vulnerable. Using any or all of the previously gathered data, i.e., Monitor/Agent Baselines, simulated attack information and conclusions, operation data stored from current or previous simulated attacks, can be used by the API **242** controller in conjunction with any of the components of the PSS **230** to automatically or semi automatically close identified vulnerabilities.

(72) The elements (components) described in this document assist to provide a quick understanding of a real-time attack underway. The elements may include the coordination device **220**, the coordination agents **222**, and previously stored statistics/baselines from the monitor controller **200**. This feature of knowing what is affected can be available via a user interface (UI or GUI) that shows how the stability of the internal network **120** has changed under a real perimeter security attack from real attack nodes **104**. This is possible, in part, by the monitors **202** continuously monitoring the production services **124** and the coordination device **220** continuously updating the monitor controller **200**, in addition, the coordination agents **222** are monitoring the services **124** data and all this data is gathered and reported back to the monitor controller **200** via the coordination device **220**, this means all currently affected services **124** that are unhealthy are seen in real-time. The gathered data can then be used by the monitor controller **200** (or another device) to make (calculate, generate, and/or infer) conclusions about affected services **124**. In addition, previously identified perimeter security weaknesses detected by the method described of non-disruptive perimeter security testing (perimeter security testing service) allow for speedier diagnosis and analysis when under real-time perimeter security attack from attackers at attack nodes **104**, as compared to the amount of time necessary for diagnosis and analysis using conventional techniques. Additionally patching all vulnerabilities identified, ensures automatic mitigation in the future by, ESS **109**, DDos CPE **250**, Firewall **252**, Web Application firewall (WAF) **254**, and Intrusion Prevention System (IPS) **256**. 2. Automatic rechecking of the

environment: a. If there are any configuration changes to the system **230**, devices in the organization's internal network **120**, or new IPs are detected on the internal network **120** (for example, from an IP/Port scan launched by the one of the monitors **202**), this may trigger the monitor controller **200** to run a series of diagnostic tests from diagnostic monitors **240**, or to tell the simulator controller **204** to run a series of perimeter security testing simulations. b. Responses can also be read from traffic launched on the simulator nodes **206**. This assists in further understanding perimeter security mitigation capabilities deployed at the organization, this may include information such as which types of attack mitigation mechanisms triggered during the perimeter security test. For example by reading responses during an SQL injection web based attack test the simulators **206** may be able to understand that captcha was presented, this can be understood through the parsing of the HTTP response packet received on the simulator **206** from the WAF service **254** during the attack. 3. A method of automatic hardening of the environment post perimeter security test: a. The monitor controller **200** via the API controller **242** or coordination device **220** may be setup to send instructions garnered from the perimeter security testing run/results, to various devices within the internal network **120** or Internet **100** ESS **109** (deemed relevant to the perimeter security mitigation strategy). Commands can be sent via the API controller or any communication protocol the mitigation device or service supports. This assists in strengthening the environment (organization's production environment) and may include configuration changes to third party devices, e.g. routers, perimeter security mitigation devices or ESS modules **109**, and/or other perimeter security devices **250**, **252**, **254**, **256**, or the router **106**. b. The commands sent to the devices of the perimeter security mitigation system **230** directly from the monitor controller **200**, API controller **242**, or via the coordination device **220** are, for example, configuration changes to the various security policies on the various appliances or services protecting the organization at each ring of security. Any configuration changes made to the internal network **120** devices will be communicated from the monitor controller **200** via the coordination device **220** and services such as the ESS **109** on the external network **100** may be from the monitor controller **200** via the coordination device **220** or directly from the monitor controller **200** not passing through the coordination device **220**. All configuration changes may alternatively be directly completed by the API controller **242**. c. Devices that receive commands from the coordination device **220** or monitor controller **200** but typically from the API controller **242** may include, for example, any component from the PSS **230**, perimeter security devices **109**, **250**, **252**, **254**, **256**, firewalls, routers, web application firewalls (WAFs), and intrusion prevention systems/intrusion detection systems (IPS/IDS). The API controller **242** or other components performing a similar function to that in FIG. **10B**, may in its flow have an additional element (Not shown), requiring human approvals at various stages prior to each update happening to a PSS **230** components being applied. d. The statistics gathered and aggregated on the monitor controller **200** can also be used to assist engineers troubleshooting an attack underway in real-time with an in-depth understanding of how an attacker has bypassed the various systems intended for perimeter security mitigation. This is possible with two or more (two, three, or four) of the following components working together: the coordination agents **222**, the coordination device **220**, the simulator controller **204**, and the monitor controller **200**. This quick analysis can be facilitated by these components reporting to a single user interface (UI) where a graphical analysis is displayed to an administrator of the system. 4. A method to read current statistics on various perimeter security mitigation devices and understand if an attack could be successful: a. The coordination device **220** polls statistics such as open connection information (e.g., TCP stack), CPU utilization etc. from various network devices included in the perimeter security mitigation system **230**, data from the coordination agents **222** can also be polled. b. This information is then sent to the monitor controller **200** for further analysis and utilized in improving the current perimeter security risk level assessment. 5. A method of knowing where to do more disruptive perimeter security testing in limited maintenance windows: a. After the ongoing non-disruptive perimeter security testing has

been completed and results are known (and viewable through a user interface (UI), all perimeter security weaknesses, point of weakness, ring of security breached, such as vulnerabilities are identified, they can be reported, and are accessible real-time in the user interface. b. This report can now be used automatically to suggest the most relevant perimeter security attacks to check during the maintenance period of strenuous more disruptive perimeter security testing.

Attack Vectors to be Checked

(73) The system is designed to verify known perimeter security, including, for example, perimeter security attack vectors or customized unknown attack vectors, against proprietary protocols, servers, network equipment, applications, services and Application Programming Interfaces (APIs). The attack vectors simulated and tested can focus on, for example, perimeter security attacks, Web application attacks (layer 7), other application attacks, fuzzing attacks, scanning attacks, DNS attacks, cross site scripting (XSS) attacks, phishing attacks, brute force attacks, web scraping, malware attacks, spam attacks and DDoS attacks.

(74) Some vectors include attacks, malicious traffic or unwanted benign traffic (this is a brief list and does not necessarily include all known attacks) i.e., is not comprehensive: SQL injections, Geo IP blocking validations, banner grabbing, Cross site scripting (XSS), directory path traversal, port scanning, cross-site scripting, phishing attacks, exploit attempts. ACK Floods, SlowLoris, HTTPS SSL renegotiation. Botnet simulations, exploitation fuzzing.

(75) The perimeter security testing attacks (e.g., simulated attacks) are possible for both IPv4 and IPv6 networks as well as any other transport protocol that could be used to attain delivery to a production system (like internal network **120**). The addressing scheme of TCP/IP is neutral, and this testing system may be applied to any protocol addressing scheme. An important point is the method of gathering statistics to make assumptions on the vulnerability of the environment being validated whilst simulating perimeter security testing attacks. In addition, implementations of the current method for perimeter security testing are able to understand, using traffic captured on the coordination device(s) **220** if the environment(s) is/are indeed vulnerable. This understanding of perimeter security attack vulnerability of the environment is highly accurate, false positive free, very efficient in coverage and non-disruptive to an organizations IT infrastructure, for many Internet **100** originating attacks, compared to conventional vulnerability scanning, pen-testing or other security testing techniques. Perimeter security testing can either directly proceed against production servers **126** or first complete non-disruptive perimeter security testing against the coordination device **220**. Regardless of method chosen, a similar methodology of verifying system health at each stage of the attacks, the non-disruptive perimeter security testing is coupled with fail-safe or cut-off mechanism, altering or terminating of the ongoing perimeter security test being sent by the simulators **206** and avoiding disruption to the targeted organizations IT infrastructure or services.

(76) Services Validated During the tests of the perimeter security testing may include any protected service, daemon, or application (for example web servers, gaming servers, email servers, DNS servers etc.). Any service **124** or daemon, or server **126** that serves users **102** directly or indirectly is valid for perimeter security testing.

(77) This may include but is not limited to HTTP servers, VOIP servers, HTTPS servers, SMTP servers. DNS servers, SIP servers, VPN servers, database servers (MSQL, SQL, and the like), FTP servers, SSH daemons, and other customized servers providing external or internal services.

(78) Testing Methods:

(79) Tests are designed to validate that the perimeter security system(s) (PSS **230**) deployed, which may include components such as ESS **109**, Firewall **252**, WAF **254**, DDoS CPE **250**, IPS **256**, and, for example, where all function to intercept and mitigate attack, malicious or unwanted benign traffic or payloads before that traffic can get to its intended destination and cause harm or damage on the end service **124**, server **126** or IT production system(s) of the internal (e.g. production) network **120**. Such tests are designed to ensure that threats including perimeter security attacks,

such as web attacks, DDoS attacks, application exploitation attempts, port scanning, web scraping and other attacks are detected without having to rely on the fact that the end service, server or infrastructure are patched correctly. The tests and are designed to make sure that even in the event those threats are not patched, the intermediate perimeter security systems are mitigating those threats. Using this method, in certain cases, it may be possible to identify weaknesses in the perimeter security systems, even before the end server or service has an actual vulnerability. For example, assuming WAF rules are not auto configured, if a web application has a POST form, and it is possible to send POST requests to that form, however the web form is not vulnerable to an SQL injection, using this method, through sending SQL queries towards the web application, simulating the process to identify the potential for an SQL injection i.e. fuzz the application, our method can identify if those fuzzing queries are able to traverse the perimeter security systems relied upon, if those systems don't trigger then one can enable protections on the WAF for any future vulnerability which could appear in that same POST form. This will proactively mitigate any damaging attack in the future and significantly harden the protections for the web server.

(80) Attacks used by the perimeter security testing service to perform an attack simulation (e.g., sending attack traffic or simulated attack traffic), are malicious traffic patterns or any traffic which may include data within the packet taken from known CVE/BID or unknown proprietary researched exploits. The attack patterns are created according to real life perimeter security attacks, for example, web attacks, phishing attacks, malicious payload exploit attempts or DDoS attacks. Generally, there are predefined checks towards the coordination device **220**. Once all checks are completed to make sure the components in the system are all working as expected, simulated attacks are launched from the simulators **206** and are designed to bypass current known mitigation systems incorrectly configured or lacking perimeter security mitigation technology or have an incorrect architecture design with regards to perimeter security attacks. Furthermore, the perimeter security testing service can do perimeter security vulnerability tests that are less focused on traffic flow and manipulation and more focused on a flaw or flaws within an application. Examples may be seen at: <http://web.nvd.nist.gov/view/vuln/detail?vulnId=CVE-2013-5211>, and <http://web.nvd.nist.gov/view/vuln/detail?vulnId=CVE-2007-0087>

(81) There may also be optional traffic generation options from the simulator nodes (simulators) **206** configured through the monitor controller **200**, which updates the simulator controller **204**. This optional traffic can be utilized to create realistic and customized scenarios designed to validate perimeter security mitigation system **230** capabilities or distributor security systems, when the organization is targeted with a sophisticated and prolonged perimeter security attack from malicious attackers, for example, from attack nodes **104**. This is done because some perimeter security mitigation devices may have behavioral algorithms based on previously learnt statistics, or are security systems split between two environments or multihomed systems, and require more traffic to identify the vulnerability in various rings of security, together with the particular service or appliance. This means that the simulator nodes **206** can generate attack traffic to appear as legitimate clients and or malicious traffic. This assists in getting more realistic results in some cases during a more complex non-disruptive perimeter security test.

(82) Frequency of Checks

(83) The tests, for example, attacks, simulated attacks, health and diagnostic tests, can be scheduled to run on a daily, weekly, or monthly level at predefined (predetermined) times for time periods (start time/end time for the test and time length for the test, between start and end times), through a non-disruptive perimeter security testing scheduler setup by an administrator, or on triggered events setup by the administrator. The “time” for the test, in addition to the actual time of the test, for example, in real time, includes an approximate time with respect to the test, so that the system, e.g., the coordination devices **220**, can collect traffic at or approximately at the predefined time of the attack or simulated attack. Optionally, custom settings can be used when a test is run and to adapt to the environment or the test (for example perimeter security mitigation system (PSS) **230** and

internal network **120**). For example, if the coordination device **220** communicates a change in configurations on the internal network perimeter security system (PSS) **230** mitigation devices **109**, **250**, **252**, **244**. (of the external network, e.g., Internet **100**), this change could automatically trigger a retesting of the perimeter security mitigation system **230**. Tests may also be manually initiated by the administrator of the system, for example, an administrator or engineer using an interface (such as a GUI) configured on the monitor controller **200** to generate and/or configure a test, initiate the test, and then monitor the test (attack while in progress real-time). Another example is updates on the simulator controller **204** device to definitions of new perimeter security attacks being added may also trigger a test to take place. Alternatively, based on previous baselines created by the monitor controller **200**, non-disruptive perimeter security simulated attack testing may be set to run at the most suitable time automatically selected by the administrator, e.g., when the production servers **126** or services **124** are under the least amount of load (during a day or week). Alternatively settings may be configured dynamically configured, without human intervention, based on gathered data, for example from, baselines, logs or other operation data, gathered from various controllers from coordination agents **222**, monitor baselines **202**, diagnostic monitors **240**, simulators **206**, or even the API controller or coordination device **220** statistics, e.g., legitimate traffic rate identified towards targets.

(84) Asset Monitoring

(85) All services **124** being protected by the perimeter security system **230** are monitored from one or more of the monitors **202**. At a high-level monitors can be thought of as simulating users **102**, however monitors **202** do much more, as described throughout this document. The monitoring may take place from one or more monitor nodes **202A** and from one or more locations (for example, US and Asia, or London and Moscow). Having monitoring nodes (e.g., monitors **202**) in multiple locations may be important due to geo-location protections triggering dynamically on some mitigation modules (such as ESS **109** of the perimeter security system **230**) on the path to the coordination device **220** or services **124**, even when small initial sample tests are taking place. The monitor controller **200** is preferably in constant communication to update the simulator controller **204**. One way of understanding the monitor controller **200** is that the monitor controller **200** assists in ensuring there is no downtime caused by the perimeter security simulated attack testing performed against the organization. In a case where the monitor controller detects deviation from normal behavior, that may result in potential disruption of one or more components of the organization's network (internal network **120**) the monitor controller can inform the simulator controller **204** at any time to terminate simulators **206** sending simulated attack traffic.

Coordination agent **222** data may also be used in conjunction with monitor **202** data to determine system stability deduced by the monitor controller **200**.

(86) A sample of data that the monitor controller **200** can relay to the simulator controller **204** includes, but is not limited to: 1. If particular IP/FQDN (fully qualified domain name) and/or service is in healthy (meaning no service availability or degradation issues) status this can be determined through response monitoring of servers and services and previous baselines created and that the current responses are within a healthy level. For example, if a HTTP GET request to the web service **124A** normally gets and HTTP response within 200 milliseconds (ms) (according to the current baseline), and currently the HTTP response time is 230 ms this may be considered healthy. 2. If a particular IP or service is no longer in a healthy status (meaning a service availability or degradation issue has started), this is detected by one of the monitors **202** not receiving a response from a service or a sufficiently delayed or abnormal response on the coordination device **220** or one of the production services **124**. For example, if web service **124A** normally has an HTTP response time of 200 milliseconds (ms) for an HTTP GET request to a webpage begin served, and during testing there is no response for the HTTP GET, this lack of response may be considered an adverse effect to the web service **124A** or the hosting web server **126A**.

(87) These response updates during testing are typically every few seconds at most and designed to be at under a second in many cases, both prior to the simulator controller **204** scheduling tests to be run by one or more of the simulators **206** and during the testing. This will ensure that prior to testing, the production system **120** is stable, (and all services, such as service **124C** and web service **124A** are available, up, and running as expected). This will also ensure that the tests do not affect production **120** in any way (while the perimeter security testing is being performed). This course of action is done for a higher level of certainty to avoid downtime. In other words, to maintain operation and avoid causing service disruption to the organization's services **124**.

(88) If the monitor controller **200** picks up a predefined level of “bad/unhealthy” health for a particular production service **124**, the tests may be stopped or altered on the simulators **206**. This will ensure maximum uptime for the production environment **120**.

(89) As a redundancy measure, commands can be sent directly to the simulators **206** (for example to simulator-A **206A**) from for example monitor controller **200** or simulator controller **204** to terminate any tests being run against a specific service (such as mail service **124C**) or all services **124**, optionally the simulators **206** themselves can regularly (e.g., typically at a frequency of at least once per second during a simulated attack) query (signal) the simulator controller **204** or monitor controller **200** for health state changes. Additionally, should a simulator **206** lose signaling contact with either the monitor controller simulator controller **204** or monitor controller **200** the simulator **206** itself can terminate any ongoing simulated attack ongoing autonomously, and without being instructed to by any controller. This can be configurable as to when this redundancy measure is taken. This redundancy layer is an extra layer of protection to prevent the organizations IT infrastructure being affected in any way due to the perimeter security tests being run on the production servers **126** of the internal network **120**. This would likely only happen if the simulator controller **204** was out of contact and unable to communicate with associated simulators **206** (for example, loss of network connectivity) for a pre-determined amount of time. Optionally, implementation of this redundancy can also take into account additional parameters such as is the site “unhealthy/unstable” on a pre-determined level, with the monitor controller **200**. One of the simulators **206** (for example simulator-A **206A**). Additionally, a simulator **206** can terminate autonomously without being in contact with any controller **200**, **204**, in the event the simulator internal software, processes, resource usage or operating system has been deemed to become unstable by a process monitoring such processes on the simulator **206** node.

(90) Target Health and Diagnostic Checks Prior to testing (running attacks, checks) being run, all system status should preferably be healthy and working as expected according to the monitor controller **200**.

(91) The perimeter security tests are normally run with the below main parameters, these parameters may be extended or reduced depending on the perimeter test or security threat being validated: 1. Target—In FQDN or IP format (for example service **124A** or database **124D**). 2. Attack type—This is the type of attack to be launched. E.g. SQL injection attempt through browser emulation <https://insecure-mazebolt.com/blog?category=Web'+OR+1=1>— 3. Fragment packets—If to fragment packets towards the target or not. 4. Target port/service—The TCP or UDP socket e.g., TCP port 80 (HTTP) or UDP port 53. 5. Rate—What speed the test should be run at in terms of repetition of same attack type, Kbps/Mbps, PPS, or CPS. 6. Time—How long the particular test will be run for (for example 30 seconds). 7. Number of simulator nodes **206** from which to run (to use to generate the attack). 8. Iterations (with configured rate/time increases) to run—For example: Run 2 iterations—iteration1 to target x, port y, rate 300 PPS, time 30 seconds. Iteration 2 to target x, port y, rate 600 PPS, time 60 seconds. Or run attack X 3 times from 3 different source locations.

(92) How Many Separate Nodes should the Test Run from (Typically One or More). 7. Location of nodes from which to run tests (generate attacks)—Specify the location to run test from. The location can be one or more locations, either specified generally (for example Europe, only Europe, or Europe and Asia) or specified more specifically (for example London).

(93) An example of SYN Flood parameters, for single simulation (there may be additional parameters added as needed for the test): Time to run=10 seconds PPS (Packets per second)=500 Target FQDN=device.mazebolt.com (this would map to the IP of the coordination device **220**) Target port=80 Nodes to run from =1 Location to run from=ANY

(94) The parameters normally include “number of iterations”, “rate increase per iteration,” and “time increase per iteration”. This allows a gradual buildup to testing an upper limit without having any downtime. Before proceeding to the next test, the monitor controller **200** can validate the health of the environment.

(95) Updating the Perimeter Security Testing Service

(96) The perimeter security testing service, for example, has a predefined list of attacks to check. However, there are new attacks emerging in the wild all the time. These new attacks can be updated by the developer based on research done on perimeter security attacks in the wild as well as on the organization's environment.

(97) The updates can be done from the monitor controller **200** to the simulator controller **204** or the coordination device **220** or both. The attacks can be updated on the monitor controller **200** and the receiving definitions updated on the coordination device **220** controller.

(98) On the coordination device **220**, updating can include updating receiving daemons/operating system/processes/services/applications (to which the simulator nodes **206** send traffic) from the monitor controller **200** or locally installed. Other components and configurations that may need to be updated on the coordination device **220** may include information from a device in the organization, e.g., two or more of the PSS **230** components **109**, **250**, **252**, **254**, **256**, including any other configurations and/or updates/changes.

(99) Updates to the coordination device **220** software can also be done by connecting from the coordination device **220** to the simulator controller **204**, the monitor controller **200** or another server with similar functioning. The coordination device **220** preferably has an auto rollback feature in case there are issues during the software update. The coordination device **220** preferably has a guided re-install procedure in the event of a software failure. The guided re-install procedure can format all data on the coordination device **220**, including giving the coordination device **220** minimal amount of information possible to re-install, i.e., IP address and username and password of the monitor controller **200** from where the coordination device **220** will get configuration parameters and software updates.

(100) The updates can be scheduled for automatic updates at intermittent periods or manual updates. An important point is that updates are configurable per organization, if required, all configurations should be available for editing by a system administrator or other privileged users of the system (for example via a graphical user interface (GUI)).

(101) For example, no information is passed out of the organization/from the perimeter security testing service in clear text—all data will be, any one or more combination of, encapsulated, hashed or encrypted. An exception is response monitoring for monitors **202**. Monitoring is normally done in whatever protocol is necessary for the particular service e.g., HTTP response monitoring would not be necessary to encrypt but HTTPS would be by design. The method of communication between the coordination device **220** and the monitor controller **200** or the simulator controller **204** is preferably over an encrypted link, i.e., SSL communication, IPSEC or other similar methods.

(102) How the Results are Posted Back to the Perimeter Security Testing System

(103) The results of perimeter security testing by the perimeter security testing service are typically displayed in a management console user interface provided to the administrator utilizing the system. Each customer normally has a login to the system and can view at least the following information: 1. What aspects were verified for the test—for example, SQL attack towards production service **124A**. 2. The parameters of the test, i.e., from where the test was run, from how many nodes the test was run, amount of time run, what locations, if packets were fragmented or not, what padding was enabled, and the like. 3. Test result differences between locations can also

be displayed with regards to monitoring data from the monitors **202** and or the coordination agents **222A**. 4. If additional information was gathered from other sources, e.g., API calls to various equipment (for example perimeter security mitigation devices **109**, **250**, **252**, **254**, **256**). 5. If changes were made to the monitor controller **204** configurations because of information gathered by the coordination device **220**, for example the removal of a coordination agent (the coordination agent **222A**) from the web server **126A** may take agent baselines out of future testing decision making made on the monitor controller **200** during a future perimeter security test. 6. If any changes were made to other network devices by the coordination device **220** or monitor controller **200** based on the results of the perimeter security testing run, e.g., if the router **106** was modified by API controller **242** during the testing or as a result of the testing. 7. A snapshot in time of the stability of all devices being monitored in the chain while the perimeter security testing was underway, e.g., a graph showing past/healthy baselines and during perimeter security testing baselines of a particular or many services **124**. This includes the stability status of the coordination agents **222** on the production servers **126**, e.g., the coordination agent **222A** on production web server **126A**, stability of response time monitoring of the production service from the monitors **202** and stability of response time monitoring of the production server **126A**, from the monitors **202**. This can also include information on how the decision was made for if a particular one or more of the production servers **126** (for example web server **126A**) or the coordination device **220** was vulnerable or not during the perimeter security test. All this is provided to the administrator of the system (for example graphically via a GUI) and with some text through the user interface. Additional information is also provided on each ring of security in the perimeter security mitigation system **230** was bypassed during the attack, e.g., ESS **109** (or particular ESS component), Firewall **252**. 8. A snapshot of the entire system can be taken in order to be able to understand what happened at a point in time. For example, how did all monitored services **124** change in health status during perimeter security tests as opposed to during normal production time without perimeter security testing or real perimeter security attack underway. Snapshots of the system simultaneously are a part of the system.

How the Device is Configured and Multi Configurations

Monitoring of System for Administrators and During Tests

(104) When a test is running, the administrator is preferably able to see in a user interface the following information: 1. If the test was performed. 2. What parameters were set during the test with regards to type of perimeter security attack and attack parameters (for example 25 repetitions for up to 30 seconds of SQL injection attack X to port **443**). 3. If any challenges were identified, e.g., layer 7 or layer 4 challenges (for example, a web captcha challenge). 4. If the challenge can be bypassed, and if so how (show the methodology to bypass a captcha challenge and if so are there other perimeter security attack mitigation options available to mitigate this bypass). 5. An overview of how many test iterations were run (for example repeat this entire test from 1-4, 5 times) and the result for each. 6. How many tests passed or failed (i.e. if the target service **124A** or mail service **124C** are vulnerable to perimeter security attacks or not) and what the results are, the decision making process of why that was concluded (For example during and HTTP flood when some unknown mechanism triggered with the perimeter security system **230** from London and USA all monitors were unable to GET the home page and the graph shows monitoring baselines in both locations as unhealthy, so the testing was stopped for that perimeter security test). This can also be according to location, since different locations may have different results. 7. Suggestions for hardening the site when viewing a particular target server (one of the production servers **126**, for example web server **126A**). 8. A level of severity may also be assigned to a specific result to highlight the importance of the data being reviewed by and administrator, e.g., high, low, and critical. 9. Mentioning other nuances identified by the testing e.g., how to optimize or enable a certain protection, e.g., enable sandbox protection in ESS **109** of the PSS **230**, for all emails going to mail server **126C**. 10. The decision-making process of the conclusion “vulnerable”, “protected”

or “partially protected” to a particular attack. 11. Viewing each attack per target if the target is vulnerable or protected with decision information, i.e., why the target was deemed vulnerable, for example the web server **126A** was exposed to or protected to a particular web application banner grabbing technique. 12. A history of decision making for attack simulations with the conclusion per past attacks launched (for example on June the first 2014 a SYN flood against target X showed target X was exposed to a SYN flood attack vector. On July the first a SYN flood against target X showed target X was protected against a SYN flood attack vector). So, the entire history of past attacks with the various decision-making parameters are available to the administrator of the perimeter security testing system. A. Current perimeter security testing ongoing against specific targets. B. Overall current monitoring stability status of various targets (for example healthy or unhealthy). Also, administrators are able to view which specific monitored protocols are in the healthy/unhealthy status for a particular target (for example HTTP GET or PING).

What Daemons can be Installed on the Coordination Device and What Other Characteristics does the Coordination Device Have?

(105) On the coordination device **220**, the following daemons can optionally be installed. This is only an example list and potentially any network service can be installed:

(106) API communication daemon, syslog service, HTTP daemon, HTTP daemon with virtual hosts, HTTPS daemon Vulnerable HTTPS daemon, FTP service, DNS service, SMTP service.

(107) This list does not include all potential services and this will grow with the evolution of new application and networking services as well as customized software created within the organization. Essentially any socket that accepts a network connection can be setup on the coordination device **220** and included with it any higher level application. An SNMP or similar daemon can also be installed to get logs from various network devices, for example from the coordination agents **222** or perimeter security mitigation devices **109**, **250**, **252**, **254**, **256**, used to gather configuration changes of devices in the network. A daemon handling coordination agents **222** traffic is required on the coordination device **220**. In some instances, the coordination device **220** may also run a local coordination agent **222X** for analysis on pre-attacks towards services (for example service **124A** that is hosted on the coordination device **220**). The coordination device **220** continuously analyzes and/or aggregates and/or passes data gathered from perimeter security attack simulations launched towards production services **124** (for example web service **124A** or mail service **124C**) for statistical analysis and/or decision making to be passed back to the monitor controller **200**. The coordination device **220** can also gather data from coordination agents **222** regarding all production services **124** (which have a coordination agent **222** deployed), and sends the gathered data back to the monitor controller **200**. The gathered data may be used to create baselines on the monitor controller **200** regarding things such as CPU utilization, TCP stack information or memory usage etc. (on each of the production servers **126** and/or services **124**.). The coordination device **200** or coordination agent **222A** can also be gathering or collecting generic data (e.g., with or without regards to specific sources) passively when simulated attacks are not being run. Such data is used for additional data analysis and decision making by the perimeter testing system. For example, understanding peak traffic to a particular target **126A** during the week, can be done passively since all legitimate traffic sent by users **102**, towards such target **126A** is additionally copied to the coordination device **200** through the mirror port(s) **221** or coordination agent **222A**.

(108) Prior to perimeter testing being done, the monitor controller **200** communicates pre-attack information to the coordination device **220**, such as what types of attacks are being launched against the production environment (internal network **120**). This way, the coordination device **220** understands (from the content of the pre-attack information) what SRC IPs (from simulators **206**), DST IP or FQDN name of production server **126**, rate of expected packets (e.g., PPS), type of packets (e.g., PSH+ACK to port 80), attack length time (e.g., 60 seconds) etc. to monitor for on mirror port(s) **221** or self service, and also which traffic data to gather, and/or the time the attack is

scheduled to end. Then when the attack is over the coordination device **220** can pass this information (the gathered data) back to the monitor controller **200** to make conclusions about if the perimeter security attack vector was successful or not against the particular target e.g. web server **126A**. This signaling between the monitor controller **200** and the coordination device **220** is important for understanding how successful the attack vector was, i.e., how much of the attack passed through the currently deployed perimeter security system **230**. For example prior to the simulators **206** launching an SQL injection attack against the web service **124A**, the coordination device **220** is first informed by the monitor controller **200** about the attack specifics going to be launched (simultaneously the coordination device **220** may inform the coordination agent **222A** if configured to do so), e.g., 1 SQL injection payload, to port 80, for 2 seconds targeting DST IP of web server **126A** from source IP simulator-A **206A**. The coordination device **220** begins monitoring source IP of the simulator-A **206A** (also additionally the coordination agent **222A** may do the same on the host on which coordination agent **222A** is deployed) until coordination agent **222A** is signaled by the monitor controller **200** the perimeter security testing for the Web application SQL injection is complete. At this point the coordination device **220** updates the monitor controller **200** that the coordination device **220** received the malicious SQL payload targeting the web server **126A** port 80 from SRC IP simulator-A **206A**. Additionally, the update may include any other information gathered from the coordination agent **222A** via the coordination device **220** update or any other internal network **120** devices from which the monitor controller **200** is configured to receive updates/logs. This way, the monitor controller **200** understands how much attack traffic passed the perimeter security system **230** and how deep into the internal network **120** the attack penetrated. Where the protocol used to transfer malicious simulations from simulators **206** to production targets **126** and relevant services **124**, are encapsulated in SSL/TLS or other encrypted traffic, the traffic will have to be decrypted on the coordination device(s) **220**, in order to identify leakage for certain attacks, traffic can usually be decrypted by applying a private certificate/key or other decryption method on the coordination **220** device(s). Additionally, this may also apply when the ESS **109** is a CDN based protection with WAF controls. This is required in order to read meta data from packets where SRC IP or other data in the encrypted traffic is required for understanding of leakage calculations on coordination device(s) **220**.

(109) The coordination device **220** can also analyze network traffic to a very low level if needed. This can include parsing packets from layer 2 through to layer 7. This analysis feature can be used when analyzing traffic in real-time on the coordination device **220**, and the resulting statistics can be viewed through the user interface by an administrator. This functionality may also be used for threat assessment calculations as needed. This functionality is useful when troubleshooting or when the production environment (internal network **120**) is under a real-time perimeter security attack.

(110) Application Programming Interface (API) to Integrate with Other Systems Based on Results or New Threats

(111) An API on the coordination device **220** can interact with various devices (elements, sub-modules of the) perimeter security system **230**. The API can query devices that have been setup for querying. Gathering information from various perimeter security (mitigation) devices (components) **109**, **250**, **252**, **254**, **256** assists in minimizing the amount of traffic needed to trigger a particular event in the perimeter security attack mitigation, i.e., sending a minimal amount of traffic to trigger a particular perimeter security mitigation mechanism on a particular device, for example, on the internal network **120** perimeter security mitigation devices, which typically include devices (components) **250**, **252**, **254**, **256**. The gathering of information may help optimize perimeter security testing times. For example, if SYN flood protection is triggered (identified from a configured API query to the internal (network) perimeter security mitigation devices **250**, **252**, **254**, **256**) after 50 PPS of SYN flood traffic towards a specific target and the data gathered on the coordination device **220** from the simulator shows no packets were captured during the test (meaning attack completely blocked) and the health status for monitored services **124** was

unchanged a conclusion could be made that a further iteration of perimeter security attack testing is not needed for SYN Flood for that port and target.

(112) The API Controller **242** may also communicate with the simulator controller **204** and the monitor controller **200**.

(113) Interaction with Other Logs or Data from Other Systems During Test

(114) For enhanced reporting to administrators, logs can be used from systems in the organizations. Logs are not limited to only the perimeter security system (PSS) **230**, but any other components such as firewalls, routers, IPs, and the like, to make smarter reporting available for the administrator.

(115) For instance, if an attack is partially blocked logs can indicate that the administrator should tune a network device (for example a component of perimeter security system **230**, such as router **106**) to strengthen the current perimeter security attack mitigation strategy.

(116) The gathered data and logs can also be used to enhance the threat level of low, medium, high, and critical.

(117) Alerting (Notification) System

(118) Alerting can be provided in a dashboard (for example, a GUI used by an administrator of the perimeter security testing service) and can also be provided in other forms such as email or SMS message (if setup to do so). Alerting can include notification (including initiating notifications) regarding new weaknesses or other important messages the perimeter security testing system wants to inform the administrator about. The system can also be configured to send syslogs to SIEM systems. Alerts can be configured by the administrator on what alerts the administrator wants to see, including default alerting options. Preferably, at a bare minimum alerts should be shown in the interface to the administrator.

(119) Referring again to FIG. 1, traffic, for example from the simulators **206**, can be sent directly production services **126**, port mirroring can be used (for example in the router **106**) to send a copy of traffic destined for the production servers (such as web server **126A**) to the coordination device **220**. Port mirroring is one way the coordination device **220** can receive a copy of all incoming traffic towards the production services **124**. Additionally, traffic, for example from the simulators **206**, can be sent directly to the coordination device **220**. Port mirroring is used on a network switch to send a copy of network packets seen on one switch port (or an entire VLAN) to a network monitoring connection on another switch port. This is commonly used for network appliances that require monitoring of network traffic such as an intrusion detection system, passive probe, or real user monitoring (RUM) technology that is used to support application performance management (APM). Port mirroring on a Cisco Systems switch is generally referred to as Switched Port ANalyzer (SPAN) or Remote Switched Port ANalyzer (RSPAN), in AWS port mirroring can be done through VPC (Virtual private Cloud), on Google through packet mirroring from VPC (Virtual private cloud). Other vendors have different names for it, such as Roving Analysis Port (RAP) on 3Com switches, some cloud vendors may additionally have packet brokers to enable such functionality. The coordination device(s) **220** supports incoming traffic from one or more mirror ports (MP) **221**.

(120) A network tap is a hardware device that provides a way to access the data/traffic flowing across a computer network. In many cases, it is desirable for a third party to monitor the traffic between two points in the network. If the network between points A and B consists of a physical cable, a “network tap” may be the best way to accomplish this monitoring. The network tap has (at least) three ports: an A port, a B port, and a monitor port. A tap inserted between A and B passes all traffic through unimpeded, but also copies that same data to its monitor port, enabling a third party to listen. Either way, all services **124** being tested in the internal network **120** by the non-disruptive perimeter security testing system must have network traffic mirrored to the coordination device **220**.

(121) Coordination Device

(122) Referring again to the FIG. 1, as described above, the monitor controller **200** and/or simulator controller **204** can communicate with the coordination device **220**. The coordination device **220** is, for example, located, or otherwise deployed, wherever components of the PSS **230** may be located, this may include an organization's internal network **120** or external network **100**, and typically protected by the perimeter security mitigation strategy deployed in the organization, implementation practicalities and considerations will normally dictate coordination device(s) **220** deployment locations. The coordination device **220** receives statistical and other information from coordination agents **222**. Assuming the attack traffic bypassed the upstream PSS components and coordination device **220**, with corresponding mirror port(s) **221** are working as expected, the coordination device **220** also receives attack traffic from the simulators **206** regardless of if the traffic is destined for coordination device **220** or one of the production services **124**. The coordination device **220** can communicate bi-directionally with the monitor controller **200** and may also be configured to communicate with other third party devices such as but not limited to the simulator controller **204**. The coordination device **220** can assist in calculating whether or not the production environment is exposed to a certain type of perimeter security attack. For example, with the gathered statistics of non-disruptive perimeter security testing traffic from the simulators **206** data captured towards one of the production services **124**. In an alternative configuration, the coordination device **220** can capture traffic for later analysis or on the fly (real time, current) analysis.

(123) Roles of the coordination device **220** include the following: 1. The coordination device **220** is primarily a data collector (e.g., of operation data including packets of traffic/mirrored traffic having traversed some or all of the internal network **120**) for the monitor controller **200**. In some cases, the coordination device **220** may interact with elements other than the monitor controller **200**, for example, the coordination agents **222** such as coordination agent **222A** or simulator controller **204**. The coordination device **200** may also communicate with parts (modules) of the perimeter security system **230** strategy, for example, the ESS **109** or other internal perimeter security devices **250**, **252**, **254**, **256** in the organization (e.g., on the internal network **120**) (for example applying or removing a blacklist on the router **106** with a previous API setup between the coordination device **220** and the router **106**). 2. The coordination device **220** can emulate one or more services **124** or daemons in the organization being protected by the perimeter security system **230**, these services can be used for signaling between components or a service to receive an attack. Services **124** can include but are in no way limited to, HTTP, DNS, SMTP, SIP, and other services needed to provide value to users **102** and customers. The services **124** (for example the web service **124A** or the mail service **124C**) are services that an organization needs to provide to the users of the organization's infrastructure. For example, if a web service **124A** is running on a web server (not shown) in the organization's production environment (internal network **120**), a web service daemon would be setup on the coordination device **220**. Setting up a web service daemon is represented in the current figure by the service **124A** on the coordination device **220**. A similar scenario (emulation) would happen for other available services (for example, the DNS node **124B**, and the mail service **124C**). In this way an alternative in a pre-attack is that the simulators **206** may target, with non-disruptive DDoS testing prior to other production servers **126**, first the services **124** on the coordination device **220**. 3. The coordination device **220** receives traffic from the simulators **206**. The traffic is stored and evaluated by the coordination device **220** as needed per the pre-attack notification information. The results from the coordination device **220** are sent out from the internal network **120** back to the monitor controller **200** for evaluation and analysis. In a non-limiting example, prior to a perimeter security test the coordination device **220** is informed by the monitor controller **200** to expect "100 PPS of type SYN flood from simulator nodes **206A** and **206N** SRC IP's, to port 80 for 10 seconds, towards target IP of the web server **126A**". Having this pre-attack notification information, when the perimeter security test is completed, the coordination device **220** will then inform the monitor controller **200** of received data, for example "X packets, to port 80, with

destination IP of web server **126A**". The monitor controller **200** can then make conclusions of how successful the DDoS testing was against web server **126A**, and if web server **126A** is protected or unprotected against the SYN flood). The coordination device **220** may also signal to the coordination agents **222** that non-disruptive DDoS testing is about to start (in conjunction with the DDoS attack specifics), the information in this signaling to the coordination agents **222** may include some of the pre-attack notification information provided to the coordination device **220**. Pre-attack notification information is sent to the coordination device **220** regardless of if the perimeter security testing being done is towards the coordination device **220** or towards one of the production servers **126**. 4. The coordination device **220** receives various attacks from the simulators **206**. The attacks can include high rate and low rate floods, web application attacks, DDoS attacks, phishing attack simulations, exploitation attempts, scanning attacks, malicious payload transfer, or other cyber attacks originating on the internet **100** being sent towards production **120** servers **126** or services **124**. The coordination device **220** will receive traffic destined both for both production web services **124** (for example **124A**, **124B**) via port mirroring and destined toward the coordination device **220** where required. 5. The coordination device **220** can pool data from the perimeter security devices (components) **109**, **250**, **252**, **254**, **256** (e.g., the ESS **109** deployed on the external network **100** as a perimeter security device) and coordination agents **222** and also aggregate or analyze in real-time received network traffic. 6. Typically, the coordination device **220** collects information from the coordination agents **222**. The coordination agents **222** collect information about the services **124** with which the coordination agents **222** are deployed (for example, coordination agent **222A** collects information regarding web service **124A** (for example TCP stack information, CPU utilization, number of open Apache processes etc.), and the coordination agent **222B** collects information about DNS node **124B**). Combined information from the coordination device **220** can then be passed to the monitor controller **200** and/or the simulator controller **204**. Information from coordination agents **222** can be used to determine the health and status of the system. The coordination device **220** can communicate with both the simulator controller **204** and the monitor controller **200**.

Coordination Agents

(124) The perimeter security testing system may include one or more coordination agents **222** deployed on one or more productions servers or the coordination device **220** on an organization's internal network **120**. The coordination agents **222** report statistics regarding operation and status of the server on which the coordination agent is deployed. Reporting includes, but is not limited to, TCP stack information, process information, CPU utilization, memory utilization, and the like. Normally the coordination agents **222** report to the coordinating device **220**. The statistics gathered by the coordination agents **222** may be used to understand the stability of the particular device or server on which the reporting coordination agent is deployed. The coordination agents **222** continually report operation data back to the coordination device **220** (which in turn reports operation data back to the monitor controller **200**), to subsequently create baselines/thresholds on the monitor controller **200**.

(125) In an alternative configuration, the perimeter security testing service can be implemented only with coordination agents **222** (without the use of the coordination device **220**). In this case, communication is directly between the coordination agents **222** and the other devices (such as the monitor controller **200**), as opposed to the preferred configuration of communicating via the coordination device **220**.

(126) Monitor Controller

(127) The monitor controller **200** is a logical controller (node, device), which commands one or more monitors **202** to start or stop sending various monitor traffic towards the organization's production servers or the coordination device **220**. The monitor controller **200** assists in creating statistical information baselines about how stable the production servers **126** are, or how stable the coordination device **220** is. The monitor controller **200** controls what monitors **202** are started, with

which cloud provider (node provider) and how many. Some of the information the monitor controller **200** will tell the monitors may include but not limited to, how frequently to send a probe network packet to the monitored production server or coordination device **220** services **124**, what type of packet to send e.g. HTTP GET packet or PING, and what metric to report back to the monitor controller. The monitor controller **200** can be supplied with the pre-attack notification configuration information as a source for commanding, controlling, and monitoring the monitors **202** (for example monitor frequency). The monitor controller may also be utilized to initiate and control API controller **242** requests, diagnostic monitor(s) **240** and control when diagnostic procedures should happen and which diagnostic monitor(s) should be involved. Additional or other logical functions for the overall system may be implemented on the monitor controller **200**.

(128) Monitors

(129) The testing system includes one or more monitors **202** (**202A-202N**) and diagnostic monitors **240** (**240A-240N**). Monitors are nodes (devices) that are instructed by the monitor controller **200** as to what types of network probes to send and to which targets. Typically, there is a multitude of monitors **202** monitoring production servers or the coordination device **220** emulated services **124E**.

(130) Diagnostic monitors **240**, send similar traffic towards production servers **126** or services **124**, in order for the coordination device(s) **220** to ascertain the extent to which mirror port(s) **221** are functioning. For example, if twenty-five legitimate probes are sent to web server **126A**, the target of the attack, and twenty-five probes are seen on coordination device mirror port **221**, the mirror port(s) **221** can be confirmed to be operating at 100% reliability. This will avoid the possibility of a false negative wherever this type of confirmation has been completed on all relevant coordination **220** device(s), prior to a perimeter attack being launched by one or more simulators **206**.

(131) Monitors **202**, gather various traffic statistics and other data (for example, identified mitigation traffic sent by a mitigation device like SYN cookie protection) to send to the monitor controller **200**. The monitor controller **200** can use this gathered data for decision making, in particular regarding the health and status of the organization's production environment (internal network **120**) or targeted web server **126A**. The monitors **202** can be used to understand the system stability status view from the external network (Internet **100**). Additional elements can contribute to this understanding and are reported to the monitor controller. For example, the coordination agents **222** generally report to the coordination device **220**, which in turn reports to the monitor controller **200**. The reported data from the coordination agents **222** can then be used by the monitor controller **200** to assist in evaluating the health and status of the system (production environment, e.g., including the production network **120** and components deployed along the production network **120**).

(132) Similar to the above-described operation of monitors **202**, the simulators **206** generate attack test traffic towards both the coordination device **220** and other servers on the internal network **120**. Other servers include devices and nodes such as a web server **126A** running the web service **124A**, a mail server **126C** running the mail service **124C**, or a database server **126D** configured with database service **124D**.

(133) Traffic generated by the simulators **206** can include Web attacks. Phishing attacks, DDoS attacks, Malware attacks, e.g. SQL injections, UDP floods, malicious attachments, or any other cyber attack patterns. Attack from the simulators **206** is sent in a predictable way to the coordination device **220** or other internal network **120** servers (also known in a predictable way to the coordination device **220**, the coordination device **220** typically knows the non-disruptive diagnostics or testing attack specifics, which the coordination device **220** gets preferably from the monitor controller **200**, prior to the attack traffic being launched towards the target of the planned attack. In some cases, the coordination agents **222** will also receive advanced notice of non-disruptive testing attack about to be done and when the non-disruptive testing attack is complete, since the coordination agents **222** may also alter behavior during non-disruptive testing).

(134) Simulator Controller

(135) The simulator controller **204**, also referred to in the context of this document as a “traffic simulator controller”, contributes to governing attack traffic should be launched against the targeted environment. The simulator controller **204** is a logical controller (node, device), which commands one or more simulators **206** to start or stop sending various diagnostic or attack traffic towards the organization's production servers **126** or the coordination device **220**. Some of the commands the simulator controller **204** can tell simulators **206** include: when to start and stop sending traffic, what type of traffic to send, what rate to send the traffic at, how long to send the traffic for.

(136) The simulator controller **204** can also communicate bi-directionally with the monitor controller **200** and can receive commands such as stop attack, start attack, configuration updates, etc. There are many commands that the simulator controller **204** can get instructions from the monitor controller **200**, for example to stop a currently active attack, because the targeted system is detected as unhealthy. This communication between the monitor controller **200** and simulator controller can avoid disruption to the targeted network. Alternatively, the simulator controller **204** can also communicate with the coordination device **220**.

(137) Simulators

(138) One or more simulators **206A-206N** are nodes (devices) that launch attack simulation traffic (or attack traffic). The simulators **206** receive commands mainly from the simulator controller **204**. The received commands include, but are not limited to stop attack or start a certain type of attack for a certain amount of time at a certain rate against a specific target (perimeter security testing attack parameters). The simulators **206** may also report data back to the simulator controller **204** and read responses from the targeted network undergoing the simulation. Examples of responses are SYN cookie challenges or ICMP replies. Simulators **206** can be set to send an exact amount of packets towards a production server (for example web server **126A**) or to the coordination device **220** for an exact amount of time. Signaling between the simulators **206** and the simulator controller **204** is preferably bidirectional. The simulators **206** may also be configured to stop all non-disruptive attack traffic, if communication (signaling) is lost with the simulator controller **204**. This is done, for example, as a failsafe mechanism.

(139) Operation of the Perimeter Security System (PSS **230**) During a Simulated Attack (or Attack)

(140) The point of the ESS **109**, **250**, **252**, **254**, **256** appliances and security service modules is to protect the target network(s) **120** servers **126** and services **124**. All these security modules and appliances, commonly referred to as “perimeter security” or “perimeter security services”. When all perimeter security systems (PSS) **230** are working together, they create a layered and multi-threat defensive barrier against the array of cyber-attacks targeting the production servers **126** and infrastructure network **120** originating on the internet **100**. The outer layer of this defensive barrier may be referred to as the outer ring of security and the inner layer referred to as the inner ring of security. Alternatively, each ESS **109** module may have a ring of security, as may each appliance, for example WAF **254** may be its own logical ring of security protecting against web based attacks.

(141) The verification system (perimeter security testing service) is typically configured on the external network (Internet **100**) with two main controllers: the monitor controller **200** and the simulator controller **204**. Both controllers (the monitor controller **200** and the simulator controller **204**) communicate with each other for coordination purposes (to coordinate operation of the perimeter security testing service). The monitor controller **200** directs monitors **202**. Simulator controller **204** directs simulators **206**.

(142) The monitor controller **200** and the simulator controller **204** have a bidirectional communication channel for coordinating activities. The coordination device **220** has a communication channel with at least one of the controllers (monitor controller **200** or simulator controller **204**) for coordinating monitoring and simulation activities.

(143) The coordination device **220** is generally deployed in the de-militarized zone (DMZ) and can see (monitor) all traffic from the Internet **100** entering the internal network **120** (for example traffic

towards the production servers **126**).

(144) All traffic coming from the monitors **202** or the simulators **206** should traverse the perimeter security mitigation strategy deployed **230**. Traffic from the simulators **206** can be analyzed or received by the coordination device **220**. Traffic coming from the monitors **202** can reach the services **124** being monitored. As described elsewhere, the coordination device **220** may be configured with services **124** and/or coordination agents **222**.

(145) The monitors **202** generate traffic towards both the coordination device **220** and other servers on the internal network **120**. Other servers include devices and nodes such as a web server running the web service **124A**, a mail server running the mail service **124C**, or a database server configured with database service **124D**. Traffic is sent in a predictable way to either the coordination device **220** or other internal network **120** servers or the coordination agents **222**.

(146) The coordination device **220** records all traffic generated from the simulators **206**. Traffic is recorded by the coordination device **220**, regardless of whether or not the target of the traffic from the simulators **206** is generated towards a production server **126** (for example, web server **126A**) or the coordination device **220**.

(147) The monitor controller **200** validates that the (internal) services **124** and/or the coordination device **220** is stable prior to the simulator controller **204** signaling to the simulators **206** to send perimeter security simulated attack traffic. The monitor controller **200** decides if the targeted services **124** (for example **124B**) are stable by utilizing information gathered from the monitors **202** and/or the coordination device **220**.

(148) Prior to beginning a test (attack on the internal network **120**), the test is designed or selected, typically by an administrator user or default settings in the system. User interaction, in particular for an administrator to configure the system can be considered a user interaction module (not shown in the figures). For example, the user interaction module **102** can be configured on a computer separate from, or on one of the monitors (monitor controller **200**, simulator controller **204**, monitors **202**, simulators **206**, coordination device **220**), or another local or remote computer device. For simplicity of this description, a preferred embodiment is where the user interacts via the user interaction module installed on the monitor controller **200**. The desired test of the organization's perimeter security mitigation **230** is characterized by pre-attack notification information regarding the parameters of the test to be conducted. Parameters can include, but are not limited to one or more types of attacks to be launched, when each type of attack will be launched, and parameters of each type of attack such as begin time, end time, amount, size, speed, repetition, location, and the like. Typically, the monitor controller **200** sends the pre-attack notification information to all appropriate devices, normally the monitor controller **200**, the simulator controller **204**, and the coordination device **220**. Subsequently, the monitor controller **200** sends the appropriate information to the monitors **202** to monitor the test/change monitoring frequency, the coordination device **220** sends the appropriate information to the coordination agents **222** to monitor the test/change monitoring frequency, and the simulator controller **204** sends appropriate information to configure appropriate simulators **206** to be prepared to generate the non-disruptive perimeter security testing attack.

(149) When the monitor controller **200** deems the target (for example, mail service **124C**, coordination device **220**, or web service **124A**) is stable, the monitor controller **200** will signal to the simulator controller **204** to begin sending traffic towards the internal network **120**. The simulator controller **204** will signal to simulators **206** to begin sending traffic according to the specification (pre-attack notification information) previously sent by the simulator controller **204**.

(150) During the time that the simulators **206** are sending traffic towards the internal network **120**, if the monitor controller **200** detects any stability issues with the monitored services **124** or coordination device **200**, the monitor controller **200** can make the decision to alter or stop the simulators' **206** traffic. This can be done by signaling from the monitor controller **200** to the simulator controller **204**. In turn, the simulator controller **204** notifies the simulators to alter or stop

the traffic being generated by one or more simulators **206**. An alternative setup may be that the monitor controller **200** may signal directly to the simulators **206** directly to start or stop the perimeter security (simulated) testing attacks.

(151) The simulators **206** may also stop sending traffic if signaling is lost between one or more simulators **206** and the simulator controller **204**. The simulators **206** have the ability to terminate sending traffic autonomously. For example, in a case where signaling is lost between simulator-A **206A** and the simulator controller **204**, simulator-A **206A** can make a decision, independent of other system devices, to terminate sending traffic.

(152) Generating Baselines

(153) Monitors **202** send traffic probes through the perimeter security (mitigation) system (PSS) **230** (for example, via the ESS **109**, the router **106**, and/or the other perimeter security (mitigation) devices (components) **250, 252, 254, 256**) to services **124**. The probes facilitate verification of response rates both when the simulators **206** are generating traffic and when the simulators **206** are not generating traffic (idle). Using this method, the monitor controller **200** knows what a normal/healthy response rate from services **124** and an unstable/unhealthy response rate from services **124** looks like. In other words, the monitors **202** can use probes to characterize the normal, stable, operational, defending, unstable, and crippled status of the internal network **120** and/or services **124**. Monitor controller **200** utilizes monitors **202** to create baselines to understand and differentiate between normal responses and unstable/unhealthy responses.

(154) A current baseline is one piece of data that allows the monitor controller **200** to make decisions since the baselines are determined prior to testing (adjusted with previous monitoring, using operation data from either coordination agents **222** or monitors **202**) ranges of stability/health levels. Decisions made by the monitor controller **200** could cause signaling to occur to the simulator controller **204**, the monitors **202**, or the coordination device **220**. Baselines are normally stored on the monitor controller **200**. Baselines can indicate one or more services **124** are currently unstable or down (unavailable). Baselines are a constantly updated running average or some other measurement used to be able to identify current normal (stable/healthy) service **124** statuses and also be able to identify current abnormal (unstable/unhealthy) service **124** statuses. Multiple baselines may be created for a single service, for example ICMP response time per minute, per hour, per day or per week. Baselines are then utilized to understand if a service has become unstable based on how far the response time has deviated from the response time's normal/stable threshold. For example, if the normal baseline for ICMP response (for a particular monitored target) prior to a non-disruptive DDoS test being performed is 100 milliseconds (regardless at which monitoring frequency the response threshold was recorded at) and then the non-disruptive DDoS testing attack starts against the target and the baseline (preferably under a high level of monitoring frequency e.g. 3 seconds) changes to an ICMP response time of 200 milliseconds, the response threshold may be deemed to have deviated enough to now be considered that the current monitored ICMP response time is over the threshold of unstable and therefore the monitored service **124** is considered in an unstable state. Baselines are created both for monitors **202** data and the coordination agent's **222** data, just with coordination data the baseline being created is more for system specific information (e.g., TCP stack usage, free memory, possess information, and the like).

(155) Testing Against the Coordination Device

(156) Referring also to FIG. **1**, an optional use case where the example is described below in which the simulators **206** first validate various perimeter security attack traffic against the coordination device **220**. After the simulators **206** have finished perimeter security attack testing without an unstable/downed state being detected by the monitor controller **200** (with information gathered from monitors **202**), then verification (attack test) takes place against production services **124** (for example **124A, 124C**). This case includes the following steps: 1. Simulator controller **206** launches perimeter security attack traffic via simulators **206** against the coordination device **220** on the

internal network **120**. The coordination device **220** is validated against that particular attack (for example, a web attack with malicious payload). 2. Based on settings for the testing service, if the coordination device **220** is protected (the coordination device **220** settings are dynamic), then simulator controller **204** will signal to the simulators **206** to launch attacks directly against the production servers (for example, web server **126A** and corresponding web service **124A**). 3. The attacks are performed with simulator controller **204** settings (as per the pre-attack notification information), including such parameters as type of perimeter security attack traffic, rate of the attack traffic, iterations, and time to run. The simulator controller **204** may get its settings from the monitor controller **200** or any other similar configurations setting device. 4. During the time the production server (in this example web server **126A**) is being tested by the simulators **206** all traffic is monitored by the coordination device **220**. The traffic can be monitored because all traffic in the internal subnet **120** has been mirrored to the coordination device(s) **220**. 5. If the production service (for example web service **124A**) or any other server (other than web server **126A**, based on monitor controller **200** settings) are deemed to be in an unhealthy status, i.e., response time slowed down on the monitor controller **200** baselines (i.e., the response time is now at an unhealthy threshold), or coordination agent **222A** (which updated coordination device **220**, which updated the monitor controller **200**) baselines, have deviated to unhealthy, the attack may be stopped (by the appropriate simulators **206**) and the relevant threat status assigned. 6. A similar process as the above-described takes place for each type of attack run, first against the coordination device **220** and then against the actual production server (for example web server **126A**). The perimeter security testing service can also be configured to refrain from testing (not perform testing/attacks).

Testing Via an ESS (External Security Service)

(157) Also in FIG. **1**, another example use case is now described in which the testing is done using the ESS **109**. The simulator controller **204** signals simulators **206** to generate traffic to the internal network **120** via the ESS **109**. As in the previously described cases, traffic may be sent first to the coordination device **220** and baselines generated. This case includes the following steps: 1. Simulator controller **204** signals to simulators **206** to launch perimeter security attack traffic targeting a production target **126** or **124**, with all traffic sent via the ESS **109**. 2. One or more, typically all, production servers (for example, web server **126A**) are monitored at a rapid rate by the monitors **202** similar to other tests (cases). Any unstable status detected by the monitor controller **200** may lead to termination of the generation of test traffic by the simulators **206**. 3. Checking of the production servers can be done one at a time (serially) or more than one simultaneously (in parallel). 4. Alternatively, the coordination device **220** can be validated by a simulation prior a production target **126**, **124** being validated. If no instability is detected when checking the coordination device **220** the monitor controller **200** would continue on to validate production targets **124**, **126**. 5. For the decision making process of if the attacked service (for example web service **124A**) is vulnerable or protected, the traffic sent from the simulators **206** can be sent via an ESS **109** or directly to the organization's internal network **120** (via the router **106**).

Continuous Monitoring

(158) Refer now to FIG. **2**, a flowchart of a method for the monitor controller **200** to continuously monitor input IP (internet protocol) addresses (also referred to simply as “IPs”) and fully qualified domain names (or referred to simply as “FQDNs”) in a registry of the monitor controller **200**.

(159) The IPs and FQDNs are normally production servers on which actual production services or the coordination device **220** service are running on the internal network **120** at the organization's site. If the perimeter security (mitigation) system (PSS) **230** is successful (sufficiently effective) the IPs and FQDNs should not be affected during testing (during an attack simulation). The monitoring cycle on the monitors **202** of the current figure can be sped up (increased) and slowed down (decreased) depending on whether there is a perimeter security test ongoing (an active test). For example, without a test ongoing a query every 20 or 30 seconds may be sufficient to monitor the services and create a healthy system baseline in the organization during normal operation.

However, while a test is being performed the monitor controller **200** may instruct the monitors **202** to increase the monitoring cycle to be, for example, every 1 second to reduce the likelihood of any adverse effects on the production environment by detecting a deviation from the normal healthy baseline as quickly as possible. Depending on the requirements of the organization and configuration of the perimeter security testing service, the monitor controller **200** can decide how to handle the messages (information being returned by the monitors **202**). The monitoring cycle is also referred to as “monitoring frequency” or simply “frequency”. As monitoring is typically done using probes, the monitoring cycle is also referred to as “probe frequency”. An increase in the monitoring cycle corresponds to a higher (quicker) frequency, and similarly a decrease is a lower (slower) frequency.

(160) In step **300** (“steps” may also be referred to as “blocks” herein), the monitor controller **200** receives IPs and FQDNs to be monitored during a scheduled test (pre-planned attack) to monitor, or, ongoing monitoring (to continually update the baseline) without a scheduled attack. First, a baseline of normal response for at least one network service (for example HTTP GET response) on at least one IP and/or FQDN is generated (in the setup and ongoing phases). In step **302**, the monitoring frequency is adjusted to an appropriate current frequency (of whether or not an attack is active or about to be active/inactive). As described above, if an attack simulation is about to take place, the monitoring frequency will be increased from a relatively lower frequency used during normal operation (for example, every 20 or 30 seconds) to a relatively higher frequency used during testing (for example, every 3 seconds). This increase in frequency during testing helps to avoid a delay in understanding if the system under test has become unstable. Optionally, one or more coordination agents **222** can be updated to speed up monitoring. In step **304**, the monitor controller **200** initiates sending probes to the IPs and FQDNs at the relevant current frequency set in step **302**. For example, the monitor controller **200** controls one or more monitors **202** to send probes to the targeted servers. Types of probes include, but are not limited to “HTTP GET”, ping, and other known probes. In step **306**, a baseline is created and/or updated using the information received from monitors **202**. Examination of the baseline can be used to see if the target is healthy or unhealthy (service availability of production servers **124** adversely affected or not) or has become unhealthy for the particular service (network service) being monitored. In step **308**, the current baseline is evaluated to understand if the current baseline is healthy or unhealthy. In step **310**, regardless of the health status of the target being monitored, the current health status is reported to the monitor controller **200** and the simulator controller **204**. Then monitoring continues by returning to step **302** and adjusting the monitoring frequency, as necessary and continues updating the baselines with information from the monitors **202**. In step **310** the monitor controller **200** could alternatively signal the simulator controller **204** to terminate ongoing non-disruptive DDoS attack testing on the simulators **206**. In step **300** other monitoring commands may be received by the monitor controller for example, adding/removing new IPs or FQDNs, starting/stopping service monitoring etc.

(161) As also described in this document, an alternative method of operation has the monitor controller **200** shutdown the simulators **206** by signaling the simulator controller **204**. The shutdown may be necessary if the destination services **124** being monitored (by monitors **202**) are continuously deemed unhealthy or unstable.

(162) Checking Status and Decision to Continue Testing

(163) In FIG. 3, a flowchart of a method for checking status and deciding to continue testing. In step **400**, the simulator controller **204** receives the perimeter security attack simulation parameters to use for the relevant perimeter test (pre-attack notification information). In step **402**, the monitor controller **200** is queried to validate system health status. The answer to this query in combination with various administrator-defined settings will decide if the perimeter security simulation (testing attack) will proceed, however preferably the monitor controller **200** will signal the simulator controller **204** to continue or terminate the ongoing non-disruptive perimeter security testing attack.

If the attack will not proceed, the method continues at step **410** and the test is ended (in this branch, before the test even began). If the attack will proceed, the method continues in step **404** to configure the necessary simulators **206**. Configuring the simulators **206** includes for each one or more simulators **206** sending appropriate pre-attack information (pre-attack notification information), preparing, and making ready to launch the perimeter security simulation attacks. After the simulators **206** are configured and prepared, then in step **406** perimeter security attack testing is started (at this point the coordination device **220** and/or the coordination agents **222**, the monitor controller **200**, have already been updated with pre-attack notification information). (164) During testing (shown as box **407**) in step **408** the monitor controller **200** is checked for a change in system health status. The simulator controller **204** can also receive updates from or query the monitor controller **200** and can be used in step **408** to make a decision regarding system health. If the system health (health of the service **124** and/or servers such as web server **126A**) is unacceptable (not healthy/unstable) and/or there is insufficient communication between components (communications are inactive or crippled between monitor controller **200** and simulator controller **204**), the method continues to step **410** and the test is ended. This is another fail-safe mechanism to avoid downtime during non-disruptive testing, including, for example, DDoS testing. In contrast, if the system health (health of the services **124** and/or servers such as web server **126A**) is acceptable (healthy/stable) and there is communication between components (communications are active between monitor controller **200** and simulator controller **204**), the method continues to step **412** and testing continues. In step **414**, a check is made if the pre-arranged tests (based on the pre-attack configuration information) are finished. If the tests are finished, the method continues to step **410** and the test is ended. If the tests are not finished, the method continues and returns to step **408**. Either way, (from either step **408** or step **414**) at step **410** when the test is ended, the testing results are recorded for use by the administrator, for example for reporting and to view through a user interface.

(165) A similar procedure is performed by the Monitor Controller **200**. Diagnostic Testing Monitors **240A-240N**, and one or more simulators **206**, when the health/stability of the target is monitored in association with a diagnostic test.

(166) Interaction of Perimeter Security Testing Service Elements During a Simulated Attack

(167) FIG. **4** is based on the topology of FIG. **1**. FIG. **4** is a simplified diagram showing interaction of perimeter security testing service elements (devices or components of the PSS), shows a basic configuration of how the monitor controller **200** on the external network (Internet **100**) and the coordination device **220** or one of the production servers **126**, such as web server **126A**, interact with each other, for example, during a simulated attack, subject to mitigation by the perimeter security system **230** and/or the perimeter security devices (components) **109**, **250**, **252**, **254**, **256**. In general, results from the coordination device **220** are sent to the monitor controller **200** for further processing and reporting.

(168) As described elsewhere in this document, simulators **206** send simulated perimeter security attacks **502** against the internal network **120**, to components such as the coordination device **220**, or services **124** on production machines, for example, production servers **126**. Simulators **206** may be able to read some of the perimeter security attack traffic responses, this can be used to understand more about how that particular attack traffic is being mitigated, or not mitigated). Optional storage **501**, respectively on the simulators **206** may be used to store data. The simulator controller **204** could also optionally have local storage data (not shown).

(169) Coordination agents **222**, such as coordination agent **222A**, typically report **509** to the coordination device **220**. Reporting is preferably as close to real-time as possible (during non-disruptive perimeter security attack testing), and sent to the monitor controller **200** for updating the particular coordination agent's **222A** baseline.

(170) The coordination device **220** stores results from tests **510** in a local coordinator device storage **506** during testing. After each perimeter security attack (from the simulators **206**), the data

gathered on the coordination devices storage **506** is sent to the monitor controller **200** for analysis and decision-making (for example was the perimeter security attack test successful or not). Regardless of success or not, if another non-disruptive perimeter security attack test takes place, the pre-attack information (transmitted from the monitor controller **200** to the coordination device **220**) needs to be initiated once again.

(171) Monitors **202** send requests (for example HTTP GET) and receive responses (HTTP response). For example, this is how health (stability) baselines are created for a particular service e.g., web service **124A**, being monitored for a particular server, e.g., web server **126A**, in the production network **120**. Baselines for both monitors **202** and coordination agents **222** can be stored and updated on the monitor controller storage **508**. When needed, the monitor controller storage **508** is queried to get the necessary data for decision-making (for example stopping an ongoing perimeter security attack test). In another example, if a perimeter security attack test is ongoing, and simulators **206** are sending (simulated) attack traffic **502** the monitor controller **200** may use all the latest data gathered from the coordination agents **222** (e.g. coordination agent **222B** collected data on current CPU utilization, memory utilization etc. of the DNS node **124B**) and also the latest data gathered from the monitors **202** (for example DNS query/response time is X ms) and make a decision on whether or not to inform the simulator controller **204** to tell the simulators **206** to stop the perimeter security attack testing traffic currently being generated to production node **124B**.

(172) Perimeter security attack test results are sent **512** from the coordination device **220** to the monitor controller **200**. Gathered data results can include from operation data from coordination agents **222** and/or the coordination device **220**, either before, during, or after an attack (test).

(173) The monitor controller **200** can inform **518** the system regarding new tests, send pre-attack information, pre-diagnostic information, update configurations, and send updated operation information (for example to adjust settings, increase monitor cycle time of coordination agents **222** or the coordination device **220**) during perimeter security attack testing or diagnostic testing. The monitor controller **200** can also send commands **520** to the API controller **242** to remediate any identified vulnerabilities in the perimeter security system **230**. The commands, once at the API controller **242**, are sent by the API controller **242** to the perimeter security system **230** to remediate the identified vulnerabilities **522**. Once the commands reach the perimeter security system **230**, the vulnerabilities in the identified vulnerable components are remediated **524**.

(174) Both simulators **206** perimeter security attack test traffic data (if any and if enabled for analyzing potential mitigation mechanisms in place (e.g., SYN cookie challenge) and monitors **202** store results, for example monitors **202** store on respective result storage **507**, and simulator controller **204** may also include storage (not shown).

(175) The monitor controller **200** controls communication and signaling to and from monitors **202** and diagnostic monitors **240**. Additionally, the monitor controller **200** collects information and operation data originating from diagnostic monitors **240A-240N**, previously received and/or generated on the co-ordination device **220**.

(176) Results can be sent **514** to a reporting engine, for example at pre-determined times, as per the pre-attack configuration, or upon administrator requests via a user interface. Processing of results takes place on the monitor controller **204** or at another location, such as another element doing reporting for the organization **516**.

(177) Interaction of Simulator Controller and Simulators

(178) Refer now to FIG. 5, a diagram of interaction between the simulator controller **204** and the simulators **206**. The simulator controller **204** and the simulators **206** initiate attack traffic generation from various locations around the world. This is done by starting (initiated by the simulator controller **204**) one or simulators **206** in various physical locations, for example, Simulator A **206A** in the US, Simulator B **206B** in London, Simulator C **206C** in Ireland, and, Simulator D **206D** in the US. The simulators **206** are configured and controlled by the simulator

controller **204** based on at least the pre-attack configuration information. If any of the simulators **206** are in the middle of a attack test generating traffic, and lose communication with the simulator controller **204**, then preferably the simulator that has lost communication terminates generation of attack testing traffic. This termination is independent, in other words the simulator that has lost communication terminates attack testing traffic generation autonomously. That is, the specific simulator (such as Simulator A **206A**) of the simulators **206** that has lost communication with the simulator controller **204** can terminate the attack test traffic with an independent decision not requiring communication with the simulator controller **204**.

(179) Using multiple locations (geographically dispersed) for attack test simulators **206** is helpful due to the fact that attack mitigation systems may take into account the geographic location of source traffic and make mitigation decisions based on this geographic location.

(180) The simulator controller **204** is typically used for decision-making and orchestration of the attack testing simulators **206**. The simulator controller **204** can receive and send signals and updates from and to the monitor controller **200**, the simulators **206**, and the coordination device **220**.

(181) Interaction of Monitor Controller and Monitors

(182) Referring now to FIG. 6A, a diagram of interaction between the monitor controller **200** and the monitors **202**, for attack testing traffic, and **240** for diagnostic testing traffic. The monitor controller **200** controls one or more of the monitors **202**, **240** in various locations around the world or diagnostic monitors **240**. For example, monitor-A **202A** in the US, monitor-B **202B** in London, monitor-C **202C** in Ireland, and monitor-D **202D** in the US. This would also hold for monitors **240a-240n**, associated with the diagnostic testing traffic. Distributing the monitors **202**, facilitates the monitor controller **200** creating accurate baselines. Because of the nature of perimeter security mitigation systems, monitoring during attack testing from monitors **202**, from multiple locations, is important, and may be necessary to create accurate system status baselines, as well as real-time perimeter security attack termination decision-making. For example, if monitoring were to be setup only from London, and the particular perimeter security mitigation system being tested only allows clientele from the US and China to access the organization (internal network **120**/services **124**), then an incorrect baseline could be generated. In the example, as the perimeter security mitigation system does not allow connectivity from the geographic area of the monitor, probes from the monitor in London **206B** would be blocked by the perimeter security mitigation system **230**, the London monitor **202B** would fail to respond, and an incorrect baseline may be generated. Another example may be that the non-disruptive perimeter security testing system knows that during normal time (a time when perimeter security testing is not being run) all monitor locations are stable (e.g., US, Europe, Asia). However, when under an HTTP flood (a perimeter security test), because of various perimeter security mitigation **230** mechanisms triggering (and previously seen in other perimeter security testing performed), monitors **202** in the US may move to an unhealthy/unstable status (because of the triggered perimeter security mitigation **230** mechanism) but other monitors (other than in the US) continue to be in a stable state. This would likely result in a decision being made to terminate the ongoing perimeter security attack traffic on the simulators **206**. However, because this behavior was expected, the perimeter security testing system can be configured to continue the perimeter security testing until completion and not have a terminate action sent to the simulators **206**.

(183) The monitor controller **200** has a bidirectional communication channel with the monitors **202**, **240**. The monitors **202**, **240** can send and receive data from the monitor controller **200**. The monitor controller **200** can send and receive data from monitors **202**, **240**, coordination device **220**, and the simulator controller **204**. As with the simulators **206**, the monitors **202**, **240** may be configured to stop generating requests towards the monitored services (for example service **124A**) if communication with the monitor controller **200** is lost. This decision of a monitor (for example, monitor-A **202A** of the monitors **202**) can be made independently by the monitor **202** (in this

example monitor-A 202A).

(184) Interaction of API Controller **242** and Components

(185) Referring now to FIG. **6B**, a diagram of interaction between the monitor controller **200** and the API controller **242**. The API controller **242**, interacts, either directly or indirectly with components including, for example, the perimeter security devices **109, 250, 252, 254, 256**, services **124** and production servers **126**.

(186) FIG. **7** is a high-level partial block diagram of an exemplary system **600** configured to implement the coordination device **220** of the present invention. System (processing system) **600** includes a processor **602** (one or more) and four exemplary memory devices: a RAM **604**, a boot ROM **606**, a mass storage device (hard disk) **608**, and a flash memory **610**, all communicating via a common bus **612**. As is known in the art, processing and memory can include any computer readable medium storing software and/or firmware and/or any hardware element(s) including but not limited to field programmable logic array (FPLA) element(s), hard-wired logic element(s), field programmable gate array (FPGA) element(s), and application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC) element(s). Any instruction set architecture may be used in processor **602** including but not limited to reduced instruction set computer (RISC) architecture and/or complex instruction set computer (CISC) architecture. A module (processing module) **614** is shown on mass storage **608**, for example, and could be located on any of the memory devices.

(187) Mass storage device **608** is a non-limiting example of a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium bearing computer-readable code for implementing the testing methodology described herein. Other examples of such computer-readable storage media include read-only memories such as CDs bearing such code.

(188) The system **600** may have an operating system stored on the memory devices, the ROM may include boot code for the system, and the processor may be configured for executing the boot code to load the operating system to RAM **604**, executing the operating system to copy computer-readable code to RAM **604** and execute the code.

(189) Network connection **620** provides communications to and from system **600**. Typically, a single network connection provides one or more links, including virtual connections, to other devices on local and/or remote networks. Alternatively, system **600** can include more than one network connection (not shown), each network connection providing one or more links to other devices and/or networks.

(190) The system **600** can be implemented as a server or client respectively connected through a network to a client or server.

(191) Turning to FIG. **8**, the environment shown in FIG. **1** is usable in describing a diagnostic procedure (diagnostic testing procedure, diagnostic test, or diagnostic). The diagnostic procedure is used, for example, to determine operation of the mirror port (MP) **221**, and the extent to which the mirror port **221** is operating. The extent to which the mirror port **221** is operating, should be known, in order to avoid false negatives. In the event the mirror port is not operating at all, or operating at a very limited capacity, such as receiving no or partial traffic, simulated packets sent from simulators **206A-206N**, which reached a production target **126** may not have been detected at the mirror port **221**, even though they may have not been blocked, i.e., successfully penetrated security ring of the upstream of one or more of the perimeter security devices **109, 250, 252, 254, 256**. This results in a false negative determined by the monitor controller **200**. Such a false negative may result in damage to a production server **126A-126D** by real malicious or unwanted traffic.

(192) An attack simulation (for example, of simulated attack traffic, validation, emulated attack, simulation, simulated attack, attack), includes but is not limited to, attack traffic of DDoS Attacks, web based attacks (e.g., SQL injections, Non-SQL injections, cross site scripting, fuzzing, version enumeration, dictionary based attacks, and the like), other brute force attacks, phishing attacks, website scraping, service scanning, host scanning, sending malicious files, exploits or data payloads, disallowed IP address or FQDN sources towards production servers and or services or

towards other areas of the Internal network **120**, which are expected to be mitigated by either one or more modules in the perimeter security devices **109, 250, 252, 254, 256**.

(193) The diagnostic procedure begins at START block **1002**, where, the start of the attack simulation, is waiting to take place. Alternatively, another reason, to perform a diagnostic check, is for example, for the overall system, a particular component, may want to evaluate the stability of mirror ports **221** in the system at different points at some time, during which the general system is running. The process moves to block **1004**, when the monitor controller **200** receives pre-diagnostic notification information including, for example, parameters as to diagnostic traffic (e.g., source IPs diagnostic nodes, DST IP, number of connections, start time, stop time, format to aggregate etc.), which the diagnostic monitor **240A** and/or monitor **202A** sends to the coordination device **220**.

(194) At block **1006**, the diagnostic monitor **240A** or monitor **202A** (or one or more monitors **240A-240N, 202A-202N** and/or diagnostic node(s)) sends designated legitimate traffic to a target, e.g., a production server **126**, in the internal network **120**, for example, the target protected by perimeter protection devices or components, i.e., of the PSS **230**) in accordance with the pre-diagnostic notification information.

(195) The process, typically in parallel, moves to block **1008**, where the target is monitored for health, for example, by the monitor controller **200**, analyzing request and return response times between a monitor and the target being within predetermined acceptable limits. Should a monitored time be outside of the acceptable limits, and therefore, not healthy, at block **1010**, the process moves to block **1012**, where the diagnostic testing ends. The actual ending is, for example, immediately after an unhealthy status for the target has been determined. This allows for operational traffic to continue without impacting the service level or creating any type of response slowdown or down time of the target. While this process is shown at this particular time, monitoring for target health can and most likely will occur anywhere and at most times along the process.

(196) Returning to block **1010**, should the target be healthy, the process moves to block **1014**. At block **1014**, the monitor controller **200**, at a predetermined time after the diagnostic (legitimate) packet traffic was sent (the time of the sending being known from the pre-diagnostic notification information sent by the monitor controller **200**), for example, on the order of milliseconds, but not longer than the order of seconds, the mirror port(s) **221** or agent (s) **222** send(s) packets and packet data (data in the packets) to the coordination device(s) **220**. The coordination device(s) **220** processes and formats the mirrored data in accordance with the pre-diagnostic information. It is possible that mirror port(s) may have been sending from the start of **1002** to the coordination device **220** in order to not lose any data, though only the packets or data in packets specified in the pre-diagnostic notification at block **1004** will be analyzed at block **1014**.

(197) The process moves to block **1016**, where the coordination device **220** reports (transmits) the processed and formatted data to the monitor controller **200**. The process moves to block **1018**, where the monitor controller **200** analyzes the diagnostic data, and determines whether the respective mirror port (MP) **221** or agent **222** is working (e.g., operational). If the determination is that the mirror port **221** is not working, the process moves to block **1012**, where it ends. However, If the determination is that the mirror port **221** is working, the process moves to block **1020**.

(198) Optionally, the process may now move to block **1020**, where the monitor controller **200** determines the extent to which the mirror port **221** or agent **222** is operational or working. Should this determination not be desired, the process moves to block **1022**, where the monitor controller **200** determines whether the diagnostic testing procedure is finished. If yes, at block **1022**, the process moves to block **1012**, where the diagnostic testing ends. If no, at block **1022**, the process moves to block **1004**, from where it resumes as detailed above.

(199) Returning to block **1020**, the extent to which the mirror port (MP) **221** is working can be analyzed. This analysis occurs, for example, at block **1024**. For example, from the input received

from the mirror port **221**, corresponding to a time and specific diagnostic packet traffic sent, as a number of packets that were mirrored from this traffic is determined. This number of mirrored packets is compared against the number of packets sent in the corresponding diagnostic traffic, this number of packets provided by the monitor controller **200**. The difference between the numbers is the extent or percentage at which the mirror port **221** is operating. For example, it may be, that if during a diagnostic check, 100 packets were sent from monitor **202A** towards production server **126A**, and the coordination device **220** received 80 packets from its attached mirror port **221**, it may be determined that the mirror port **221** is operating at 80% reliability.

(200) Returning to block **1020**, should it be desired perform a further data inspection to see the extent the mirror port is working, the process moves to block **1024**. At block **1024**, an extended diagnostic may be run in accordance with these subprocesses. In the extended diagnostic, the subprocesses of blocks **1004** and **1016** are run for times on the order of minutes, to look at the extent of the operations by the mirror ports **221** over a longer time period, than the regular diagnostic. From block **1024**, the process moves to block **1022**, where it resumes as detailed above.

(201) The aforementioned diagnostic tests are run during normal operation of the target, and the target remains on-line and functional to regular traffic during the diagnostic testing. There are typically not any cut-off commands (stopping such diagnostic test) sent for deviation of normal baselines or other system reasons during or just before such diagnostic tests. Accordingly, the target need not be down during the time the diagnostic testing is occurring.

(202) FIG. **9** shows a system set up for validating multiple profiles at a single time, by looking at the depth an attack penetrates (e.g., downstream depth of penetration of an attack) across multiple technologies or security protections otherwise known as security rings, i.e., each mirror port (MP) **221** or a combination of mirror ports **221** (e.g., **221a-221f**) may be construed as a security ring, e.g., firewall **252** is the inner security ring and the ESS **109** is the outer security ring. Through validating multiple security rings at the same time (or at different times), the depth of an attack penetrating from the internet **100** through to the internal target **126** can be known. For example, this is one way of understanding the depth of an SQL attack targeting a target **126** penetrated the outer and inner security ring, all the way up to, and even beyond, the IPS **256**. Here, the Internal Network **120** and partially into the external network **100**, is configured such that a mirror port **221a** to **221f** is positioned between each of the perimeter security devices or components (of the PSS **230**, as shown in the broken line box) **109**, **250**, **252**, **254** and **256**, with each corresponding mirror port **221a-221f** linked to the coordination device **220**, or alternately different, e.g., multiple, coordination devices (not shown). The coordination device(s) **220** communicate with the monitor controller **200**. After an attack simulation has been completed by simulator(s) **206**, the depth of penetration would be known based on what traffic each of the mirror ports **221** captured from the origination attack traffic just after each security component deployed, for example, based on the position of the respective mirror port **221a-221f**. For example, If the attack traffic was identified to have bypassed ESS **109** and DDoS CPE **250** and Firewall **252** but no attack traffic was identified at the WAF **254** or IPS **256**, then the rings of ESS AND DDoS CPE and Firewall security rings can be concluded to be vulnerable, and the WAF and IPS protected, i.e., the depth of penetration is up to and until the WAF **254**.

(203) The mirror ports **221a-221f** may be for example, span ports, tap ports or any other component which makes and provides a copy of the through-passing traffic, to the coordination device(s) **220**. Additionally, the coordination device **220** can obtain logs from a log management system or coordination agent **222A**. Based on the log information gathered, monitor controller **200** can change diagnostic test results or simulation results (e.g., simulated attacked, discussed in FIGS. **11** and **12**), which were run previously or currently running. This log information may be gathered by the coordination device **220**, sent to the monitor controller, or via the API controller **242**, sent to the monitor controller **200**. With log information gathered and processed, the API controller **242** or other processes detailed herein may be triggered. For example, updating via the API controller **242**

the ESS **109** and the other the perimeter security devices **250, 252, 254, 256**, and/or the target servers (e.g., one or more of the production servers **126**) via the respective coordination agent (CA) **222**, as detailed below.

(204) The traffic used for the aforementioned depth (depth of penetration into the internal network and/or PSS **230**) analysis is for example, monitor traffic, sent from one or more of the monitors **202A-202N**, as discussed above, intended for one or more of the production servers **126**.

Alternatively, the traffic used may be from simulated attack traffic originating from simulators **206A-206N** toward the internal network **120** service or node.

(205) In FIG. **10A**, a flow diagram of the process for multiple profile analysis is shown for operation of the system of FIG. **9**. At a START block **1202**, the type of attack traffic is selected along with the simulation attack to a target using the attack traffic, that will be run. At block **1204**, pre-attack information is sent from the monitor controller **200** to the coordination device **220**, providing the details of the attack and the attack traffic. Also, the pre-attack information typically includes queries, requests, and the like, as to aspects, features, and the like, as to the mirrored traffic, that are to be watched and/or examined in the mirrored traffic by the coordination device(s) **220**, and reported by the coordination device(s) **220** to the monitor controller **200**.

(206) The process moves to block **1206**, where an initial health check is made for the target, e.g., target production service **124** and/or production server **126**. The health check may be, for example, in accordance with the health check shown in FIG. **3** and its description above. Should the target be determined not to be healthy, the process moves to block **1208**, where it ends and the simulated attack does not proceed, or in some cases, even begin. However, at block **1206**, should the target be healthy, the process moves to block **1210**. At block **1210**, the attack traffic, e.g., simulated attack traffic, is sent destined for the target, for example a production server **126**, for example, from one or more simulators **206A-206N**, and at a predetermined time, on the order of milliseconds, but not usually longer than seconds, for example, 2 (two) seconds. During and or before the attack, the target is, for example, continuously monitored for health, at block **1212**, as the process moves from block **1210** to block **1212**.

(207) From block **1212**, the process moves to block **1214**, where the controller **200** determines whether the target is healthy, for example, by applying the health test to the target production server, as detailed for block **1206** above. Should the target not be healthy at block **1214**, the process moves to block **1216**, where it is determined whether the simulated attack should be altered or otherwise modified. If the attack should be altered at block **1216**, the process moves to block **1218**, where it is determined whether pre-attack information for the altered simulated attack is required, and accordingly, needs to be transmitted from the monitor controller **200** to the coordination device **220**.

(208) If yes at block **1218**, the process moves to block **1204**, from where the process resumes. If no at block **1218**, the process moves to block **1220**, where simulator **206A-206N** settings are altered. From block **1220**, the process moves to block **1210**, from where it resumes.

(209) Returning to block **1216**, should the attack not be altered or otherwise modified or changed, the process moves to block **1222**, where the simulated attack ends. From block **1222**, the process moves to block **1228**, from where it continues, as detailed below.

(210) Returning to block **1214**, should the target be determined to be healthy, the process moves to block **1224**, where the mirrored packets including packet data within the mirrored packets and data associated with these packets, is transmitted from all engaged mirror ports **221** during (and also just before) the simulated attack to the coordination device **220**. The process then moves to block **1226**, where it is determined whether the simulated attack is finished (e.g., complete). This is typically determined by waiting a predetermined time from the time the simulated attack was sent, the predetermined time on the order of milliseconds, and typically not later than the order of seconds, e.g., up to five seconds. Should the simulated attack not be complete or otherwise finished, the process returns to block **1212**, from where it resumes as discussed above. Should the simulated

attack be finished, the process moves to block **1228**.

(211) At block **1228** (also arrived at from block **1222**, as detailed above), the coordination device(s) **220** process the packets and the data therein and associated therewith, which was received (mirrored) from the mirror ports **221a-221e**. For example, the mirror ports **221a-221e**, continuously transmit their mirrored attack traffic, including, for example, the mirrored packets and data associated with the mirrored packets, to the coordination device **220**. While the coordination device **220** shown is typically a single coordination device, it may also be divided into multiple components, or may be multiple coordination devices working simultaneously together. The processing by the coordination device **220** is for data referenced in the pre-attack information, for example, data mirrored at a certain time corresponding to the time of the simulated attack. The coordination device **220** then sends the processed data, requested in the pre-attack information, to the monitor controller **200**, at block **1230**.

(212) The process moves to block **1232**, where the received processed data is analyzed by the monitor controller **200**, to determine whether or not it is present. The process moves to block **1234**, where the monitor controller **200** determines actions to be taken and/or reports to be made, based on the presence or absence of the processed data. These actions and/or reports may be made based on determined conditions as to the ESS **109** and the other perimeter security devices **250, 252, 254, 256**, such as security vulnerabilities, operations of these security devices working or not working, the depth of penetration for the simulated attack (e.g., how far the simulated attack penetrated from the internet **100**, through the internal network **120**, and to what extent from the perimeter security devices **109, 250, 252, 254, 256** are working), and the like.

(213) The process moves to block **1236**, where, for example, the monitor controller **200** determines whether another simulated attack should be made on the same or another target on the internal network **120**. If yes, the process moves to block **1204**, from where it resumes, as detailed above, as another simulated attack on the same or another target of the internal network **120** is made. If no, at block **1236**, another simulated attack is not made, and the process ends at block **1238**.

(214) FIG. **10B**, shows a process performed, for example, after the process of FIG. **10A** has ended, and, for example, based on the system, e.g., monitor controller **200**, having determined that a vulnerability has been determined and/or action should be taken, as per block **1230**, which serves as the START block **1252**.

(215) The process moves to block **1254** where an initial health check is made for the target **126**. The health check may be, for example, in accordance with the health check shown in FIG. **3** and its description above. Should the target be determined not to be healthy, the process moves to block **1256**, where it ends and the security update does not proceed or occur.

(216) Should the target be healthy at block **1254**, the process moves to block **1258**, where based on the received data from the coordination device **220**, the monitor controller **200** determines the action to be taken to address the detected vulnerability to one or more of the perimeter security devices **109, 250, 252, 254, 256**, and/or on the target itself through an agent **222**, to either mitigate or improve the deployed security services designed to protect the target or its services in the system. This protection may, for example, include either mitigating or improving (via the API) the deployed security services designed to protect the target or its services.

(217) Moving to block **1260**, the monitor controller **200** may send updates via the API controller **242** or similar channel with configuration changes to otherwise change the settings of the required specific security service or external log service. The API controller **242** may trigger any part of the overall system described herein to again simulate, reapply configuration based on the monitor controller **200**, additional API updates or otherwise recheck certain aspects of the target or, for example, its associated ESS **109**, perimeter or host security on the target itself.

(218) The process moves to block **1262**, where it is determined whether the update API was successful. If no, the process moves to block **1264**, where the update is retried. If successful at block **1264**, the process moves to block **1270**, where the log is retried, and the process returns to

block **1254**, from where it resumes.

(219) Returning to block **1264**, if the update retry fails, a log entry of FAILED is made at block **1268**. From block **1268**, the process moves to block **1278**, where the process ends.

(220) Returning to block **1262**, should the API update have been successful, the process moves to block **1266**. At block **1266**, it is determined whether the target being monitored is healthy, for example, using the test detailed for FIG. **3** above. If the target is not healthy, at block **1266**, the process moves to block **1272**, where the perimeter security devices **109**, **250**, **252**, **254**, **256**, and/or agents **222** associated optionally therewith, are updated with a new update, removing all previous changes. The process then moves to block **1274**. The process also moves from block **1266** to block **1274** if the target is healthy, at block **1266**.

(221) At block **1274**, a log success message is issued to a logging system, indicating, for example that the API controller **242** successfully completed the transaction and potentially additional information on the type of update. The process then moves to block **1276**, where the update API is now successfully completed. The process moves to block **1278**, where it ends, and may be repeated if desired.

(222) FIGS. **11** and **12** are directed to detecting security profiles across the entire PSS, and, for example, using the detected security profiles to determine when an attack stopped, where it was stopped, what security device or service stopped it, as well as the path the attack traveled, and what security devices were bypassed along the path. These inquiries can be determined by analyzing the data, e.g., operation data, received by the respective coordination devices **220** from the respective mirror ports **221**.

(223) In FIG. **11**, two mirror ports (MP) **221a**, **221b**, that transmit mirrored traffic to a coordination device **220** are positioned along separate channels of the Internet **100**, between an ESS **109a** (part of the PSS **230**) for respective Internet Service Provider (ISP1) and a router and between an ESS **109b** (part of the PSS **230**) for respective Internet Service Provider (ISP2) and a router (R) **106**, at the edge (e.g., perimeter) of the internal Network **120**. In FIG. **11**, the PSS **230** is shown in the broken line box. Also, in FIG. **11** (and also FIG. **14**) the separate pathways from the respective ISP (ISP1, ISP2) to the router **106**, from the respective ESS **109a**, **109b** includes network segments, with segments (of the respective pathway) between the respective ESS **109a**, **109b** and corresponding ISP1 and ISP2 being external network segments.

(224) For example, assuming simulated attack concludes vulnerability status for number of packets leaked and that the mirror ports (MP) **221a**, **221b** are operational. Should each mirror port (MP) **221a**, **221b** transmit at least a 30% threshold number of packets to the coordination device **220**, from a simulated attack in accordance with the pre-attack information, each ESS **109a**, **109b** may be considered to be vulnerable. If vulnerable to this specific attack, action is typically suggested to the ISP, or taken, such as by the ISP providing a patch at the respective ESS **109a** and **109b** to stop any future attack packet leakage.

(225) Alternately, in the example above, should zero, or less than the threshold packet amount get through each ESS **109a**, **109b**, the internal network **120** is considered protected.

(226) FIG. **12** shows a series of telecom providers (telco), such as Tier 1 providers, such as Verizon®, Sprint®, and the like, protecting an internal network **120** address space and the potential targets therein, such as that of a bank. Each Telco (e.g., an enterprise) is at a location (Locations **1-5**) along the Internet **100**, and each telco has one or more coordination devices **220** and mirror port (MP) **221** (**221-1**, **221-2**, **221-2a**, shown for example purposes) downstream from an ESS **109** (e.g., **109a**, **109b**, **109p**, **109q**, **109r**, **109s**, **109t**, **109u**, part of the PSS **230**) or other perimeter security devices **250**, **252**, **254**, **256** (of the PSS **230**). Each coordination device(s) **220** receives pre-attack information at approximately the same time, and, for example, simultaneously, from an upstream monitor controller **200**, which orchestrates the simulated attack from simulators **206**. Additionally, a diagnostic check may be also orchestrated by the monitor controller **200**, designed to validate the various mirror ports (MP) **221** connected to each respective coordination device(s) **220**, may be

performed in accordance with that described in FIG. 8 above.

(227) Each coordination device **220** of the Internal network **120** receives mirrored traffic from mirror ports **221a** and **221b** during the time of the simulated attack, and processes the mirrored traffic, such that the processed traffic corresponding to the traffic mirrored during the attack can be analyzed. For example, should the coordination device **220** have received zero or minimal (below a threshold) mirrored packet traffic during the attack, the attack may have traveled, such that this telco was bypassed or the attack was mitigated upstream to the Telco, depending on setup and additional coordination device results. Additionally, to further analyze for bypassing and routes in which traffic travels, the coordination devices **220** and/or the associated mirror ports (MPs) **221** may be turned on and off, to determine whether they are operable as detailed above, to further analyze packet traffic and the route the traffic traveled. The coordination devices **220** may also report to the monitor controller **200**, whether the simulated attack is just a single or few packets, e.g., SQL injection attempt against a web server **126A**, using this attack depth would be able to be determined.

(228) FIGS. **11** and **12** are setups are known as multi-homed or multi-route environments. A multi-homed environment is such that the network or server security device or defender may not know which protection system a particular attack from attackers **104** (A in FIG. **12**) may traverse when an attack is launched, therefore not knowing which ESS **109** or security service is responsible for mitigating the attack, malicious or otherwise unwanted traffic or packets. Using multiple coordination devices **220** and corresponding mirror ports **221**, allows multi-homed systems to be non-disruptively evaluated accurately by the validation method and also know where to remediate the various vulnerabilities based on leakage reporting from coordination devices **220**.

(229) FIG. **13** is another example of a multi homed environment. Here, the web server (WS) is separated into two web servers (WS) **126A1**, **126A2**. Each Internet Service Provider (ISP) **ISP1** and **ISP2** is at a different location, **ISP1** in New York, and **ISP2** in London. Each ISP has a coordination device **220a** (**220a-1**, **220a-2**), **220b** (**220b-1**, **220b-2**) and corresponding mirror port (MP) **221a** (**221a-1**, **221a-2**), **221b** (**221b-1**, **221b-2**) downstream from an ESS **109a**, **109b** (part of the PSS **230**, with the remainder of the PSS **230** including components **250**, **252**, **254**, **256**) or other perimeter security devices. Each coordination device **220a**, **220b** receives pre-attack information from an upstream monitor controller **200**, which controls the simulated attack. Each coordination device **220a**, **220b** receives mirrored traffic during the time of the attack, and processes the mirrored traffic, such that the processed traffic corresponding to the traffic mirrored during the attack can be analyzed. For example, should a coordination device **220a**, **220b** have received zero or minimal (below a threshold) mirrored packet traffic during the attack, the attack may have traveled, such that this Telco TC1, TC2 was bypassed. Additionally, to further analyze for bypassing and routes in which traffic travels, the coordination devices **220a**, **220b** may be turned on and off, to determine whether they are operable as detailed above, to further analyze packet traffic and how it travels. The coordination devices **220a**, **220b** may also report back to the monitor controller **200** whether the simulated attack is just a single or few packets, e.g., SQL injection attempt against a web server, using this attack depth would be able to be determined.

(230) For example, should only one ESS **109a** MP **221a** have zero packet leakage, or less than the threshold amount of packet leakage through its associated ESS **109b**, and MP **221b** for ESS **109b** is 70% packet leakage, depending on monitor controller decision making, the result may be vulnerable only for the ESS **109b** associated with **ISP2**.

(231) Many variations of the above traffic paths and leakage may exist and will vary from environment to environment. Additionally, a single packet of leakage may suffice to consider something vulnerable, for example, a leaked SQL injection.

(232) FIG. **14** is similar to FIG. **11** but adds coordination agents (CA) (or agents) **222A-222C** at each of the production servers **126A**, **126B**, **126C**, **126D**. The agents **222A-222C** may function as simulated coordination devices, and may, for example, have an emulated service, associated

therewith. For example, the agents **222A-222C** may provide data from the network, which may not be available from coordination devices. For example, the agents **222A-222C** may obtain baseline statistics, which may be utilized for health baselines, as well as baselines for the CPU of the system. Additionally, the agents **222A-222C** may be instructed to look for data on a machine, as well as communicate with the monitor controller **200, 240** to be aware of preattack data or pre diagnostic information. In this figure the PSS **230** is shown in the broken line box.

(233) FIG. **15** is a diagram showing a coordination device set up in the cloud. The configuration shown is one example configuration in the Amazon Web Service (AWS) cloud infrastructure. While cloud infrastructure is shown, the configuration, other infrastructure configurations such as, AWS, GCP, Azure or any other cloud provider, are also suitable, and the setup for mirroring or similar methods of diverting such traffic to the disclosed coordination devices are also suitable. Here, for example, traffic is copied or mirrored to the coordination device/instance **1520** for the target being validated.

(234) FIG. **15** shows the Internet **1500** (accessible through a gateway **1500a**) and the public subnet **1502** with an Amazon Web Service (AWS) EC2 **1504** in instance **1**, hosts, for example, a web server **1505**. Instance **1** is where the public would normally connect to from the Internet. Between the Internet **1500** and EC2 **1504** instance **1**, there is normally a combination of one or more of an ESS and or perimeter security services, such as Cloudfront, AWS shield, AWS WAF, and the like, including external security services like AKAMAI™ or IMPERVA™.

(235) Additionally, in the PUBLIC subnet **1502** of the ENI (Elastic Network Interface) **1506** with a VPC (Virtual Private cloud), a traffic mirror **1510** sends a copy of all its incoming and or outgoing traffic to an AWS network load balancer **1515**. The traffic then flows to an AWS partner solution **1517**, which in this case, for example, could be the coordination device **1520**, and/or, monitor tool **1525** (also known as a packet broker or Mirror service, used to mirror traffic). However, a partner solution may not be required and the traffic may flow directly to the coordination device **1520** from the AWS network load balancer **1515** or may even flow directly from and EC2 **1504, 1532** instance A and/or B to the coordination device **1520** in certain setups. Multiple EC2 **1504** instances from multiple PUBLIC subnets **1502** communicate to one or more coordination devices **1520** (for example, on the private subnet **1550**) through the ENIs, such that the coordination device **1520** receives a copy of all mirrored traffic from each associated EC2 **1504, 1532** instance. There may be one or more EC2 instance(s) **1504** to one coordination instance, or many EC2 **1504** instances to many coordination instances, in many cloud locations. Additionally, there may be a configuration when the VPC traffic monitor **1510** may not send traffic through an AWS Load Balancer **1515** and may be in a configuration where an EC2 **1504** instance sends mirrored traffic directly to the instance with the coordination device **1520**. Additionally, agents may be installed on any of the instances **1504** to provide further information and functionalities on the EC2 instance **1510** or other instances.

(236) For example, there may also be scenarios whereby on the PRIVATE subnet **1530**, through EC2 **1532** instance ENIs **1534**, a VPC traffic monitor **1540** may control the sending of mirrored traffic to the coordination device **1520**. The instances **1504** and **1532** may even be configured to send mirrored traffic to a coordination device external to the cloud provider's infrastructure.

(237) Some reference links, are listed as exemplary to potential cloud mirroring setups in different providers, cloud providers and underlying technologies have different ways of mirroring, instance and security setups, and the disclosed subject matter can be configured to accommodate the mirroring of each specific cloud: <https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/networking-and-content-delivery/using-vpc-traffic-mirroring-to-monitor-and-secure-your-aws-infrastructure/>
<https://azure.microsoft.com/en-us/updates/azure-virtual-network-tap/>
<https://cloud.google.com/vpc/docs/packet-mirroring> <https://cloud.google.com/vpc/docs/monitoring-packet-mirroring> <https://cloud.google.com/vpc/docs/packet-mirroring-partners>

EXAMPLES

Example 1

(238) A method for testing comprising: (a) configuring a coordination device in communication with a production network, the production network including at least one production service, the production network interfacing with an external network at a perimeter of the production network, the at least one production service downstream from the external network, and, a perimeter security system (PSS) for mitigating multiple threats upstream from the at least one production service; (b) receiving, by the coordination device, pre-attack notification information, the pre-attack notification information including: one or more types of attacks to be launched against the at least one production service; and, (c) collecting, by the coordination device, operation data corresponding to the traffic sent to the at least one production service, the traffic which has at least partially traversed the perimeter security system (PSS) during an attack, where the attack is based on the one or more types of attacks of the received pre-attack notification information, and the collecting during the attack based on the one or more types of attacks of the received pre-attack notification information.

Example 2

(239) The method of Example 1, wherein the coordination device includes at least one emulated service for receiving a simulated attack associated with the pre-attack notification information, and/or for receiving pre-attack notification information or signaling.

Example 3

(240) The method of Example 1 or Example 2, wherein the traffic includes packets.

Example 4

(241) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 3, wherein the traffic includes simulated attack and/or monitor traffic.

Example 5

(242) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 4, wherein the traffic includes legitimate traffic.

Example 6

(243) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 5, additionally comprising: monitoring response operation data of one or more monitors during the attack by a monitor controller, and, determining whether the response operation data is within a predetermined range.

Example 7

(244) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 6, wherein if the response operation data is determined to be outside of the predetermined range, either altering or terminating the attack.

Example 8

(245) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 7, additionally comprising: monitoring coordination agent operation data, during the attack by a monitor controller or co-ordination device, and, a co-ordination agent is on a production server and/or the co-ordination device.

Example 9

(246) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 8, wherein the monitor controller or the coordination device determines whether the agent operation data is within a predetermined range.

Example 10

(247) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 9, wherein if the agent operation data is determined to be outside of the predetermined range, either altering or terminating the attack.

Example 11

(248) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 10, additionally comprising, the coordination device sending the collected operation data to a collection point which evaluates the operation of the PSS.

Example 12

(249) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 11, wherein the collection point comprises a monitor controller.

Example 13

(250) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 12, wherein the coordination device collecting the operation data includes receiving a copy of the traffic sent to the production service from a mirror port, the traffic having at least partially traversed the perimeter security system (PSS) during the attack, the mirror port along the at least one production network and/or the external network and in communication with the coordination device.

Example 14

(251) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 13, wherein prior to a simulated attack, and collecting by the coordination device, generating a baseline associated with one or more monitor responses for the at least one production service.

Example 15

(252) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 14, wherein prior to a simulated attack, and collecting by the coordination device, generating a baseline associated with one or more coordination agent metrics for the at least one production server and/or at least one production service being hosted by the at least one production server.

Example 16

(253) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 15, wherein prior to the collecting by the coordination device, determining whether the at least one production service is of a predetermined stability to receive the attack.

Example 17

(254) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 16, wherein the pre-attack notification information includes the time when the attack is launched, and, one or more parameters of the attack.

Example 18

(255) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 17, additionally comprising: configuring one or more coordination agents on at least one production server hosting the at least one production service, each of the one or more coordination agents configured for: (i) receiving the pre-attack notification information; (ii) collecting the traffic received on the at least one production service and/or the at least one production server: or, (iii) collecting agent operation data from the one or more coordination agents indicative of the operation of the at least one production server.

Example 19

(256) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 18, additionally comprising: monitoring the one or more coordination agents for agent operation data during the attack, and, determining whether the agent operation data is within a predetermined range.

Example 20

(257) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 19, wherein if the agent operation data is determined to be outside of the predetermined range, either altering or terminating the attack.

Example 21

(258) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 20, wherein either altering or terminating the attack is performed by a monitor controller and/or a coordination device.

Example 22

(259) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 21, additionally comprising: configuring one or more monitors along the external network, each of the one or more monitors configured for: receiving the pre-attack notification information; and, collecting monitor operation data based on the pre-attack notification information and the collecting during the attack, from one or more of: the PSS; or, the at least one production service.

Example 23

(260) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 22, additionally comprising: monitoring, by a monitor controller, the monitor operation data during the attack, and, determining whether the monitor operation data is within a predetermined range.

Example 24

(261) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 23, wherein if the monitor operation data is determined to be outside of the predetermined range, either altering or terminating the attack.

Example 25

(262) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 24, additionally comprising: configuring one or more attack simulators along the external network, each of the one or more attack simulators configured for: receiving the pre-attack notification information; and, collecting simulator operation data based on the pre-attack notification information and the collecting of responses during the attack, from one or more of: the PSS; or, the at least one production service.

Example 26

(263) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 25, wherein the attack is initiated by a one or more simulators in communication with a simulator controller.

Example 27

(264) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 26, wherein the simulator controller is in communication with a monitor controller.

Example 28

(265) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 27, wherein the monitor controller is in communication with the one or more attack simulators.

Example 29

(266) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 28, wherein if the simulator controller loses communication with the monitor controller, the simulator controller initiates notification to the one or more simulators to terminate the attack.

Example 30

(267) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 29, wherein the attack is initiated by a simulator controller and performed by one or more simulators.

Example 31

(268) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 30, wherein if any of the one or more simulators loses communication with the simulator controller or a monitor controller, the simulator that has lost the communication terminates the attack.

Example 32

(269) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 31, wherein the perimeter security system is within the production network and at least partially in the external network.

Example 33

(270) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 32, wherein the perimeter security system (PSS), includes at least two of the group of: External Security Services (ESS) Module; DDoS mitigation module; Firewall; Antivirus; Anti-malware; Sandbox protections; Antispam; Web Application Firewall (WAF); or, Intrusion Protection System (IPS).

Example 34

(271) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 33, additionally comprising: analyzing the operation data collected by a monitor controller and/or the coordination device, the analyzing including: identifying vulnerabilities in the components of the perimeter security system (PSS); and, sending commands from an Application Program Interface (API) controller towards the PSS for remediating at least one of the components of the perimeter security system having the identified vulnerabilities.

Example 35

(272) The method of any one of Example 1 to Example 34, additionally comprising analyzing the operation data in the traffic by processes including deep packet inspection.

Example 36

(273) A method for testing a mirror port for communication with a coordination device, the mirror port along either an external network or a production network, the method comprising: receiving,

by the coordination device, pre-diagnostic notification information, the pre-diagnostic notification information including: test diagnostic traffic to be used for the testing of the coordination device and its at least one associated mirror port, the test diagnostic traffic including at least one of: a number of the packets and/or certain data within the packets of the test diagnostic traffic, and the time when the test diagnostic traffic will be transmitted to at least one production service along the production network; the at least one mirror port providing a copy of the test diagnostic traffic to the coordination device, corresponding to the time that the test diagnostic traffic was transmitted to the at least one production service, for which the test diagnostic traffic traversed at least one of the external network or the production network, towards the at least one production service; and, analyzing at least one of: the number of packets and/or the certain data within the packets, in the copied test diagnostic traffic, as provided in the pre-diagnostic notification information received by the coordination device, to determine operational status of the mirror port.

Example 37

(274) The method of Example 36, wherein the test diagnostic traffic is sent from at least one diagnostic monitor.

Example 38

(275) The method of Example 36 or Example 37, wherein the test diagnostic traffic comprises legitimate traffic from at least one external network.

Example 39

(276) The method of any one of Example 36 to Example 38, wherein the analyzing the certain data in the packets includes deep packet inspection.

Example 40

(277) The method of any one of Example 36 to Example 39, wherein the at least one production service is hosted by one or more production servers.

Example 41

(278) The method of any one of Example 36 to Example 40, wherein the diagnostic traffic is transmitted independently of the at least one diagnostic monitor, when the start time and/or end time of the diagnostic traffic is unknown.

Example 42

(279) The method for determining the route of an attack into a production network, the production network including at least one production service, from at least two network segments, including at least one external network segment, comprising: (a) configuring one or more coordination devices for communication with at least two of the network segments, each of the at least two network segments communicating with: 1) a production network, and, 2) a perimeter security system (PSS), the perimeter security system upstream from the at least one production service; (b) receiving, by the one or more coordination devices, pre-attack notification information, the pre-attack notification information including: one or more types of attacks for launching along any one or more of the at least two network segments, and targeting the at least one production service; and, (c) collecting, by the one or more coordination devices, operation data corresponding to traffic sent along at least one of the network segments towards the at least one production service and the operation data having at least partially traversed the perimeter security system (PSS) during an attack based on the one or more types of attacks of the received pre-attack notification information, and the collecting during the attack based on the one or more types of attacks based on the received pre-attack notification information.

Example 43

(280) The method of Example 42, wherein the pre-attack notification information includes, the time of the attack, and one or more of: the attack type, the number of packets in the attack, and/or certain data in the packets of the attack.

Example 44

(281) The method of Example 42 or Example 43, wherein the time of the attack includes the exact

time of the attack.

Example 45

(282) The method of any one of Example 42 to Example 44, wherein the time of the attack includes the approximate time of the attack.

Example 46

(283) The method of any one of Example 42 to Example 45, wherein the at least one production service is hosted by one or more production servers.

Example 47

(284) The method of any one of Example 42 to Example 46, wherein the perimeter security system (PSS) is within the production network and at least partially in the external network.

Example 48

(285) The method of any one of Example 42 to Example 47, wherein the perimeter security system (PSS) comprises at least two of the group of: External Security Services (ESS) Module; DDoS mitigation module; Firewall; Antivirus; Anti-malware; Sandbox protections; Antispam; Web Application Firewall (WAF); or, Intrusion Protection System (IPS).

Example 49

(286) The method of any one of Example 42 to Example 48, wherein the attack is initiated by one or more simulators in communication with a simulator controller.

Example 50

(287) The method of any one of Example 42 to Example 49, wherein the simulator controller is in communication with a monitor controller.

Example 51

(288) The method of any one of Example 42 to Example 50, wherein the one or more simulators are in communication with a monitor controller.

Example 52

(289) The method of any one of Example 42 to Example 51, wherein if any of the one or more simulators loses communication with the simulator controller or the monitor controller, the one or more simulators terminates the attack.

Example 53

(290) The method of any one of Example 42 to Example 52, wherein if the simulator controller loses communication with the monitor controller, the simulator controller initiates a notification to the one or more simulators to terminate the attack.

Example 54

(291) A method for testing depth of penetration for perimeter security of a network, comprising: (a) configuring at least one coordination device for communication with at least two points of-at least one network, the at least one network including at least one production service, and, a perimeter security system (PSS) for mitigating multiple threats upstream from the at least one production service; (b) receiving, by the at least one coordination device, pre-attack notification information, the pre-attack notification information including: one or more types of attacks to be launched against the at least one production service; (c) collecting, by the at least one coordination device, operation data which has at least partially traversed the perimeter security system (PSS) during an attack of the one or more attack types in the received pre-attack notification information, and the collecting from the at least two points, based on the attack of the one or more attack types from the pre-attack notification information; and, (d) analyzing the operation data collected by the at least one coordination device from the at least two points of the at least one network, for one or more of: packet leakage and/or the certain data within the packets, to determine one or more of: the downstream depth of penetration through the PSS towards the at least one production service by the attack, or, the effectiveness of one or more of the components of the perimeter security system (PSS).

Example 55

(292) The method of Example 54, wherein each of at least the at least two points of the at least one network includes a mirror port.

Example 56

(293) The method of Example 54 or Example 55, wherein the analyzing the operation data collected at the coordination device, additionally comprises: identifying vulnerabilities in one or more of the components of the perimeter security system (PSS); and, sending commands from an Application Program Interface (API) controller towards the PSS for remediating the at least one of the one or more components of the perimeter security system having the identified vulnerabilities.

Example 57

(294) The method of any one of Example 54 to Example 56, wherein the components of the perimeter security system (PSS) comprise at least two of the group of: External Security Services (ESS) Module; DDoS mitigation module; Firewall; Antivirus; Anti-malware; Sandbox protections; Antispam; Web Application Firewall (WAF); or, Intrusion Protection System (IPS).

Example 58

(295) The method of any one of Example 54 to Example 57, wherein the at least one network comprises a plurality of networks, and including an external network and a production network, and the at least one production service is on the production network.

Example 59

(296) The method of any one of Example 54 to Example 58 the perimeter security system (PSS) is within the production network and at least partially in the external network.

Example 60

(297) The method of any one of Example 54 to Example 59, wherein the identified vulnerabilities includes instructing the API controller to send one or more commands, and is performed by a monitor controller or the coordination device.

Example 61

(298) The method of any one of Example 54 to Example 60, wherein the pre-attack notification information includes, the time of the attack, and one or more of: the attack type, the number of packets in the attack, and/or certain data in the packets of the attack.

Example 62

(299) The method of any one of Example 54 to Example 61, wherein the time of the attack includes the exact time of the attack.

Example 63

(300) The method of any one of Example 54 to Example 62, wherein the time of the attack includes the approximate time of the attack.

Example 64

(301) The method of any one of Example 54 to Example 63, wherein the attack is initiated by one or more simulators in communication with a simulator controller.

Example 65

(302) The method of any one of Example 54 to Example 64, wherein the simulator controller is in communication with a monitor controller.

Example 66

(303) The method of any one of Example 54 to Example 65, wherein the one or more simulators are in communication with a monitor controller.

Example 67

(304) The method of any one of Example 54 to Example 66, wherein if the simulator controller loses communication with the monitor controller or the simulator controller, the simulator controller or the monitor controller initiates a notification to the one or more simulators to alter or terminate the attack.

Example 68

(305) The method of any one of Example 54 to Example 67, wherein the at least one coordination

device includes a plurality of coordination devices, and, different coordination devices communicate with at least one point of the at least one network.

Example 69

(306) A system for testing comprising: a coordination device configured for communicating with a network, the coordination device including: a receiver for receiving pre-attack notification information via the network, the pre-attack notification information including: one or more types of attacks to be launched; and, a collector for collecting operation data corresponding to traffic of an attack on the network which has at least partially traversed a Perimeter Security System (PSS), which was sent to a downstream target on the network, the traffic sent to the network based on the pre-attack notification information, and the collecting is during the attack on the network based on the pre-attack notification information.

Example 70

(307) The system of Example 69, additionally comprising a Perimeter Security System (PSS) at least partially along the network to protect the downstream target.

Example 71

(308) The system of Example 69 or Example 70, wherein the PSS includes two or more components selected from the group consisting of: External Security Services (ESS) Module; DDoS mitigation module; Firewall; Antivirus; Anti-malware; Sandbox protections; Antispam; Web Application Firewall (WAF); or, Intrusion Protection System (IPS).

Example 72

(309) The system of any one of Example 69 to Example 71, wherein the coordination device communicates with one or more mirror ports which receive traffic having traversed one or more of the components of the PSS along the network.

Example 73

(310) The system of any one of Example 69 to Example 72, wherein the coordination device or a monitor controller is configured to determine by monitoring the response of the target, whether the operation data is out of a pre-determined range, and, if the operation data is out of the predetermined range, initiating a notification to one or more simulators to alter or terminate the attack.

Example 74

(311) The system of any one of Example 69 to Example 73, wherein the downstream target comprises a production service along the network downstream from the PSS.

Example 75

(312) The system of any one of Example 69 to Example 74, wherein the production service is hosted by one or more production servers.

Example 76

(313) The system of any one of Example 69 to Example 75, wherein at least one emulated service is deployed on the coordination device, the emulated service configured for receiving a simulated attack associated with the pre-attack notification information, for receiving pre-attack notification information, and/or, for receiving and sending signaling associated with the pre-attack notification information.

(314) Aspects of the disclosed embodiments may be provided as a system, method or computer program product. Accordingly, aspects of the present disclosed embodiments may take the form of an entirely hardware embodiment, an entirely software embodiment (including firmware, resident software, micro-code, etc.) or an embodiment combining software and hardware aspects that may all generally be referred to herein as a “circuit,” “module” or “system.” Furthermore, aspects of the present disclosed embodiments may take the form of a computer program product embodied in one or more non-transitory computer readable (storage) medium(s) having computer readable program code embodied thereon.

(315) Implementation of the method and/or system of embodiments of the disclosed subject matter

can involve performing or completing selected tasks manually, automatically, or a combination thereof. Moreover, according to actual instrumentation and equipment of embodiments of the method and/or system of the disclosed subject matter, several selected tasks could be implemented by hardware, by software or by firmware or by a combination thereof using an operating system. (316) For example, hardware for performing selected tasks according to the disclosed embodiments could be implemented as a chip or a circuit. As software, selected tasks according to the disclosed embodiments could be implemented as a plurality of software instructions being executed by a computer using any suitable operating system. In an exemplary embodiment of the disclosed subject matter, one or more tasks according to exemplary embodiments of method and/or system as described herein are performed by a data processor, such as a computing platform for executing a plurality of instructions. Optionally, the data processor includes a volatile memory for storing instructions and/or data and/or a non-volatile storage, for example, non-transitory storage media such as a magnetic hard-disk and/or removable media, for storing instructions and/or data. Optionally, a network connection is provided as well. A display and/or a user input device such as a keyboard or mouse are optionally provided as well.

(317) For example, any combination of one or more non-transitory computer readable (storage) medium(s) may be utilized in accordance with the above-listed embodiments of the disclosed subject matter. A non-transitory computer readable storage medium may be, for example, but not limited to, an electronic, magnetic, optical, electromagnetic, infrared, or semiconductor system, apparatus, or device, or any suitable combination of the foregoing. More specific examples (a non-exhaustive list) of the computer readable storage medium would include the following: a portable computer diskette, a hard disk, a random access memory (RAM), a read-only memory (ROM), an erasable programmable read-only memory (EPROM or Flash memory), a portable compact disc read-only memory (CD-ROM), an optical storage device, a magnetic storage device, or any suitable combination of the foregoing. In the context of this document, a computer readable non-transitory storage medium may be any tangible medium that can contain, or store a program for use by or in connection with an instruction execution system, apparatus, or device.

(318) A computer readable signal medium may include a propagated data signal with computer readable program code embodied therein, for example, in baseband or as part of a carrier wave. Such a propagated signal may take any of a variety of forms, including, but not limited to, electromagnetic, optical, or any suitable combination thereof. A computer readable signal medium may be any computer readable medium that is not a computer readable storage medium and that can communicate, propagate, or transport a program for use by or in connection with an instruction execution system, apparatus, or device.

(319) As will be understood with reference to the paragraphs and the referenced drawings, provided above, various embodiments of computer-implemented methods are provided herein, some of which can be performed by various embodiments of apparatuses and systems described herein and some of which can be performed according to instructions stored in non-transitory computer-readable storage media described herein. Still, some embodiments of computer-implemented methods provided herein can be performed by other apparatuses or systems and can be performed according to instructions stored in computer-readable storage media other than that described herein, as will become apparent to those having skill in the art with reference to the embodiments described herein. Any reference to systems and computer-readable storage media with respect to the following computer-implemented methods is provided for explanatory purposes, and is not intended to limit any of such systems and any of such non-transitory computer-readable storage media with regard to embodiments of computer-implemented methods described above. Likewise, any reference to the following computer-implemented methods with respect to systems and computer-readable storage media is provided for explanatory purposes, and is not intended to limit any of such computer-implemented methods disclosed herein.

(320) The flowcharts and block diagrams in the Figures illustrate the architecture, functionality, and

operation of possible implementations of systems, methods and computer program products according to various embodiments of the present disclosed subject matter. In this regard, each block in the flowchart or block diagrams may represent a module, segment, or portion of code, which comprises one or more executable instructions for implementing the specified logical function(s). It should also be noted that, in some alternative implementations, the functions noted in the block may occur out of the order noted in the figures. For example, two blocks shown in succession may, in fact, be executed substantially concurrently, or the blocks may sometimes be executed in the reverse order, depending upon the functionality involved. It will also be noted that each block of the block diagrams and/or flowchart illustration, and combinations of blocks in the block diagrams and/or flowchart illustration, can be implemented by special purpose hardware-based systems that perform the specified functions or acts, or combinations of special purpose hardware and computer instructions.

(321) The descriptions of the various embodiments of the disclosed subject matter have been presented for purposes of illustration, but are not intended to be exhaustive or limited to the embodiments disclosed. Many modifications and variations will be apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art without departing from the scope and spirit of the disclosed embodiments.

(322) As used herein, the singular form “a”, “an” and “the” include plural references unless the context clearly dictates otherwise.

(323) The word “exemplary” is used herein to mean “serving as an example, instance or illustration”. Any embodiment described as “exemplary” is not necessarily to be construed as preferred or advantageous over other embodiments and/or to exclude the incorporation of features from other embodiments.

(324) It is appreciated that certain features of the disclosed subject matter, which are, for clarity, described in the context of separate embodiments, may also be provided in combination in a single embodiment. Conversely, various features of the disclosed subject matter, which are, for brevity, described in the context of a single embodiment, may also be provided separately or in any suitable subcombination or as suitable in any other described embodiment of the disclosed subject matter.

(325) The above-described processes including portions thereof can be performed by software, hardware and combinations thereof. These processes and portions thereof can be performed by computers, computer-type devices, workstations, processors, micro-processors, other electronic searching tools and memory and other non-transitory storage-type devices associated therewith. The processes and portions thereof can also be embodied in programmable non-transitory storage media, for example, compact discs (CDs) or other discs including magnetic, optical, etc., readable by a machine or the like, or other computer usable storage media, including magnetic, optical, or semiconductor storage, or other source of electronic signals.

(326) The processes (methods) and systems, including components thereof, herein have been described with exemplary reference to specific hardware and software. The processes (methods) have been described as exemplary, whereby specific steps and their order can be omitted and/or changed by persons of ordinary skill in the art to reduce these embodiments to practice without undue experimentation. The processes (methods) and systems have been described in a manner sufficient to enable persons of ordinary skill in the art to readily adapt other hardware and software as may be needed to reduce any of the embodiments to practice without undue experimentation and using conventional techniques.

(327) Although the disclosed subject matter has been described in conjunction with specific embodiments thereof, it is evident that many alternatives, modifications and variations will be apparent to those skilled in the art. Accordingly, it is intended to embrace all such alternatives, modifications and variations that fall within the spirit and broad scope of the appended claims.

Claims

1. A method for testing comprising: (a) configuring a coordination device in communication with a production network, the production network including at least one production service, the production network interfacing with an external network at a perimeter of the production network, the at least one production service downstream from the external network, and a perimeter security system (PSS) for mitigating multiple threats upstream from the at least one production service; (b) receiving, by the coordination device, pre-attack notification information, the pre-attack notification information including: one or more types of attacks to be launched against the at least one production service; and (c) collecting, by the coordination device, operation data corresponding to the traffic sent to the at least one production service, the traffic which has at least partially traversed the perimeter security system (PSS) during an attack, where the attack is based on the one or more types of attacks of the received pre-attack notification information, and the collecting during the attack based on the one or more types of attacks of the received pre-attack notification information.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the coordination device includes at least one emulated service for receiving a simulated attack associated with the pre-attack notification information, and/or for receiving pre-attack notification information or signaling.
3. The method of claim 1, wherein the traffic includes packets.
4. The method of claim 1, wherein the traffic includes simulated attack traffic and/or monitor traffic.
5. The method of claim 1, wherein the traffic includes legitimate traffic.
6. The method of claim 1, additionally comprising: monitoring response operation data of one or more monitors during the attack by a monitor controller, and, determining whether the response operation data is within a predetermined range.
7. The method of claim 6, wherein if the response operation data is determined to be outside of the predetermined range, either altering or terminating the attack.
8. The method of claim 1, additionally comprising: monitoring coordination agent operation data during the attack by a monitor controller or the coordination device, and a coordination agent is on a production server and/or the coordination device.
9. The method of claim 8, wherein the monitor controller or the coordination device determines whether the coordination agent operation data is within a predetermined range.
10. The method of claim 9, wherein if the coordination agent operation data is determined to be outside of the predetermined range, either altering or terminating the attack.
11. The method of claim 1, additionally comprising, the coordination device sending the collected operation data to a collection point which evaluates the operation of the perimeter security system (PSS).
12. The method of claim 11, wherein the collection point comprises a monitor controller.
13. The method of claim 1, wherein the coordination device collecting the operation data includes receiving a copy of the traffic sent to the at least one production service from a mirror port, the traffic having at least partially traversed the perimeter security system (PSS) during the attack, the mirror port along the production network and/or the external network and in communication with the coordination device.
14. The method of claim 1, wherein prior to a simulated attack, and the collecting by the coordination device, generating a baseline associated with one or more monitor responses for the at least one production service.
15. The method of claim 1, wherein prior to a simulated attack, and the collecting by the coordination device, generating a baseline associated with one or more coordination agent metrics for the at least one production service and/or the at least one production service hosting at least one production server.
16. The method of claim 1, wherein prior to the collecting by the coordination device, determining

whether the at least one production service is of a predetermined stability to receive the attack.

17. The method of claim 1, wherein the pre-attack notification information includes the time when the attack is launched, and one or more parameters of the attack.

18. The method of claim 1, additionally comprising: configuring one or more coordination agents on at least one production server hosting the at least one production service, each of the one or more coordination agents configured for: (i) receiving the pre-attack notification information; (ii) collecting the traffic received on the at least one production service and/or the at least one production server; or, (iii) collecting coordination agent operation data from the one or more coordination agents indicative of the operation of the at least one production server.

19. The method of claim 18, additionally comprising: monitoring the one or more coordination agents for coordination agent operation data during the attack, and, determining whether the coordination agent operation data is within a predetermined range.

20. The method of claim 19, wherein if the coordination agent operation data is determined to be outside of the predetermined range, either altering or terminating the attack.

21. The method of claim 20, wherein either altering or terminating the attack is performed by a monitor controller and/or the coordination device.

22. The method of claim 1, additionally comprising: configuring one or more monitors along the external network, each of the one or more monitors configured for: receiving the pre-attack notification information; and collecting monitor operation data based on the pre-attack notification information and the collecting during the attack, from one or more of: the perimeter security system (PSS); or, the at least one production service.

23. The method of claim 22, additionally comprising: monitoring, by a monitor controller, the monitor operation data during the attack, and, determining whether the monitor operation data is within a predetermined range.

24. The method of claim 23, wherein if the monitor operation data is determined to be outside of the predetermined range, either altering or terminating the attack.

25. The method of claim 1, additionally comprising: configuring one or more attack simulators along the external network, each of the one or more attack simulators configured for: receiving the pre-attack notification information; and collecting simulator operation data based on the pre-attack notification information and the collecting of responses during the attack, from one or more of: the perimeter security system (PSS); or, the at least one production service.

26. The method of claim 1, wherein the attack is initiated by one or more simulators in communication with a simulator controller.

27. The method of claim 26, wherein the simulator controller is in communication with a monitor controller.

28. The method of claim 27, wherein the monitor controller is in communication with the one or more simulators.

29. The method of claim 28, wherein if the simulator controller loses communication with the monitor controller, the simulator controller initiates notification to the one or more simulators to terminate the attack.

30. The method of claim 1, wherein the attack is initiated by a simulator controller and performed by one or more simulators.

31. The method of claim 30, wherein if any of the one or more simulators loses communication with the simulator controller or a monitor controller, the simulator that has lost the communication terminates the attack.

32. The method of claim 1, wherein the perimeter security system (PSS) is within the production network and at least partially in the external network.

33. The method of claim 25, wherein the perimeter security system (PSS), includes at least two of the group of: External Security Services (ESS) Module; Distributed Denial of Service (DDoS) mitigation module; Firewall; Antivirus; Anti-malware; Sandbox protections; Antispam; Web

Application Firewall (WAF); or Intrusion Protection System (IPS).

34. The method of claim 1, additionally comprising: analyzing the operation data collected by a monitor controller and/or the coordination device, the analyzing including: identifying vulnerabilities in the components of the perimeter security system (PSS); and sending commands from an Application Program Interface (API) controller towards the perimeter security system (PSS) for remediating at least one of the components of the perimeter security system (PSS) having the identified vulnerabilities.

35. The method of claim 1, additionally comprising analyzing the operation data in the traffic by processes including deep packet inspection (DPI).

36. A method for testing a mirror port for communication with a coordination device, the mirror port along either an external network or a production network, the method comprising: receiving, by the coordination device, pre-diagnostic notification information, the pre-diagnostic notification information including: test diagnostic traffic to be used for the testing of the coordination device and at least one mirror port associated with the coordination device, the test diagnostic traffic including at least one of: a number of the packets and/or certain data within the packets, of the test diagnostic traffic, and a time when the test diagnostic traffic will be transmitted to at least one production service along the production network; the at least one mirror port providing a copy of the test diagnostic traffic to the coordination device, corresponding to the time that the test diagnostic traffic was transmitted to the at least one production service, for which the test diagnostic traffic traversed at least one of the external network or the production network, towards the at least one production service; and analyzing at least one of: the number of packets and/or the certain data within the packets, in the copy of the test diagnostic traffic to the coordination device, as provided in the pre-diagnostic notification information received by the coordination device, to determine operational status of the at least one mirror port.

37. The method of claim 36, wherein the test diagnostic traffic is sent from at least one diagnostic monitor.

38. The method of claim 36, wherein the test diagnostic traffic comprises legitimate traffic from the external network.

39. The method of claim 36, wherein the analyzing the certain data within the packets includes deep packet inspection.

40. The method of claim 36, wherein the at least one production service is hosted by one or more production servers.

41. The method of claim 37, wherein the test diagnostic traffic is transmitted independently of the at least one diagnostic monitor, when a start time and/or end time of the test diagnostic traffic is unknown.

42. A method for determining the route of an attack into a production network, the production network including at least one production service, from at least two network segments, including at least one external network segment, comprising: (a) configuring one or more coordination devices for communication with at least two of the network segments, each of the at least two network segments communicating with: 1) a production network, and 2) a perimeter security system (PSS), the perimeter security system (PSS) upstream from the at least one production service; (b) receiving, by the one or more coordination devices, pre-attack notification information, the pre-attack notification information including: one or more types of attacks for launching along any one or more of the at least two network segments, and targeting the at least one production service; and (c) collecting, by the one or more coordination devices, operation data corresponding to traffic sent along at least one of the network segments towards the at least one production service and the operation data having at least partially traversed the perimeter security system (PSS) during an attack based on the one or more types of attacks of the received pre-attack notification information, and the collecting during the attack based on the one or more types of attacks based on the received pre-attack notification information.

43. The method of claim 42, wherein the pre-attack notification information includes, a time of the attack, and one or more of: the type of the attack, a number of packets in the attack, and/or certain data in the packets in the attack.
44. The method of claim 43, wherein the time of the attack includes an exact time of the attack.
45. The method of claim 43, wherein the time of the attack includes an approximate time of the attack.
46. The method of claim 42, wherein the at least one production service is hosted by one or more production servers.
47. The method of claim 42, wherein the perimeter security system (PSS) is within the production network and at least partially in the at least one external network segment.
48. The method of claim 47, wherein the perimeter security system (PSS) comprises at least two of the group of: External Security Services (ESS) Module; DDoS mitigation module; Firewall; Antivirus; Anti-malware; Sandbox protections; Antispam; Web Application Firewall (WAF); or Intrusion Protection System (IPS).
49. The method of claim 42, wherein the attack is initiated by one or more simulators in communication with a simulator controller.
50. The method of claim 49, wherein the simulator controller is in communication with a monitor controller.
51. The method of claim 50, wherein the one or more simulators are in communication with the monitor controller.
52. The method of claim 51, wherein if any of the one or more simulators loses communication with the simulator controller or the monitor controller, the one or more simulators terminates the attack.
53. The method of claim 52, wherein if the simulator controller loses communication with the monitor controller, the simulator controller initiates a notification to the one or more simulators to terminate the attack.
54. A method for testing depth of penetration for perimeter security of a network, comprising: (a) configuring at least one coordination device for communication with at least two points of at least one network, the at least one network including at least one production service, and a perimeter security system (PSS) for mitigating multiple threats upstream from the at least one production service; (b) receiving, by the at least one coordination device, pre-attack notification information, the pre-attack notification information including: one or more types of attacks to be launched against the at least one production service; (c) collecting, by the at least one coordination device, operation data which has at least partially traversed the perimeter security system (PSS) during an attack of the one or more attack types in the received pre-attack notification information, and the collecting from the at least two points of the at least one network, based on the attack of the one or more attack types from the pre-attack notification information; and (d) analyzing the operation data collected by the at least one coordination device from the at least two points of the at least one network, for one or more of: packet leakage and/or the certain data within the packets, to determine one or more of: the downstream depth of penetration through the perimeter security system (PSS) towards the at least one production service by the attack, or, the effectiveness of one or more components of the perimeter security system (PSS).
55. The method of claim 54, wherein each of the at least two points of the at least one network includes a mirror port.
56. The method of claim 54, wherein the analyzing the operation data collected by the at least one coordination device, additionally comprises: identifying vulnerabilities in the one or more components of the perimeter security system (PSS); and sending commands from an Application Program Interface (API) controller towards the perimeter security system (PSS) for remediating at least one of the one or more components of the perimeter security system (PSS) having the identified vulnerabilities.

57. The method of claim 56, wherein the one or more components of the perimeter security system (PSS) comprise at least two of the group of: External Security Services (ESS) Module; DDoS mitigation module; Firewall; Antivirus; Anti-malware; Sandbox protections; Antispam; Web Application Firewall (WAF); or Intrusion Protection System (IPS).

58. The method of claim 56, wherein the at least one network comprises a plurality of networks, the plurality of networks including an external network and a production network, and the at least one production service is on the production network.

59. The method of claim 58, wherein the perimeter security system (PSS) is within the production network and at least partially in the external network.

60. The method of claim 56, wherein the identifying vulnerabilities includes instructing the API controller to send one or more commands, and is performed by a monitor controller or the at least one coordination device.

61. The method of claim 54, wherein the pre-attack notification information includes, a time of the attack, and one or more of: the type of attack, a number of packets in the attack, and/or certain data in the packets in the attack.

62. The method of claim 61, wherein the time of the attack includes an exact time of the attack.

63. The method of claim 61, wherein the time of the attack includes an approximate time of the attack.

64. The method of claim 54, wherein the attack is initiated by one or more simulators in communication with a simulator controller.

65. The method of claim 64, wherein the simulator controller is in communication with a monitor controller.

66. The method of claim 65, wherein the one or more simulators are in communication with the monitor controller.

67. The method of claim 65, wherein if the simulator controller loses communication with the monitor controller or the simulator controller, the simulator controller or the monitor controller initiates a notification to the one or more simulators to alter or terminate the attack.

68. The method of claim 54, wherein the at least one coordination device includes a plurality of coordination devices, and different ones of the plurality of coordination devices communicate with at least one point of the at least one network.

69. A system for testing comprising: a coordination device configured for communicating with a network, the coordination device including: a receiver for receiving pre-attack notification information via the network, the pre-attack notification information including: one or more types of attacks to be launched; and a collector for collecting operation data corresponding to traffic of an attack on the network which has at least partially traversed a Perimeter Security System (PSS), which was sent to a downstream target on the network, the traffic sent to the network based on the pre-attack notification information, and the collecting is during the attack on the network based on the pre-attack notification information.

70. The system of claim 69, additionally comprising a Perimeter Security System (PSS) at least partially along the network to protect the downstream target.

71. The system of claim 70, wherein the perimeter security system (PSS) includes two or more components selected from the group consisting of: External Security Services (ESS) Module; DDoS mitigation module; Firewall; Antivirus; Anti-malware; Sandbox protections; Antispam; Web Application Firewall (WAF); or Intrusion Protection System (IPS).

72. The system of claim 71, wherein the coordination device communicates with one or more mirror ports which receive traffic having traversed one or more of the components of the perimeter security system (PSS) along the network.

73. The system of claim 69, wherein the coordination device or a monitor controller is configured to determine, by monitoring the response of the downstream target, whether the operation data is out of a predetermined range, and, if the operation data is out of the predetermined range, initiating

a notification to one or more simulators to alter or terminate the attack.

74. The system of claim 69, wherein the downstream target comprises a production service along the network downstream from the perimeter security system (PSS).

75. The system of claim 74, wherein the production service is hosted by one or more production servers.

76. The system of claim 69, wherein at least one emulated service is deployed on the coordination device, the emulated service configured for receiving a simulated attack associated with the pre-attack notification information for receiving pre-attack notification information, and/or, for receiving and sending signaling associated with the pre-attack notification information.
